

PHILIPPINE ARMY MANUAL 3-0502-02

CAVALRY OPERATIONS

Proponent: Mechanized Infantry Division, Philippine Army

Issued: _____

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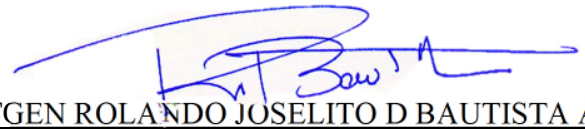
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LTGEN ROLANDO JOSELITO D BAUTISTA AFP
Commanding General, Philippine Army

Preface

1. The purpose of this manual is to provide guidance for cavalry operations. Specifically, this material will provide guidance in the conduct of cavalry operations in the Philippine Army.

2. This manual contains information on the command and control; offensive operations; defensive operations; other tactical operations and combat support and combat service support of an cavalry unit. It is highly applicable in both conventional and internal security operations.

3. The proponent of this manual is Mechanized Infantry Division, Philippine Army. However, Doctrine Center is responsible for the review and updating of this publication. Send comments or recommendations to the the Director, Doctrine Center, TRADOC, PA at Camp O'Donnell, Sta Lucia, Capas, Tarlac 2315 or via email at dcannex45@gmail.com. Feedbacks to this publication are also welcome telephonically via the Bonifacio Telephone Exchange trunk line number 845-9555 or military local line number 765 extension 4971.

4. All publications, manuals and directives inconsistent with this manual are hereby rescinded.

5. Unless this publication state otherwise, masculine nouns and pronouns do not refer exclusively to men.

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Chapter I
Introduction to Cavalry Operations

The Role of Cavalry

0101. **Fundamental Role.** The fundamental role of cavalry is to perform reconnaissance and provide security in close operations. In doing so, the cavalry facilitates the commander's ability to maneuver divisions, brigades, and battalions and to concentrate superior combat power and use it against the enemy at the decisive time and point. Cavalry clarifies, in part, the fog of battle. Cavalry is, by its role, an economy of force. The flexible capabilities of cavalry allow the commander to conserve the combat power of divisions or brigades for preferred engagement. The combat power of cavalry units, in particular, makes them ideal for offensive and defensive missions as an economy of force.

0102. Cavalry serves as a catalyst that transforms the concepts of maneuver warfare into a battlefield capability. Maneuver, in the tactical sense, is the swift movement and positioning of combat forces to attack an enemy's vulnerability, such as flanks, rear and line of communication, service support capability, or isolated elements.

0103. Maneuver is the means to seize or retain the initiative and to create or exploit offensive opportunities. Maneuver is also the means to concentrate superior combat power against the enemy at the right time and place. For maneuver to be successful, the commander must have a high degree of situational awareness. He must reduce the enemy, terrain, and friendly unknowns of the battlefield to fight effectively and to operate within the enemy's decision cycle. The successful execution of maneuver warfare continues to be the product of thorough reconnaissance and continual security. As the "eyes and ears" of the commander, the cavalry provides the commander with situational awareness and enhances his ability to maneuver successfully.

Primary Roles

0104. The fundamental purpose of the cavalry on the battlefield translates into roles that it performs for the commander. These roles are not necessarily missions in themselves, but are translated into mission statements by the squadron commander. These roles may represent the intent of the division commander when he assigns a mission to the cavalry unit. The primary roles of the Cavalry are:

a. Provide fresh information on the terrain and enemy

b. Provide reaction time and maneuver space

c. Preserve combat power

d. Restore command and control

e. Facilitate movement

f. Perform rear operation

0105. **Provide Fresh Information.** The division commander's ability to seize or retain the initiative and concentrate overwhelming combat power at the right time and place depends on having fresh information about the enemy, such as his current dispositions, size, composition, direction of movement, and rate of advance. The precise application of combat power and effective synchronization of maneuver and supporting fires require a fresh and accurate picture of the enemy's current dispositions and activity within the area of operations. Concentration of combat power, through maneuver, also depends on the ability of divisions and brigades to move swiftly and predictably. Consequently, the commander must know which routes and cross-country terrain are suitable to maneuver forces into decisive engagements with the enemy.

0106. To piece the puzzle together, the commander has varied intelligence assets available to him, such as national intelligence sources, military intelligence units, aviation, cavalry units, and any unit in contact. These intelligence collection sources facilitate intelligence preparation of the battlefield (IPB), the target development process, and execution of ongoing operations. Many intelligence systems orient well forward of the Forward Line of Own Troops (FLOT) to identify enemy force concentrations and movements, as well as high-value targets whose loss may have a paralyzing effect on the enemy's ability to fight. The analytical control element at the division and regiment collates, analyzes, and disseminates this information to support planning of future operations and targeting for indirect-fire systems. This information serves as a basis for the commander to dispose and concentrate his forces for future combat operations. While this type of intelligence information is necessary, it is not entirely sufficient. Commanders need fresh, real- time information during the execution of current operations to be precise in the maneuver and application of combat power against the enemy. A major source of fresh information for the commander during battle is his cavalry.

0107. Cavalry has decisive advantages over other intelligence resources because it:

a. Works through and counters enemy deception efforts better than any sensor system.

b. Provides the fastest, most reliable means of assessing terrain that the enemy is trying to configure to his advantage.

c. Is not a passive source. The Cavalry is not only finds the enemy but can further develop the situation and force the enemy to reveal more information.

d. Can more effectively disseminate information to commanders with an immediate need (eavesdrop, liaison officer).

0108. Performing reconnaissance, cavalry provides the commander with combat information he needs to strike at the right place and time, such as the actual size and composition of the enemy, his exact dispositions, where he is strong, where he is

weak, and where and when the precise application of superior combat power could have a decisive effect.

0109. The cavalry shows the commander where to move forces to ensure their uninterrupted advance to objectives despite battlefield conditions, such as impassable routes, blown bridges, unfordable streams, contaminated areas, refugee columns, converging friendly units, and enemy forces. At the decisive point, the cavalry guides maneuver units into engagements with the enemy, assists in rapidly massing and dispersing maneuver units, controls routes and choke points, and monitors the movement of combat support and combat service support units.

0110. **Provide Reaction Time and Maneuver Space.** A commander thinks and plans in terms of the time and space required in maneuvering and concentrating subordinate units against enemy weaknesses. There are two ways to create sufficient time and space. First, he detects and comprehends enemy developments well forward of the FLOT in time to array forces. Second, he directs aggressive security actions that buy time and space required for an effective response to enemy initiatives.

0111. Reconnoitering or performing security operations well forward or to the flanks of the main body, the cavalry develops the situation and prevents the commander from fighting at a disadvantage - unwarned, poorly disposed, or not poised to fight. By virtue of where the cavalry performs the mission, it provides time for the commander to assess the situation, determine a course of action, issue orders, and maneuver.

0112. The cavalry also provides space to maneuver divisions or brigades, creating flexibility for the commander to respond to unanticipated enemy initiatives. The amount of time and space provided may be determined by the commander’s intent. It is defined by the assigned mission. Time and space are physically provided by where the cavalry unit operates relative to the main body and the amount of combat power available.

0113. **Preserve Combat Power.** When fighting a bigger, echeloned enemy, sustainment and preservation of combat power are critical. Winning the current battle is only part of the fight. Performing security for the brigade or division, the cavalry protects and preserves combat power until the commander determines where to concentrate forces so that they can be maneuvered into engagements with the enemy.

0114. During offensive operations, the cavalry prevents premature deployment and attrition of combat power before reaching the objective. In defensive or retrograde operations, the cavalry provides warning of enemy approach, destroys or repels enemy reconnaissance elements, and fights enemy, lead elements as required. If required, the cavalry protects the main body from engagement under unfavorable conditions and prevents the commander from having to divert forces from his main effort.

0115. **Restore Command and Control.** On a battlefield that is fluid and chaotic, with communications systems frequently destroyed or jammed, command and control within the corps and division is fragile. When communications are lost with subordinate units, or when the commanders are unsure of their location and situation,

the cavalry is particularly suited to restore command and control. Performing reconnaissance, the cavalry finds and re-establishes physical contact and communications with subordinate units, finds dead spaces not covered by any unit, or fills gaps between units that could be exploited by the enemy. Cavalry reports directly to the corps or division commander on the status of subordinate units. Serving as liaisons, the cavalry carries the commander's request for information or instructions to a subordinate commander when communications are lost.

0116. **Facilitate Movement.** The cluttered and confused battlefield requires firm control of unit movements. The history of mechanized warfare demonstrates that the most frequent task a division performs is movement:

a. From port of debarkation to assembly area;

b. From assembly area to attack positions or defensive sectors;

c. During repositioning in the defense;

d. When conducting a counterattack;

e. When repositioning forces for the attack;

0117. Cavalry units execute this task largely by performing reconnaissance. They monitor progress of subordinate elements for the commander. Their man contact points and passage points, and coordinate with higher and adjacent units or headquarters.

0118. **Perform Rear Operations.** The threat can attack throughout the depth of the battlefield. They do this simultaneously with an attack along the FLOT. Rear areas are not safe. When not employed in other missions, the cavalry may perform rear operation tasks to supplement the capabilities of other rear area units/assets or to relieve combat units of contingency missions that may detract from their primary focus.

0119. By performing continuous reconnaissance of rear areas, the cavalry keep its fingers on the pulse of rear operations. The cavalry identifies problems, performs area damage control after a major disruption, restores command and control, and facilitates movement of forces. Rear operations may also include serving as, or as part of, a tactical combat force.

The Operating Environment

0120. The country's strategic depth is determined by the land domain where the people, the government, its culture and socio-political and economic infrastructure that defines it as a nation reside. As such, in order to understand the conditions, circumstances, and influences that affect the employment of Army capabilities, the PA Operating Environment must be viewed with the following physical and non-physical characteristics:

a. **Archipelagic.** The Philippines is an archipelagic country that consists of around 7,641 islands with an estimated 31,800 kilometers of coastline. It is divided into three main island groups, namely: Luzon, Visayas and Mindanao. Each island group has unique physical characteristics. Most of the islands are huge enough to accommodate large populations since their local resources allow for long-term habitation and development. These characteristics of the physical operating environment dictates that most military operations will most likely happen across a non-contiguous land domain with intervening variables such as political, economic, cultural and social factors.

b. **Disaster-Prone.** The Philippines is prone to natural calamities due to its geographic location being situated along the "Pacific Ring of Fire" and "Pacific Typhoon Belt." This makes the Philippines a consistent witness to severe weather conditions as well as earth-shaking, volcanic and seismic activities. Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief (HADR) will continue to compete with the PA traditional task of warfighting.

c. **Highly Urbanized.** According to recent population study, by 2025, Metro Manila will be considered as one of the mega-cities in Asia with a projected population of 14.8 million. Such will be the trend in other metropolitan areas of the country as well. Protecting population and infrastructures in a high-density urban terrain from the impact of war is a high probability in the future.

d. **Universally Connected.** Global economic, social, and communication systems are becoming highly interconnected. Information is disseminated immediately through various means. The transmission of information at high rates of consumption amplifies the interaction among people and organizations on a global scale. This highly connected environment makes the conduct of Army operations equally advantageous and precarious.

e. **Politically, Economically, and Socially Constrained.** The political and social dynamics primarily define the direction of national priorities. The economic capacity of the nation influences what it may and may not do. Currently, economic pressures and fiscal constraints curtail the nation's potentials.

f. **Collective Environment.** National security is a shared responsibility of government and non-government agencies, organizations and partner nations. Internally, a collective environment would mean that both government and non-government sectors have a certain degree of shared interests, concerns, and responsibilities which are manifested through joint efforts of various sectors of society. Externally, a collective environment is composed of the shared concerns of nations and how they forge partnerships for the common good. Therefore, a collective environment requires that all the sectors involved must have the capacity for interoperability.

g. **Culturally Diverse.** The diversity of the country's demography as an effect of the Philippines being an archipelago and its long history of interaction with other countries contributed to the uniqueness of the Philippine culture. In fact, local sub-cultures are distinct from every region in the country. The Philippine

populace is composed of a multitude of ethnic groups that have their respective cultural practices, norms and traditions. With these, the culture of the people in a particular region impacts on the conduct of military operations as far as establishing legitimacy and generating popular support is concerned.

Cavalry In Support Of Division Operations

0121. The cavalry squadron normally operates as part of the division to which it is assigned. The squadron is the division commander's "eyes and ears."

0122. **Division Offensive Operations.** The division undertakes offensive operations to destroy the enemy and his ability and will to resist. Within a division offensive scheme of maneuver, subordinate units conduct a variety of missions:

a. Movement to contact;

b. Hasty attack;

c. Deliberate attack;

d. Deception operations;

e. Reconnaissance in force;

f. Security (screen, flank/advance/rear guard, area, convoy, and route security);

g. Defend;

h. Special purpose operations;

0123. As part of this offensive operation, the squadron may perform a series of missions. Should the division conduct movement prior to contact, the squadron may perform the following:

a. Reconnaissance of movement routes;

b. Movement control tasks; and

c. A variety of forms of reconnaissance and security operations as directed by the division commander.

0124. As the division attack begins, the squadron may lead the main effort performing zone reconnaissance or advance guard. If the division commander elects not to use the squadron forward of the division, then it can screen or guard an exposed flank of the division to prevent surprise from enemy attack. Additionally the squadron might screen the objective while the division re-organizes or consolidates. Depending on the squadron organization, guard missions may require augmenting the squadron with tanks.

0125. **Division Defensive Operations.** The primary purpose of division defensive operations is the defeat of an enemy attack. Defense is a temporary state that creates the conditions for surviving the initial shock of the attack, stopping the enemy, and exploiting the initiative to go on the offensive.

0126. Within a typical division defensive scheme of maneuver, subordinate maneuver units perform a variety of missions. Some will defend in sector or delay. Others may counter-attack or perform security missions. Some may defend in an economy-of-force role. A reserve repairs to execute counter-attack contingencies or lead the transition to offensive operations. Deceptions, spoiling attacks, raids, and other special purpose missions are part of these operations.

0127. Again, the squadron may perform a series of missions. Security missions will predominate. Initially, the squadron may screen or guard forward the division. It may also serve as a part of a covering force. Alternatively, the squadron may screen or guard an exposed flank. Subsequently, the squadron may operate out of the division rear area performing a variety of tasks. Finally, the squadron may support the commitment of the reserve. The squadron facilitates movement as a reserve repositions or moves. Upon commitment, the squadron may continue with the reserve performing reconnaissance or providing security.

0128. **Joint Task Force Operations.** Cavalry units may operate as part of a joint task force to conduct reconnaissance and security missions. The combined arms nature and command and control structure inherent to cavalry organization makes them ideally suited to force packaging in support of various types of operations ranging from nation assistance to peacekeeping and peace enforcement.

Missions

0129. The primary tasks of the cavalry, within the context of joint task force or division operations, are translated into missions. Mission profiles reflect the predominant operational requirements placed on the unit. These mission requirements represent force design and capability objectives. However, some missions may require augmentation with additional maneuver or maneuver support assets. Mission profiles do not preclude the assignment of other missions required by a particular operational situation (see Table 1-1).

Table 1.1 - Mission profiles

												MISSIONS ASSOCIATED WITH ECONOMY OF FORCE ROLE				
	Recon				**Security**											
	Route	Area	Zone	Recon on Force	Screen	Guard	Cover	Area	Route	Convoy	Hasty Attack	Attack	Movement to Contact	Defend Battle Position	Defend Sector	Retrograde (Delay)
Squadron	X	X	X	X	X	X		X	X	X	X	X	X		X	X
Troop	X	X	X		X			X		X	X	X	X	X	X	X
Scout Platoon	X	X	X		X						⌂		⌂	⌂	⌂	⌂
X = Doctrinally Capable, application of area security								**⌂ Non- doctrinal but capable given METT-TC**								

0130. These missions are grouped into general categories, but they are not mutually exclusive. Techniques and critical tasks of reconnaissance and security, for example, overlap. Offensive and defensive operations can occur as a part of any other mission, especially cover, guard, area and route security. Subsequent chapters will discuss each mission category. No distinction exists in the mission profile between the armored and light cavalry. Cavalry units perform these missions in the conflict environment for which it was designed.

0131. When a cavalry squadron is committed, its capabilities need to match the increased requirements of these missions, given the factors of enemy and terrain. The organization of the cavalry squadron with air and ground troops produces a significant synergism in mission accomplishment. This is an added benefit when the squadron performs missions for the division.

0132. Missions may be performed sequentially during an operation. The squadron normally is not fragmented or assigned multiple simultaneous missions. Doing so produces squadron elements with reduced combat power and limited effectiveness. However, the mission variables; Mission, Enemy, Terrain and Weather, Time Available, Troops Available, and Civil Considerations (METT-TC) may dictate the need to attach or place a ground or air troop under operational control of brigade to facilitate better command and control and the flow of information.

Organizations, Command and Staff Responsibilities

0133. The cavalry is organized in four basic designs:

a. Cavalry Squadron;

b. Armored Cavalry Troop;

c. Air cavalry squadron;

d. Armored Cavalry Troop (Separate).

0134. These designs reflect the role of the cavalry unit and the organizational characteristics of the parent unit. Table of Organization and Equipment (TOE) structures are further modified by major commands to meet operational, equipment, and personnel considerations. Each Cavalry unit applies doctrine within the Modification Table of Organization and Equipment (MTOE) capabilities it possesses.

Cavalry Squadron

0135. The cavalry squadron is a highly mobile, armor-protected force organized as part of the mechanized infantry divisions. The squadron operates primarily during wars and conflicts. The squadron can expect to perform reconnaissance and security operations in conditions characterized as follows:

a. Fluid and continuous;

b. Mobile;

c. Wide ranging; and

d. Firepower intensive.

0136. **Squadron Commander.** The squadron commander analyzes and restates the mission, designs the concept of operations, organizes the forces, and provides support to subordinate units. He issues mission orders with sufficient details for his subordinates to plan and lead their units. He acknowledges the professional competence and expertise of his subordinate commanders and allows them flexibility to accomplish their mission. He relies on his staff and subordinate commanders for advice and assistance in planning and supervising operations. He must understand their capabilities and limitations. He must train them to achieve his intent during his absence, the failure of communications, or changes in the situation.

0137. When not in battle, the commander operates from the vicinity of the Tactical Operations Center (TOC). At the TOC, he conducts his planning, interfaces with the staff, and rests. He frequently departs the TOC to conduct reconnaissance, inspect, receive orders, brief subordinates, and visit soldiers. During battle, the commander positions himself where he can best make decisions during critical points of the battle. He positions himself to follow and influence operations and maintains

communications with higher, lower, and adjacent units. When his organization or mission changes, he reorganizes as needed.

0138. Teamwork, functional Standard Operating Procedures (SOP), and a clear understanding of the mission, permit subordinates to quickly translate a mission order into action. The commander must know the enemy; his organization, his weapon systems, and how he fights. He must know the terrain over which his unit will fight and the adjacent terrain the enemy may use to support or reinforce. The commander must be aware of the operational limitations of his unit. He ensures air and ground cavalry efforts are fully synchronized to accomplish the mission.

0139. Once the operation starts, subsequent orders and quick responses are the norm. The orders must be simple and clear to enable swift execution upon receipt. The commander prepares to accept mission orders, and without further detailed instruction, takes action to execute the order within the intent of his commander. He limits the number of subordinates with whom he routinely deals. His staff refines raw data by filtering the information so that the commander can focus on the combat's critical information. Squadron commanders fight troops and track platoons.

0140. **Squadron Staff.** The staff consists of officers and enlisted soldiers who assist the commander in planning and supervising tactical operations. The staff reduces the demands on the commander's time and assists him by providing information, making estimates and recommendations, preparing plans and orders and supervising the execution of orders issued by the commander. The staff synchronizes combat support and combat service support operations to ensure total integration of support with the commander's concept. The staff also assists subordinate commanders by anticipating problems, providing informal staff responses when appropriate, and providing assistance in functional areas. The organization of a typical squadron staff is depicted in Figure 1-1. SOP defines the responsibilities of key personnel to preclude overlaps and to make sure all functions are adequately supervised.

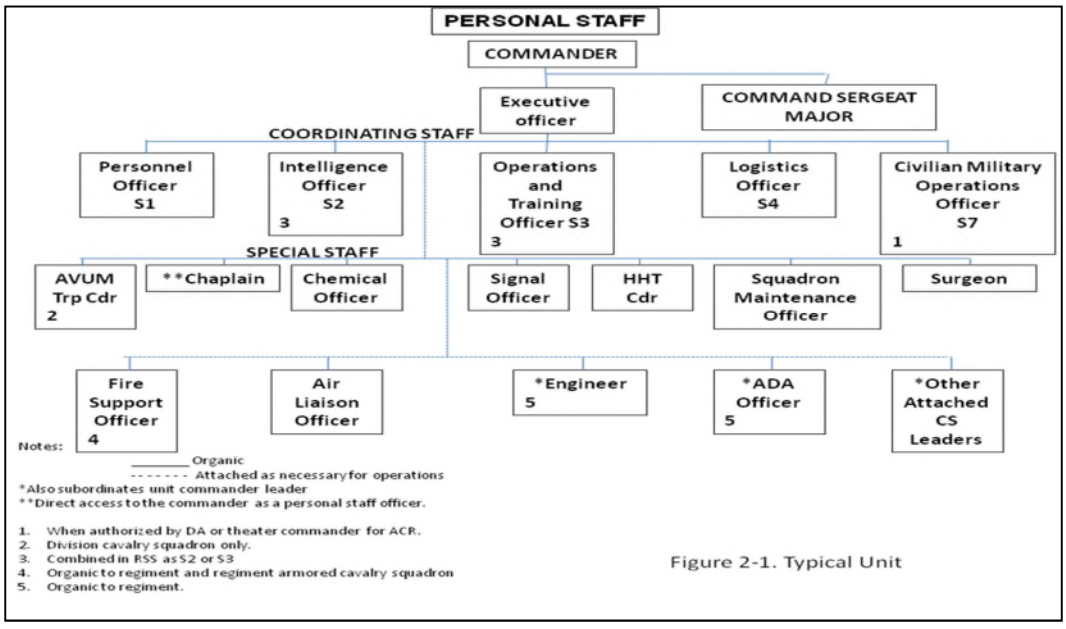


Figure 1.1 - Organization of a Typical Squadron Staff

0141. **Executive Officer (EX-O).** The EX-O is second in command and the principal assistant to the commander. He performs a variety of functions. He is responsible for the assignment of tasks and the efficient, coordinated, and prompt response of the staff. He directs, supervises, and ensures coordination of staff work except in those specific areas reserved by the commander, thereby freeing the commander from routine details. During combat operations, the EX-O is positioned in the TOC where he is responsible for its operation.

0142. The EX-O directs and coordinates combat support in consonance with the commander's plan and ensures continuous combat service support. The EX-O, assisted by the operations sergeant, maintains routine reporting, coordinates the activities of the liaison personnel, and is always planning ahead. The signal and air liaison officers work directly for the EX-O. During lulls in the battle, the EX-O may go to the trains and personally determine the status of combat service support operations. He remains current on the tactical situation and is prepared to assume command on a moment's notice. The commander trains the EX-O and allows him to command during training exercises to prepare him to assume command in combat.

0143. **Command Sergeant Major (CSM).**The CSM is the senior Non-Commissioned Officer (NCO) in the squadron. He acts in the name of the commander when dealing with the other NCOs in the unit and is the commander's primary advisor concerning the enlisted soldiers. He is not an administrator, but must understand the administrative/logistical and operational requirements of the squadron. He is the most experienced soldier in the squadron and keeps his finger on the pulse of the command. He focuses his attention on any function critical to the success of the operation. This requires that the CSM have mobility; he must be able to move where the commander needs him most. The commander establishes a close relationship with his CSM and defines his responsibilities and authority. The CSM assists the commander in the following ways:

a. Training troop first sergeants;

b. Monitoring NCO development, promotions, and assignments within the squadron;

c. Being directly involved in planning and assessing soldier training tasks. He ensures soldier training tasks are identified and trained to support the performance of collective (unit) mission essential task list (METL) tasks;

d. Monitoring the level of proficiency of training and morale of subordinate units;

e. Providing recommendations and expediting the procurement and preparation of replacements for subordinate units;

f. Monitoring food service and other logistical operations;

g. Conducting informal investigations;

h. Assisting in controlling squadron movement through a breach in a critical obstacle or at a river crossing;

i. Making coordination for a squadron passage of lines;

j. Leading the squadron advance/quartering party during a major movement; and

k. Assisting in the combat service support effort during the battle when the EX-O is in the TOC or forward.

0144. **Personnel Officer (S1).**The S1 has primary responsibility for all personnel matters. The S1 normally operates from the Combat Trains Command Post (CTCP) collocated with the S4. He moves as necessary to accomplish his mission. He shares supervisory responsibility for logistics with the S4. The S1 and S4 must cross-train to enable them to conduct continuous operations. The Squadron Level Personnel and Administrative Center (PAC) operates in the field trains under the supervision of the PAC supervisor. The PAC maintains contact with the S1 on the administrative/logistics net from the field trains command post. The S1 will take selected members of the section forward with him to assist in operating the CTCP.

0145. **Intelligence Officer (S2).** The S2 normally remains at the TOC where he has the communications assets to coordinate intelligence activities. He keeps the EX-O updated on the enemy situation and works closely with the Fire Support Element and Assistant S3 to ensure information is passed between the staff. The S2 is responsible for collecting and providing current information and analyzed intelligence of tactical value concerning terrain, weather, and enemy for all commanders and the remainder of the staff to facilitate planning and execution of combat operations. He is the expert on the enemy and understands in detail how he fights.

0146. He is closely involved in planning subsequent operations. The S2 converts the information requirements of the commander into Priority Intelligence Requirements (PIR) and ensures they are provided in the unit plan. He is also the facilitator of the Intelligence Preparation of the Battlefield (IPB) process. Working with the commander, operations officer, and other staff officers, the S2 participates in the development of the decision support template.

0147. **Operations Officer (S3).** The S3 is the commander's principal assistant for matters pertaining to the organization, employment, training, and operations of the unit and supporting elements. He also has a special relationship with the commander and normally has direct access for functional area matters. He monitors the battle, ensures the necessary combat support assets are provided when and where required, and anticipates developing situations. The S3, assisted by his Operations Sergeant and assistant, maintains routine reporting, coordinates the activities of liaison personnel, and is always planning ahead. The S3 and Air Liaison Officer/Assistant S3 remain responsive to directives from higher headquarters, the commander or EX-O, as well as the needs of subordinate commanders and supporting organizations.

0148. The S3 ensures that his soldiers and equipment are organized, trained, and maintained to support the EX-O in the TOC. In battle, the S3 is normally in the command group or on a secondary avenue of approach, axis of advance, or with the

supporting effort. If unit operations orient in several directions simultaneously, he may assume individual control of a part of the battlefield as directed by the commander. The S3 maintains close coordination with the S4 for combat service support status.

0149. **Supply Officer (S4).** Due to the unique environment of cavalry logistics, the squadron S4 is often employed differently from battalion S4s. The cavalry squadron S4 focuses on staff responsibilities that mirror the responsibilities of the Brigade S4. He provides logistics information to the squadron commander. He functions as the squadron's logistics planner. He coordinates with troop first sergeants and EX-Os about the status of equipment and supplies. He also coordinates with supporting units and higher headquarters staff to ensure that logistics support is continuous. The S4 is in charge of the CTCP.

0150. **Civil Military Operations (S7).** The S7 serves as the Principal Staff Officer for the commander in all matters concerning the civilian impact on military operations and the political, economic, and social effects of military operations on civilians. He has staff responsibility for those activities embracing the relationship among the military forces, the civil authorities, and people in the area of operations. The S7 has primary coordinating staff responsibility for the areas of civil affairs and civil-military operations. When the S7 is not authorized, the S3 usually assumes responsibility for these functions.

0151. **Air Liaison Officer.** The Air Liaison Officer (ALO) is an Air Force officer who is a member of the Tactical Air Control Party (TACP). The Air Liaison Officer moves with the commander as part of the command group. He may serve as a Forward Air Controller or have additional officers assigned to the TACP as Forward Air Controllers. He advises the commander and staff on the employment of offensive air support, including close air support, battlefield air interdiction, and joint suppression of enemy air defenses, aerial reconnaissance, and airlift.

0152. **Signal Officer.** The signal officer is a Signal Corps Officer. He normally works for the EX-O at squadron level. He operates from the TOC, advising the commander on all signal matters, including the location of command posts, signal facilities, best uses of signal assets, and the use of signal activities for deception. He monitors the maintenance status of organic signal equipment. Additionally, he coordinates the preparation and distribution of the Signal Operation Instructions (SOI) and supervises the communications security accounting activities.

0153. **Engineer Officer.** The Engineer Officer provides the commander and staff information on the enemy's engineer capabilities. The squadron engineer is the commander or leader of the direct support, attached, or operationally controlled engineer unit supporting the squadron. He is the commander's primary advisor on all engineer matters. Because of his duties, he cannot be at the squadron TOC continuously. He is in the TOC during planning and is part of the orders group. In the absence of an engineer unit, the S3 assumes responsibility for engineer functions.

0154. **Flight Operations Officer.** The Flight Operations Officer is part of the S3 section and works in the TOC for the S3. He is assisted by an NCO and Flight Operations Specialist. He is the operations expert on army aviation in the squadron.

He assists in planning and managing the integration of air cavalry in the squadron's scheme of maneuver. Some of his responsibilities are listed below:

a. Coordinate with the aviation brigade for aviation support;

b. Receive Army Airspace Command and Control (A2C2) control measures and directives from the aviation brigade or division A2C2 element;

c. Incorporate applicable A2C2 measures into the scheme of maneuver;

d. Maintain A2C2 overlay in squadron TOC;

e. Establish and monitor flight-following net (air traffic control net) for squadron aircraft, when required;

f. Maintain squadron flying hour program and monitor crew endurance;

g. Disseminate A2C2 changes to the Air Cavalry Troop (ACT) Commander;

h. Assist in operations of the S3 section;

i. Assist the S3 and the fire support officer (FSO) in planning required SEAD and J-SEAD fires;

0155. **Fire Support Officer.** The FSO is the commander's principal advisor and coordinator for fire support matters. His primary duty is to help the commander integrate all fires to support the scheme of maneuver. This includes planning, coordinating, and executing fire support. He is also responsible for coordinating with the S3 and the Flight Operations Officer for required SEAD and J-SEAD fires. He frequently moves with the commander during tactical operations to expedite fire support.

0156. The FSO coordinates the efforts of subordinate FSOs and maintains digital and voice communications to supporting artillery. The Fire Support Section (FSS) assists the FSO. In the armored cavalry regiment, the regimental and squadron FSO and FSS are organic at each level. Troop FSOs and Fire Support Teams (FIST) are organic to squadron howitzer batteries. In division cavalry, the fire support elements and troop FISTs are dedicated assets from division artillery.

0157. **HHT Commander.** The squadron HHT commander serves as the headquarters commandant for the main command post and answers directly to the squadron EX-O. The HHT commander is responsible for the support, security, and movement of the main command post and for supporting all elements of the HHT. He normally delegates the function of maintenance support to the HHT EX-O and the function of supply to the HHT first sergeant. Although he is a unit commander, not a staff officer, the squadron HHT commander fulfills a unique role.

0158. **Liaison Officer.** Liaison officers are in the S3 section of the squadron. They represent the commander at the headquarters of another unit for effecting coordination and for promoting cooperation between the two units. Through personal

contact, they facilitate the exchange of information and ensure mutual understanding and unity of purpose before, during, and after combat operations. Liaison officers operate from the TOC where they are normally briefed and debriefed by the EX-O or TOC shift leader.

0159. **Squadron Maintenance Officer (SMO).** The SMO is responsible for coordinating all activities including recovery, evacuation, repair, and replacement of combat equipment to sustain the operational readiness of the squadron. The SMO is responsible for all ground tactical equipment. The SMO coordinates and supervises the efforts of the squadron maintenance platoon and exercises staff supervision over unit maintenance in the troops. He also functions as the Maintenance Platoon Leader. During combat, the SMO operates from the combat trains or a Unit Maintenance Collecting Point (UMCP). In the absence of the S4, he controls the combat trains.

Air Cavalry Squadron

0160. The Air Cavalry Squadron is a highly mobile, armed force organized as part of air assault divisions. It is equipped with Air Cavalry Troop. The squadron is structured light to possess the same strategic mobility as the parent division. When deployed, the squadron possesses a significant mobility advantage over the infantry battalions of the division.

Armored Cavalry Troop

0161. The ACT is the maneuver element of the squadron. It is composed of two Scout Platoons and two Light Tank Platoons that can be deployed depending on the type of enemy they are confronting. The composition was designed to be able to confront either enemy infantry units or tank units when doing their mission. The leaders at troop and company level perform functions similar to their squadron counterparts.

0162. **Troop Commander.** The Troop Commander analyzes and restates the mission, designs the concept of operations, organizes the forces, and provides support to its platoons. He issues mission orders with sufficient details for his subordinate to plan and lead their units. He acknowledges the professional competence and expertise of his platoon leaders and allows them flexibility to accomplish their mission. In the troop level, planning and preparation for military operations relies solely on the troop commander since he doesn’t have the complete staff to do so.

0163. During battle, the troop commander positions himself where he can best make decisions during critical points of the battle. He positions himself to follow and influence operations and maintain communications with higher, lower, and adjacent units. When his organization or mission changes, he reorganizes as needed. Teamwork, functional SOPs, and a clear understanding of the mission, permit subordinates to quickly translate a mission order into action. The troop commander must know the enemy; his organization, his weapon systems, and how he fights. He must know the terrain over which his unit will fight and the adjacent terrain the enemy may use to support or reinforce. The commander must be aware of the operational limitations of his unit. The troop commander prepares to accept mission

orders, and without further detailed instructions, takes action to execute the order within the intent of his commander.

0164. **Troop Executive Officer (EX-O).** As second in command, the troop EX-O supervises operations from the troop command post. The EX-O is also assigned a combat vehicle so he can quickly assume command of the cavalry troop in case the commander becomes a casualty or if the mission requires his presence forward. He stays abreast of the tactical situation within the squadron and troop. He manages the flow of combat information between the troop and squadron. He advises the commander, represents him in his absence, and prepares to assume command. The EX-O ensures that organic and supporting combat support assets are continuously synchronized with the troop's scheme of maneuver. With assistance from the troop first sergeant, he plans and coordinates combat service support for the troop.

0165. **First Sergeant.** The Troop First Sergeant is primarily responsible for sustaining the troop's ability to fight. He supervises the procurement and distribution of fuel, ammunition, food, water, clothing, equipment, replacements, and repair parts. He receives personnel replacements and assigns them to subordinate elements as needed. He is also responsible for the evacuation and recovery of damaged combat equipment. He supervises NCO development and soldier training. As a troubleshooter and advisor, he assists the commander in tactical operations as needed.

0166. **Platoon Leader**. The Platoon Leader is responsible to the commander for the discipline, combat readiness, welfare, and training of the platoon as well as the maintenance of its equipment. He must be proficient in the tactical employment of the platoon. He must also know the capabilities and limitations of the platoon's personnel and equipment. The platoon leader's responsibility in combat is twofold: 1) Accomplish all missions assigned to the platoon in accordance with the troop commander's intent. 2) Preserve the fighting capability of the platoon.

0167. **Platoon Sergeant.** The Platoon Sergeant leads elements of the platoon as directed by the platoon leader and assumes command of the platoon in the absence of the platoon leader. The platoon sergeant assists the platoon leader in maintaining discipline, training, and controlling the platoon in combat. He supervises the maintenance of equipment, supply, and other combat service support matters. He advises the platoon leader as required.

0168. **Mortar Section Sergeant.** The Mortar Section Sergeant is responsible for providing indirect fires to support the troop commander's concept of the operation. He trains, supervises, and maintains the mortar section and its equipment.

0169. **Supply Sergeant.** The Supply Sergeant requisitions, picks up, transports, and issues or stores supplies and equipment for the troop. He supervises the troop supply section. He works closely with the first sergeant to accomplish these tasks. He evacuates enemy prisoners of war and assists in evacuating Killed in Action (KIA) remains.

0170. **Maintenance Sergeant**. The Maintenance Sergeant supervises prompt recovery of damaged or inoperable equipment on the battlefield. He leads the troop

maintenance section. He works closely with the first sergeant to accomplish these tasks.

0171. **Communications Sergeant.** The Communications Sergeant prepares the troop command post and its assigned crew for combat operations. He assists the EX-O in the troop command post during combat operations. Where no command post is authorized, he operates out of the combat trains. Within his capability, he repairs communications equipment of subordinate elements. He is responsible for distributing the unit SOI and Communication Security (COMSEC) equipment.

Armored Cavalry Troop (Separate)

0172. The ACT(S) is organized as part of separate light and armored brigades. It is heavy or light depending on the organization of the brigade. It operates for the brigade commander in the operational environments for which the brigade is focused. The ACT(S) differs from an ACT since it can operate without the support of a squadron. It has its own maintenance section to sustain its operation. The troop commander and troop staffs of ACT (S) have the same responsibilities with that of ACT units.

Command and Control

0173. Cavalry organizations are often required to begin their missions and to operate very soon after (or even before) the receipt of an operation order (OPORD). A command and control system permitting such flexibility and freedom to operate independently emphasizes certain specific operational techniques and command practices. First, it optimizes the use of time by routine use of warning orders, situation updates, and parallel/anticipatory planning.

0174. Second, it stresses standardized training in operations and staff practices to assure mutual understanding between leaders and units. Third, command and control eases execution of orders using standard language, symbols, and SOPs. Fourth, the system allows the commander to position himself wherever the situation calls for his personal presence without depriving him of the ability to respond to opportunities or changing situations.

0175. The cavalry commander cannot expect constant or close supervision by his higher commander. Cavalry operations occur across wide areas and commanders normally operate with significant freedom of action. Close command direction is seldom possible, even when desired. Each commander in turn must provide his subordinates freedom of action for the same reason. Unity of effort is ensured by the intent of the commander assigning the mission.

0176. Each subordinate commander must understand the intent of the commander two levels above him and the concept of his immediate commander. They exercise initiative within the latitude permitted to achieve the intent as battlefield conditions develop. The extent and variety of the tasks confronting a commander require the cooperative endeavors of many people, the integration of many complex equipment

systems, and a sensible division of work. The mission command system accomplishes these tasks through three interrelated components and are explained further in PAM 3-02:

a. Command and control organization

b. Command and control process

c. Command and control facilities and communications

Command and Control Communications

0177. Communication is essential to cavalry operations. Fundamental to reconnaissance and security is the reporting of combat information. This information is of interest to other maneuver units as well as to division staffs and requires widest dissemination possible by eavesdrop or other means. The cavalry frequently operates over long distances, wide frontages, extended depths, and great distances from the controlling headquarters. Communications must be redundant and long range to meet these internal and external requirements.

0178. In division cavalry, operational requirements may employ the squadron under different controlling headquarters. These conditions require the squadron to have the flexibility to communicate on division as well as brigade nets. The squadron requires the equivalent communications capability of a brigade.

0179. Communications, particularly electromagnetic, are subject to disruption. Disruption may result from unintentional friendly interference, intentional enemy action, equipment failure, atmospheric conditions, nuclear blast electromagnetic pulse, or terrain interference. To compensate for these, the commander should:

a. Provide for redundancy in means of communication

b. Ensure that subordinates understand his intent so they know what to do during communications interruptions

c. Avoid overloading the communications systems

d. Minimize the use of the radio and

e. Ensure proper signals security and communications security practices are followed.

0180. **Responsibilities.** All levels of command gain and maintain communications with the necessary headquarters and personnel. The traditional communications responsibilities are listed below.

a. **Senior to subordinate**. A senior unit is responsible for establishing communications with a subordinate unit. An attached unit of any size is considered subordinate to the command to which it is attached

b. **Supporting to supported**. A supporting unit is responsible for establishing communications with the supported unit

c. **Reinforcing to reinforced**. A reinforcing unit is responsible for establishing communications with the reinforced unit

d. **Passing to stationary**. Forward passage of lines

e. **Stationary to passing**. Rearward passage of lines

f. **Lateral communications.** Responsibility for establishing communications between adjacent units may be fixed by the next higher commander or SOP. If responsibility is not fixed by orders, the commander of the unit on the left is responsible for establishing communications with the unit on the right. The commander of a unit positioned behind another unit establishes communications with the forward unit; and

g. **Restoration**. Regardless of the responsibility, all units take prompt action to restore lost communications.

0181. **Means of Communication.** Cavalry uses the full spectrum of communication means.

a. Wire. Wire is normally used for internal communications within the command post, support areas, and assembly areas. It is the primary means of communication whenever the situation permits.

b. Sound and Visual. Sound and visual signals are in the SOI or the unit SOP. Signals not included in the SOI may be established by SOP. The battlefield will have many sound and visual cues. Commanders and staff planners carefully determine how sound and visual signals will be used and authenticated. Sound and visual signals include pyrotechnics, hand-and-arm, flag, metal-on-metal, rifle shot, whistles, and bells.

c. Commercial Lines. Commercial lines are used when approved by higher headquarters. If the unit is forced to withdraw, existing wire lines, including commercial lines, are cut and sections removed so the enemy cannot use them.

d. Radio. Cavalry operations normally depend on radio as the primary means of communication. This is particularly so during reconnaissance and security missions. Net discipline and SOP minimize needless traffic. To avoid detection by enemy direction finding equipment, cavalry uses all other means

of communication to supplement the radio. Once in contact, the primary means of communication will be FM voice. Radio communications include electromagnetic communications in FM, AM, UHF, and VHF spectrums.

0182. **Communications Security.** Communications Security or COMSEC involves physical security, crypto security, and transmission security. COMSEC procedures must be covered in the unit SOP.

0183. Physical security protects the crypto system and classified documents (including plain-language copies of messages and carbons) from capture or loss. Before an area is vacated, soldiers inspect for messages, carbons, cipher tapes, and copies of maps or orders. Wire lines are patrolled to prevent enemy tapping. When SOI codes or cryptographic equipment is lost or captured, the unit reports the facts promptly to the next higher command. The SOP must contain instructions for destruction of equipment and classified documents to prevent their capture or use by the enemy. Complete SOIs should not be carried forward of the squadron TOC. When necessary, the signal officer distributes extracts for use by forward elements. The SOP establishes priority for issue of SOIs and extracts.

0184. Crypto security is maintained by using operation codes, numerical encryption devices, secure voice devices, and other secure communications equipment. Transmission security limits the enemy's ability to listen to radio signals. Any signal transmitted can be intercepted and jammed by the enemy. All transmissions should be short and treated as if the enemy were listening. Net discipline is the responsibility of all users, but the net control station is responsible for policing the net. Brevity codes, the terrain index reference system, and coded reports all serve to reduce net traffic.

Chapter II
Reconnaissance Operations

0201. Reconnaissance is a mission undertaken to obtain information by visual observation, or other detection methods, about the activities and resources of an enemy, or about the meteorologic, hydrographic, or geographic characteristics of a particular area. Reconnaissance produces combat information. Combat information is a by-product of all operations, acquired as they are in progress. Reconnaissance, however, is a focused collection effort. It is performed before and during other combat operations to provide information used by the commander to confirm or modify his concept. The cavalry is the division commander's principal reconnaissance organization.

0202. The cavalry performs reconnaissance as organized, but it may be reinforced. Cavalry combines mounted, dismounted, and aerial techniques to accomplish the mission. Integrated air and ground troop operations provide an increased tempo of reconnaissance, depth, and flexibility. Habitually integrated operations are critical in division cavalry. Both ground and air commanders habitually dismount scouts for close reconnaissance and stealth.

0203. Reconnaissance involves two contrasting methods, first is reconnaissance by stealth. Using this method, cavalry avoids physical contact with the enemy and their information by quiet, deliberate, dismounted techniques. Surveillance is the primary task performed. The second method is aggressive reconnaissance and fighting for information as necessary. Using this method, the cavalry avoids decisive engagement but prepares to fight, especially enemy security and reconnaissance forces, to gain information. This method does not have to be as stealthy and may proceed at a faster pace.

0204. Historically, the best way for cavalry to obtain information on the enemy has been aggressive action requiring combat; in other words, fighting for information. Fighting for information means employing reconnaissance by fire, attacking the enemy with fire, and conducting hasty attacks with subordinate units. Fighting for information does not entail units as a whole becoming decisively engaged, conducting deliberate attacks, or assaulting a prepared position. By fighting for information, cavalry forces the enemy to disclose not only his disposition but also to reveal his intent and will to fight.

0205. The cavalry needs the capability to perform reconnaissance using both methods. Scouts require vehicles and aircraft that allow reconnaissance by stealth and the ability to fight when necessary. The troop and squadron support the scouts with tanks or other heavier vehicles, attack helicopters, and fire support, which provide the primary fighting capability.

0206. The distances at which cavalry operates from the main body and the fluid nature of reconnaissance operations place additional unique requirements on cavalry organizations. They require vehicles with an extended operating range and increased

on-board storage capacity to reduce the burden on a stretched service support system. Extended self-sustainment reduces constraints imposed by a logistics tail.

0207. Cavalry requires long-range communications, internally and externally, to ensure adequate command and control and reporting over extended distances. Information that cannot be reported is no use to the division commander. A mobility differential, air and ground, over the main body of the division is the foundation of flexible, extended, and unfettered reconnaissance. This mobility is enhanced by effective long-range communications and an organizational structure reducing reliance on outside support. These factors taken together enable cavalry to respond rapidly, to operate over large distances, and to reconnoiter as organized.

0208. Surveillance is a primary task of the cavalry during reconnaissance operations. Surveillance is the systematic observation of airspace or surface areas by visual, aural, electronic, photographic, or other means. Scouts, ground and air, are the principal collectors of information. Scouts conduct surveillance using their natural senses. They require equipment that enhances their senses, allowing them to conduct mounted and dismounted surveillance with stealth, at long ranges, and in limited visibility.

Purpose and Fundamentals

0209. Cavalry does not perform a reconnaissance mission for its own sake. The cavalry performs reconnaissance for another friendly force to provide it fresh, accurate information about the terrain and enemy within the area. Reconnaissance is an inherent part of security and other combat missions. Reconnaissance allows the follow-on forces to maneuver more freely and rapidly to the objective. Reconnaissance allows the higher commander to keep other forces free from contact as long as possible and concentrated for the decisive engagement.

Fundamentals

0210. Successful reconnaissance operations are planned and performed with six fundamentals in mind:

a. Maximum reconnaissance force forward;

b. Orient on the location or movement of the reconnaissance objective;

c. Report all information rapidly and accurately

d. Retain freedom to maneuver

e. Gain and maintain enemy contact and

f. Develop the situation rapidly

0211. **Maximum Reconnaissance Force Forward.** In reconnaissance, every scout makes a difference. Cavalry often conducts reconnaissance over extended frontages and requires the maximum number of scouts forward to perform the mission. Cavalry units normally do not keep scout platoons or aero scouts in reserve. Extended

operations may require commanders to rotate scouts or otherwise plan rest and resupply operations to maintain a continuous reconnaissance effort. This does not mean scouts are always arrayed in a linear fashion. Depth is essential, especially in restricted terrain or in a contaminated environment. Depth is often achieved through integrated air and ground scout actions.

0212. **Orient on the Location or Movement of the Reconnaissance Objective.** The commander focuses on the efforts of the unit with a reconnaissance objective. This objective may be a terrain feature, control measure, or enemy force. If the enemy force is moving, the unit adjusts the scheme of maneuver to maintain orientation on the enemy. IPB may identify the reconnaissance objective. Commanders remain focused on reaching the reconnaissance objective regardless of what is encountered during the mission. Capabilities and limitations of the unit are a significant factor influencing how aggressively the commander attempts to reach the objective.

0213. **Report All Information Rapidly and Accurately.** The cavalry performs reconnaissance to gather information. Higher commanders need this information to confirm or make decisions. Combat information loses value quickly. Absence of the enemy is just as important as his presence. Scouts report exactly what they see. Troop and squadron commanders clarify and summarize, but do not delete raw information reported by the scouts. Seemingly, unimportant information may be extremely important in context with other information not available to the squadron. Negative reports may tell more than positive reports or no report at all. IPB helps to focus reconnaissance efforts by identifying critical information required by the division. Communications equipment must be adequate to allow for an uninterrupted flow of information.

0214. **Retain Freedom to Maneuver.** Cavalry units must retain the ability to maneuver on the battlefield to continue the reconnaissance mission. Decisive engagement occurs when a unit is fully committed and cannot maneuver or extricate itself. When this happens, reconnaissance ceases. Use of proper movement techniques, over watch, and good reconnaissance technique helps to prevent decisive engagement. IPB provides information used by leaders to anticipate locations of likely contact. Leaders remain abreast of the overall situation and anticipate tactical developments. Mental agility allows the leaders to dictate events, not merely react to enemy action.

0215. **Gain and Maintain Enemy Contact.** Information on the enemy is always critical. Unreported enemy actions can have decisive impact on friendly operations. The enemy is seldom static and changing situations must be reported to the commander. Contact is any condition ranging from a surveillance sighting to engaging in close combat. Surveillance is often sufficient and is the preferred method of maintaining contact. When necessary or required, fire and movement may be used. Once gained, contact is not lost unless ordered. Responsibility for maintaining contact does not rest solely with the scout or small unit that first gains it. Troop, and squadron commanders are responsible for maintaining contact using all the resources available to them.

0216. **Develop the Situation Rapidly.** During reconnaissance, the cavalry frequently and repeatedly encounters tactical situations that require action to

determine what is being faced. These situations may be terrain oriented, obstacles, or enemy. Terrain or obstacle situations require close reconnaissance bypass hasty breach, if necessary and marking. If an enemy force is encountered, the cavalry determines his size, composition, dispositions, and activities. IPB provides the threat situational information that guides the effort. Reconnaissance techniques, often in the form of drills, are used while developing the situation.

Actions on Contact

0217. Actions on contact are a series of combat actions taken on contact with the enemy to develop the situation. Obstacles are treated like enemy contact since they are assumed to be covered by fire. The element making contact initiates these actions and they occur at each level of command, often simultaneously. Units perform these actions whether or not the enemy has detected the presence of the scout. Actions on contact are as follows:

a. Deploy and report

b. Develop the situation

c. Choose a course of action and

d. Recommend or execute a course of action.

0218. **Deploy and Report.** Upon encountering an obstacle or enemy force, the element of the troop making contact deploys to a covered position affording observation and fields of fire. If necessary, the element uses direct fire to suppress the enemy, allowing freedom to maneuver. An immediate contact report is submitted with whatever information is available. This report alerts the commander and allows him to begin necessary actions.

0219. **Develop the Situation.** The leader of the element in contact develops the situation to define the threat being faced, using various reconnaissance techniques as appropriate. These techniques range from stealthy dismounted reconnaissance, mounted reconnaissance, and reconnaissance by fire - both direct and indirect. The troop or squadron commander continues the mission with other elements to a designated limit of advance. Doing so, helps to develop the situation across the front and provides more maneuver space to execute subsequent action. Once a clearer picture of the situation is developed, detailed spot reports are forwarded.

0220. **Choose a Course of Action.** Once the leader in contact has gathered enough information to make a decision, he selects a course of action. The course of action should adhere to the intent of the commander, be within the capability of the unit, and allow the unit to resume the mission as soon as possible. For an obstacle, these courses of action are a hasty breach or bypass. For enemy contact, courses of action consist of the following:

a. **Hasty attack.** A hasty attack is executed if sufficient combat power is available, and if it will not detract from mission accomplishment. A hasty attack is executed by at least a troop, which can mass adequate combat power.

b. **Bypass.** The enemy may be bypassed if sufficient combat power is not available, or if an attack will jeopardize mission accomplishment. The unit requests permission to bypass unless stated in the orders. The commander must keep a minimum force in contact with the bypassed enemy.

c. **Hasty defense.** If a hasty attack is not possible or a bypass is not feasible, the leader establishes a hasty defense or screen. The unit will conduct a hasty defense if it can defend against an enemy force. If the enemy contact exceeds the unit's capability to defend, it may elect to establish a screen and maintain contact through observation. The unit concentrates on maintaining contact with the enemy and fixing it in place with indirect or possibly direct fire until additional combat power can be brought to bear from supporting units.

0221. **Recommend a Course of Action.** Once the leader has selected a course of action, he reports it to his commander. The commander approves or disapproves the course of action based on its impact on the overall mission. The SOP may provide automatic approval of certain actions to avoid unnecessary delay. If the higher commander assumes responsibility to continue developing the situation, the leader in contact supports his actions as ordered.

Reconnaissance Techniques

0222. Reconnaissance techniques are the basic methods of using available equipment and personnel to accomplish reconnaissance tasks. These techniques fall into the broad categories of aerial, mounted, and dismounted reconnaissance. They are used in combination to meet the needs of the situation. Units train in standards on reconnaissance techniques, apply them with common sense, and make them part of the unit SOP. Techniques prevent reconnaissance that is blind, reckless, or blundering. Troop commander plan on using a combination of mounted and dismounted reconnaissance. Mounted reconnaissance is appropriate when:

a. Time is limited

b. Detailed reconnaissance is not required

c. An air cavalry troop is performing coordinated reconnaissance

d. IPB provides good information on the enemy and

e. Terrain is open

0223. Dismounted reconnaissance is appropriate when:

a. Time is available

b. Detailed reconnaissance is required

c. Stealth is required

d. IPB indicates close proximity to enemy positions

e. Enemy contact is expected or has been achieved

f. Danger areas are encountered

g. Restrictive terrain is encountered and

h. Security is the primary concern.

0224. Reconnaissance by fire is a method of reconnaissance in which fire is placed on a suspected enemy position to cause the enemy to disclose his presence by movement or return fire. This technique is appropriate when time is critical, while developing the situation once in contact, or when mounted or dismounted maneuver is not possible.

0225. During reconnaissance by fire, scouts maintain surveillance of the known or suspected enemy position looking for a reaction. Any surprise maintained to that point will be lost. Reconnaissance by fire may not cause seasoned or prepared enemy forces to react. Either direct or indirect fire is used (see Table 2-1). Reconnaissance by fire entails the risk that the unit may precipitate a decisive engagement. The unit commander may use reconnaissance by fire when:

a. Time is critical;

b. Natural or man-made obstacles are encountered and could be overmatched by an enemy force;

c. A suspected enemy position fits the situation template;

d. Bunker complexes that may or may not be occupied are encountered; and

e. Enemy locations are known.

Table 2.1 - Reconnaissance by fire

	ADVANTAGES	**DISADVANTAGES**
DIRECT FIRE	Rapid Response.	Sacrifices stealth and discloses friendly positions.
	Accuracy.	Low volume of fire may reveal intention.
	Minimum communications required.	Observation capability by firing vehicle reduced.
	Fire can be delivered from different directions.	Limited by the range of direct-fire weapons and ammunition availability.

INDIRECT FIRE	Security for the scout directing the fire and observing the enemy action. Permits all scout elements to observe effects Wider variety of ammunition available for the mission. More likely to force enemy movement.	Slower to deliver initial round. Usually requires adjustment for accuracy. Mortar or Artillery ammunition available. Less likely to cause the enemy to return fire.

0226. Troops encounter repetitive tactical situations during reconnaissance that lend themselves readily to establishment as techniques. These situations include certain terrain features, bridges, water obstacles, built-up areas, man-made obstacles, and forested areas.

0227. Limited visibility operations are conducted at night and during other periods of reduced visibility. These periods include smoke and battlefield obscuration, fog, rain, snow, and other weather or atmospheric conditions. These conditions affect air and ground troops in different manners. Air cavalry troops may also be adversely affected by high winds, extreme temperature, and loose top soil or sand. Reconnaissance during limited visibility is generally slower, but often is better for stealth.

0228. The capabilities of a unit's equipment is a major factor in assessing the extent of degradation suffered. Dismounted reconnaissance and patrols are more frequent, night and thermal observation devices employed, and electronic surveillance devices and ground surveillance radars are used. Engines and tracked movements are audible for considerable distances at night, making vehicles highly susceptible to ambush. Cross-country movement is more difficult, and except for short cross-country movements, mounted reconnaissance may focus on road networks. Sound and light discipline prevents compromise and ambush.

0229. Commanders should emphasize greater depth and concentration of scouts in critical areas during operations in a contaminated environment. Scouts and cavalry units are trained to detect and reconnoiter contaminated areas and to perform damage control in a Nuclear, Biological, Chemical (NBC) environment. Likewise, reconnaissance by cavalry units is critical in nuclear warfare. Cavalry can reconnoiter the effects of either friendly or enemy nuclear fires and determine how and where friendly units can exploit.

Route Reconnaissance

0230. A route reconnaissance is a directed effort to obtain detailed information of a specified route and all terrain from which the enemy could influence movement along that route. A route is the prescribed course to be traveled from a specific point of origin to a specific destination. Route reconnaissance may orient on a road or on an axis of advance. This mission is appropriate when a commander wants to use a route.
0231. He must first ensure that it is clear of obstacles and enemy and that it will support the proposed forces before he uses it. Route reconnaissance may be performed as a mission itself or as a task during another mission. Route reconnaissance proceeds faster than zone reconnaissance because effort is concentrated along the route and terrain that the enemy can use to dominate movement along the route.

0232. Route reconnaissance is seldom performed by a squadron. The squadron obtains route information as part of another mission or by assigning the task to a troop. Reconnaissance of a specific route may be a specified task for a troop during zone reconnaissance. Only one major route should be assigned to a troop when contact is expected. Under other circumstances, the troop may reconnoiter one route per assigned scout platoon. Multiple routes must be close enough together for the troop commander to effectively command and control the operation. Integrated air and ground troop reconnaissance provides for faster and more secure reconnaissance.

Critical Tasks

0233. Certain tasks must be accomplished during route reconnaissance unless the squadron commander specifically directs otherwise. Critical tasks serve as a guide to indicate those tasks that are associated with a route reconnaissance. These tasks are not a checklist or sequentially arranged. Some may not be appropriate in all situations. Based on time and the commander’s intent, the troop may be directed to reconnoiter for specific information only. IPB often indicates the critical information desired by the higher commander. An air cavalry troop may be directed to accomplish some tasks and a ground troop to accomplish others. The following are critical tasks:

a. Reconnoiters and determine the trafficability of the route

b. Reconnoiters all terrain the enemy can use to dominate movement along the route

c. Reconnoiters all built-up areas along the route

d. Reconnoiters all lateral routes

e. Inspects and evaluates all bridges on the route

f. Locates fords or crossing sites near all bridges on the route

g. Inspects and evaluates all overpasses, underpasses, and culverts

h. Reconnoiters all defiles along the route. Clear all defiles of enemy and obstacles within capability or locate a bypass

i. Locate and clear the route of mines, obstacles, and barriers within its capability

j. Locate a bypass around built-up areas, obstacles, and contaminated areas

k. Finds and reports all enemies that can influence movement along the route;
l. Reports route information.

0234. Determining trafficability of a route requires the troop to determine the capability or extent to which the terrain will bear traffic or permit continued movement of a force. Modern roadway features are often difficult to quickly evaluate in the process of route reconnaissance. In some cases, the troop assesses the capability of the feature to accommodate the follow-on forces. The troop does not conduct a deliberate engineer route classification. Engineers can provide a detailed route and obstacle classification effort and reduce obstacles as required. The route reconnaissance performed by the troop allows the engineers to proceed faster and to focus more on specific points of interest along the route.

Planning Considerations

0235. The squadron commander assigns the mission to the troop as a mission or specific task in another mission. This section discusses route reconnaissance in the context of an assigned troop mission. This mission may be assigned to a ground or air cavalry troop. The ground cavalry provides a more deliberate and detailed reconnaissance, particularly in close terrain.

0236. Air cavalry is effective when speed is essential and the terrain is open. This mission lends itself readily to formation of air and ground teams in division cavalry. Teams provide a thorough and fast reconnaissance effort. The squadron commander normally provides the following guidance to the troop commanders: critical tasks to be accomplished by air and ground elements of the reconnaissance team, when used. Any tasks that may be deleted during the reconnaissance are identified.

0237. Task organization. Any reinforcements, especially engineers, and their relationship to the troop are identified. Supporting artillery relationships are also defined.

a. Start point, release point, and designation of the route.

b. Mission to be performed at the start point and after reaching the release point.

c. Time the mission is to start and, if required, to be completed.

d. Critical points along the route identified as checkpoints.

e. IPB information on the route and enemy situation.

f. Any constraints or restrictions.

0238. The troop commander considers several factors in formulating his concept. IPB provides critical information on the enemy and terrain. Enemy threats may be encountered in two basic forms:

a. Ambushes along the route in close or restricted terrain.

b. Attack by long-range direct or indirect fires from dominating terrain along the route.

0239. Analysis of the terrain provides an indication of danger areas and the nature of the potential threat. From this information, the commander determines how much terrain on each flank of the route must be reconnoitered and the organization for combat. Any constraints or restrictions may also influence how much terrain is reconnoitered.

0240. The troop commander adds control measures to provide an adequate framework for the mission (see Figure 2-1). He places a boundary on both sides of the route far enough out to provide reconnaissance of the dominating terrain. A line of departure is placed perpendicular to the route short of the start point, allowing adequate space to deploy into formation. A limit of advance is placed far enough beyond the release point to enclose dominating terrain that overmatches it. He uses additional phase lines to maintain a coordinated troop reconnaissance. Boundaries and phase lines are drawn along recognizable terrain.

0241. The terrain features should be identifiable from ground and air to assist air-ground coordination. Checkpoints placed along the route control movement and indicate critical points. The commander uses other control measures as necessary for control and maneuver flexibility.

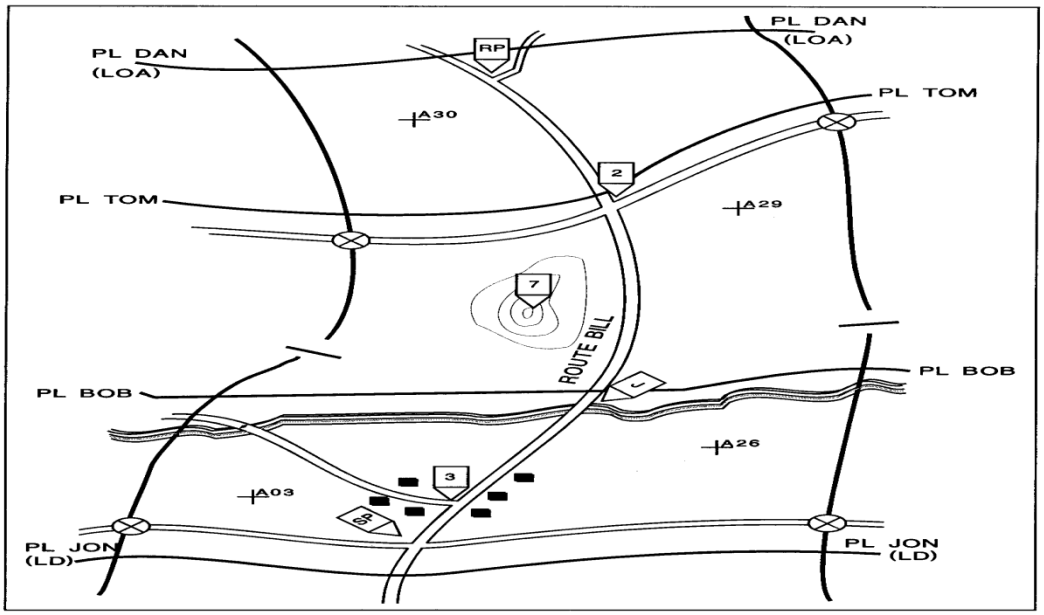


Figure 2.1 - Route Reconnaissance (Troop Graphics)

0242. The cavalry troop normally performs a tactical road march to the line of departure for the route reconnaissance. The amount of intelligence indicates how

much security the commander uses during the move. Enemies that are encountered reroute to the line of departure, may be bypassed. Upon completion of the mission, the troop may depart the area, screen along the limit of advance, or perform another mission, such as zone reconnaissance. Consideration of follow-on missions may influence the concept for performing the route reconnaissance.

0243. When reconnoitering one route, the commander assigns one scout platoon to reconnoiter the route itself. He places the other scout platoon to the side of the route to reconnoiter the dominating terrain. This flank platoon essentially performs zone reconnaissance and may precede the platoon on the route to provide it greater security.

0244. The mortars follow the lead scouts to provide fires up to two-thirds of their effective range forward of the scouts. They may move off the route to avoid interfering with the scout platoon on the route. Mortars maybe displaced by squads to provide continuous fire support. They remain in depth to retain flexibility for the troop commander in responding to enemy contact.

0245. In the absence of tanks, the troop commander may use a scout platoon in this role. The troop combat trains and command post follow, moving generally along the route displacing successive positions. These follow-on troop elements move along the route for speed, but are always displaced off the route when occupying positions. The troop commander is located forward to observe and control the reconnaissance effort.

0246. Engineer reconnaissance elements tasks organized to the troop can provide both tactical and technical information to the troop commander. The engineer reconnaissance elements focus on specific obstacles, bridges, and minefield, for example, adding to the quality of the battlefield information reports. The EX-O compiles reports and provides updated route reconnaissance information to the squadron. Route report formats are established by the SOP.

0247. When reconnoitering multiple routes, the commander assigns one route to each scout platoon. The troop may be augmented with an engineer reconnaissance element to facilitate technical and tactical reconnaissance. One route is the maximum that may be handled by a scout platoon. The commander follows one platoon, usually the main effort, on one route and the EX-O follows the other route. Considerations for other assets remain the same.

0248. When reconnoitering a ground route, the air troop commander considers the same factors of IPB and control measures as the ground troop commander. Scout weapon teams are normally assigned to reconnoiter the terrain on the flanks of the route while another scout weapon team concentrates on the route itself. Frequent dismounting is often necessary to reconnoiter specific route features.

0249. The disadvantages of air cavalry troops are: limited personnel available for dismounted reconnaissance; limited ability to reconnoiter close terrain, and difficulty in determining actual route traffic ability. An air cavalry troop is ideal, however, to reassess a previously reconnoitered route to determine if it remains trafficable and clear of enemy. A route may be too long for the troop to reconnoiter without rotating

teams through a Forward Arming and Refueling Point (FARP). When the commander does so, he must always maintain at least one team in zone.

0250. In the cavalry, air and ground teams are well suited for route reconnaissance. The air cavalry may facilitate the route reconnaissance by reconnoitering the terrain on the flanks of the route, forward of the ground troop, between assigned troop routes, or by screening an exposed flank. The air troop may also quickly reconnoiter key points along the route to assist the ground troop. The ground troop concentrates on determining route trafficability and reconnaissance of close terrain. Air and ground troop commanders coordinate control measures so they are useful for both and enhance mutual support.

0251. An air cavalry troop may be assigned an air route reconnaissance mission. The principles are the same as those for a ground route. Aviation forces moving along an air route are primarily concerned with the location of enemy forces, ease of navigation, suitability of landing zones, and hazards to flight. Hazards to flight include natural and man-made obstacles, such as buildings, wires, mountainous areas, and enemy air defense weapons locations.

Zone Reconnaissance

0252. A zone reconnaissance is a directed effort to obtain detailed information concerning all routes, obstacles, terrain, and enemy forces within a zone defined by boundaries. A zone reconnaissance is assigned when the enemy situation is vague or when information concerning cross-country trafficability is desired. The commander, through his intent, may focus the reconnaissance on the enemy, the terrain, or a combination of the two.

0253. Additionally, the commander may focus the reconnaissance effort on specific enemy force. It is appropriate when previous knowledge of the terrain is limited or when combat operations have altered the terrain. The commander assigning the mission needs this information before other forces enter the zone. Zone reconnaissance may be oriented on the main body’s zone of action or an axis of advance.

0254. Zone reconnaissance is a deliberate, time-consuming process. This mission takes more time than any other reconnaissance mission. The cavalry commander must ensure he has been given adequate time to accomplish the mission. If not, he seeks additional time or identifies the critical information desired so that he can use various techniques to accelerate the reconnaissance.

0255. If time is a constraint, the commander will need to focus the reconnaissance to achieve the higher commander’s intent. Accelerating reconnaissance increases the risk assumed by the unit. Each situation requires a certain minimum time for adequate reconnaissance and an acceptable level of risk. The commander ensures he has received at least the minimum amount of time. The type of cavalry unit and factors of METT-TC determine these time requirements.

0256. Zone reconnaissance may be performed by any cavalry unit. They may perform this mission as organized or be reinforced. Troops often perform zone

reconnaissance as part of another squadron mission. Troop commanders also receive route reconnaissance as a specified task during this mission.

Critical Tasks

0257. Certain critical tasks must be accomplished during a zone reconnaissance unless otherwise directed. Zone reconnaissance is a deliberate, time-consuming process if not specifically focused. During a zone reconnaissance, the cavalry unit accomplishes the critical tasks listed below unless specifically directed otherwise by the higher commander. The higher commander, depending on the conditions of METT-TC, may select specific critical tasks for the troop to accomplish. The commander, in the commander's intent paragraph, should focus the unit on its critical tasks when he articulates his purpose. Additionally, the critical tasks should be listed in the Coordinating Instructions since they are tasks that apply to two or more units. Three primary tasks are associated with a zone reconnaissance:

a. Find and report all enemy forces within the zone;

b. Reconnoiter specific terrain within the zone; and

c. Report reconnaissance information;

0258. The commander, time permitting, may also direct the troop to accomplish the following:

a. Reconnoiter all terrain within the zone;

b. Inspect and classify all bridges within the zone;

c. Locate fords or crossing sites near all bridges in the zone;

d. Inspect and classify all overpasses, underpasses, and culverts;

e. Locate and clear all mines, obstacles, and barriers in the zone within its capability; and

f. Locate a bypass around built-up areas, obstacles, and contaminated areas.

0259. The commander may select specific critical tasks from this menu depending on METT-TC. He may also choose to further refine these tasks in his guidance. For example, he may focus the troop's effort on a specific enemy force and specific terrain features that he deems important to the success of the squadron's mission.

Squadron Planning Considerations

0260. The squadron commander receives certain minimum guidance when assigned a zone reconnaissance mission. Most important consideration is the commander's intent. The nature of reconnaissance requires freedom of action for the squadron. The squadron commander may focus or direct the zone reconnaissance to specific critical

tasks based on his analysis of the situation. He must understand that it may not be possible to execute all the critical tasks.

0261. The squadron commander must understand the concept for the follow-on forces so he can support the mission with the reconnaissance effort. The commander's intent, however, allows for flexibility to take advantage of opportunities uncovered by the squadron. The squadron commander must recognize and understand the significance of these opportunities, present them directly to the higher commander, and support the modified concept as directed. This often entails a change of mission or focused reconnaissance into a gap in enemy positions. Reconnaissance pull is an inherent part of agility and the squadron always remains flexible to seize opportunities.

0262. The higher commander defines reinforcements attached to the squadron and provides adequate fire support. He also provides graphic control measures. These include the boundaries for the mission, a line of departure, and an objective or limit of advance. The boundaries may be defined as an extension of the division and corps boundaries or as the axis of advance for an attacking force.

0263. The line of departure is the same as the main body unless otherwise specified. The objective or limit of advance is used to focus the reconnaissance effort. It may be terrain or force oriented and may correspond to the main body objective. The operations overlay of the main body force is provided for the squadron Tactical Operations Center (TOC). The S2 obtains updated or new IPB information.

0264. IPB provides an event template, terrain analysis, and enemy situation templates as known at that point. The event template will provide Named Areas of Interest (NAI) that will identify information requirements. The reconnaissance will confirm or refute much of this information. The squadron uses this available information, however, to help determine factors, such as:

a. Speed of the reconnaissance effort and where more deliberate reconnaissance is required;

b. The overall focus of the reconnaissance;

c. Missions of subordinate troops and zones for ground troops;

d. Essential air troop on-station times or locations; and

e. Identification of essential critical tasks.

0265. Integration of air and ground troop operations in division cavalry includes determination of the following:

a. Command and control relationship of troops. Normally the squadron is controlling all troops. Air and ground teams may be formed as necessary during the mission;

b. Air troop's rotation plan and missions;

c. Ground troop's missions; and

d. Critical tasks to be performed by air and ground troops. Air cavalry troops accelerate the reconnaissance effort by reconnoitering open terrain, reconnoitering forward of the ground troops, screening an open flank, or orienting on locating enemy. These tasks allow ground troops to focus on close terrain, routes, and close reconnaissance of obstacles and enemy. When air and ground reconnaissance efforts are integrated, the squadron commander is also capable of developing the situation faster.

0266. This troop is either under the operational control of the ground squadron or under the control of the aviation squadron performing reconnaissance forward of the ground squadron. In either case, the ground squadron commander controls the terrain. The air troop commander always operates on or monitors the ground squadron command net.

0267. Specific tasks assigned to an air cavalry troop may include the following:

a. Reconnoiters terrain not easily accessible to ground troop vehicles.

b. Rapidly check key points in zone.

c. Locates the flanks of enemy forces encountered by air or ground scouts.

d. Locates bypasses around obstacles and enemy positions.

e. Provides security on the far side of obstacles while ground troops reconnoiter and clear them.

f. Locates and maintains contact with large enemy formations, especially moving ones, before they make contact with the squadron. This gives the squadron commander valuable time to act.

g. When a hasty attack is necessary, coordinate joint air attack team (JAAT) or attack helicopter operations.

0268. When the division cavalry squadron is reconnoitering in the zone of the division, squadron boundaries are normally the boundaries of the division. When assigned an axis of advance, the commander establishes boundaries for the squadron beyond the axis on both sides to include reconnaissance of dominating terrain. The size of the axis determines whether the squadron treats it as a route or zone reconnaissance.

0269. The squadron assigns zones for the ground troops (see Figure 2-2). Zone reconnaissance is normally performed over an extended distance, requiring that all ground troops employed be abreast. The capacity of the squadron is a factor of the capability and status of assigned scout platoons. Boundaries are designated to allow the troops to remain abreast of one another during the mission. Zones may not necessarily of the same size.

0270. The main body frequently orients movement along a major route, especially in an axis of advance. Reconnaissance of this route becomes a specified task for a troop. Phase lines control progress through the zone. Boundaries and phase lines are drawn along recognizable terrain. Contact points along boundaries maintain coordinated reconnaissance. Checkpoints are used to indicate critical terrain features, to control reconnaissance, or to coordinate air and ground teamwork. Additional control measures are used as necessary.

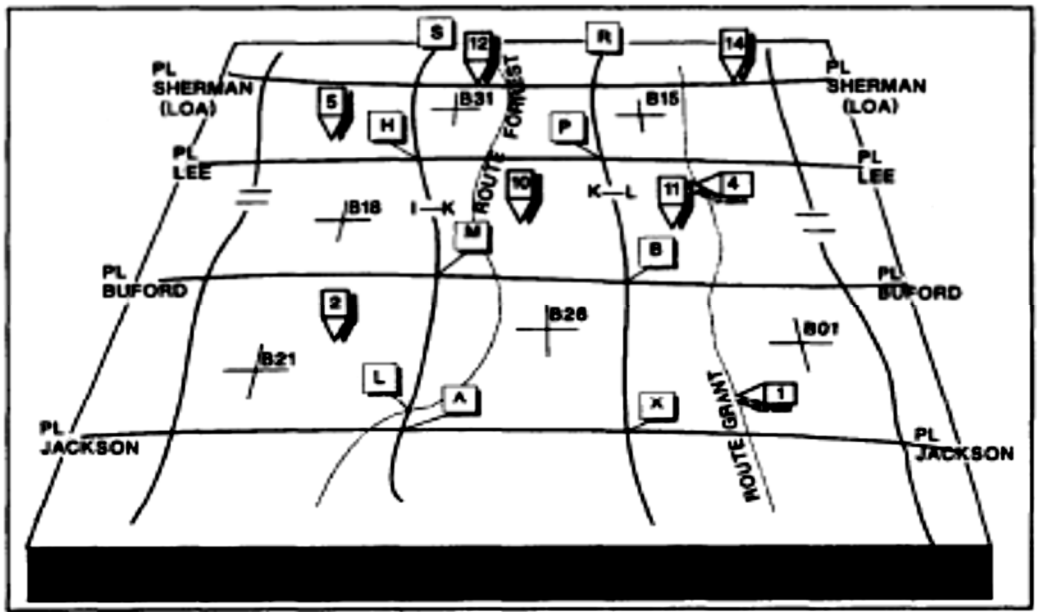


Figure 2.2 - Cavalry Squadron Zone Reconnaissance

0271. Task organized reinforcements are normally retained under squadron control because of the vague situation. In the division cavalry squadron, maneuver company teams serve as a reserve and are used by the squadron commander to develop the situation on enemy contact. Reserves are positioned to facilitate rapid employment anywhere in the zone. Priority of fire for artillery is assigned to troops based on intelligence or the main effort. Air Defense Artillery (ADA) priority is normally towards protecting trains, command posts, artillery battery, and any designated reserve. The cavalry troops are too dispersed and rely upon passive air defense protective measures.

0272. Both the squadron TAC CP and main CP are normally operational to ensure continuous communications over extended distances within the squadron and to higher headquarters. Combat trains generally move through the center of the zone along a route providing good movement laterally and in depth. A UMCP may move along an alternate route to provide adequate support across a wide zone.

0273. The division cavalry squadron's field trains may be with the forward support battalion of the lead brigade in the main body. Depth of the zone or anticipated duration of the operation dictates arrangement of combat service support assets and how much it is placed forward. Class III and Class V are the major concerns.

0274. A forward positioned FARP reduces aircraft turnaround time. The FARP may be in the squadron zone or in the zone of the lead unit behind the squadron. The air

cavalry troop's forward assembly areas are used. Command posts and combat service support assets remain mobile and bound forward as the squadron advances. The main CP monitors locations and status to ensure no element falls too far behind.

0275. Upon completion of the mission, the squadron proceeds with any assigned follow-on mission. If no mission has been assigned, the squadron provides security along the limit of advance or reconnaissance objective. Major enemy forces beyond the squadron's capability may be encountered before reaching the objective. When no gap or bypass is found, the squadron assumes a hasty defense, continues close reconnaissance, and prepares to pass main body forces forward.

Troop Planning Consideration

0276. Upon completion of the mission, the squadron proceeds with any assigned follow-on mission. If no mission has been assigned, the squadron provides security along the limit of advance or reconnaissance objective. Major enemy forces beyond the squadron's capability may be encountered before reaching the objective. When no gap or bypass is found, the squadron assumes a hasty defense, continues close reconnaissance, and prepares to pass main body forces forward (see Figure 2-3).

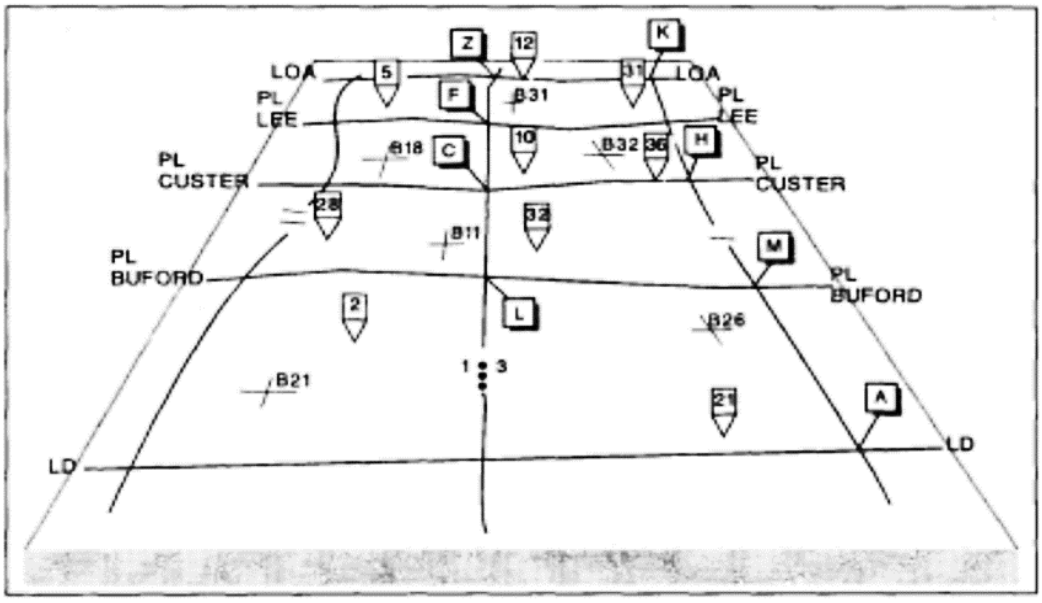


Figure 2.3 - Cavalry Troop Zone Reconnaissance.

0277. The troop commander selects a combat formation appropriate to the situation. Combat formations may change during the course of the reconnaissance as terrain or enemy situations change. The mortar section generally moves through the center of the sector or follows a scout platoon, depending on expected enemy contact. The fire support officer plans indirect fires to compensate for mortar section range limitations caused by positioning.

0278. Tank platoons, when present, follow scout platoons in depth and remain responsive to developing situations. Tank platoons key their movement on the progress of the scout platoons. The troop command post displaces through the zone,

using terrain that affords effective communications. Troop combat trains move under control of the first sergeant, bounding forward based on the troop's movement.

0279. The air cavalry troop commander plans his mission in the same manner as the ground troop commander. He uses the same operations graphics and considers the same critical tasks. He organizes his troop to accomplish the mission considering the same anticipated enemy air defenses are considered.

0280. The air troop operates in platoons, but may be task organized into scout weapon teams who may use scouts only if the situation permits. The commander identifies and tracks the locations of available FARPs, and monitors the endurance of his crews. He ensures that he has elements on station during those critical times directed by the commander. He plans flight modes and routes to maximize station time actually performing the mission.

Area Reconnaissance

0281. An area reconnaissance is a directed effort to obtain detailed information concerning the terrain or enemy activity within a prescribed area. An area reconnaissance is a specialized form of zone reconnaissance. It is assigned to a cavalry unit by the commander under the same circumstances as a zone reconnaissance.

0282. Area reconnaissance proceeds faster than zone reconnaissance since the effort is focused on a specific piece of terrain or enemy force. The squadron or troops may perform area reconnaissance. This mission lends itself to formation of air-ground teams. The squadron may be required to reconnoiter one large area or several smaller ones.

Critical Tasks

0283. During an area reconnaissance, the critical tasks listed below must be accomplished unless the higher commander directs the cavalry unit to do otherwise. Accomplishing all of these tasks is a time-consuming process. Based on time and the commander's intent, the cavalry commander may direct the reconnaissance towards specific information requirements only. Like the zone reconnaissance, the commander should focus his unit in the commander's intent paragraph and list the critical tasks in the specific instructions. Three primary critical tasks are associated with an area reconnaissance:

a. Finds and reports all enemy within the area.

b. Reconnoiter specific terrain within the area.

c. Reports reconnaissance information.

0284. Other critical tasks include the following:

a. Reconnoiter all terrain within the area.

b. Inspects and classify all bridges within the area.

c. Locates fords or crossing sites near all bridges within the area.

d. Inspects and classify all overpasses, underpasses, and culverts.

e. Locates and clear all mines, obstacles, and barriers in the area within its capability.

f. Locates a bypass around built-up areas, obstacles, and contaminated areas.

Planning Considerations

0285. The unit normally conducts movement to an area as a tactical road march. IPB indicates how much security is required for the move itself. The unit moves rapidly to the area, reporting and bypassing enemy or obstacles encountered en route. Known enemy outside the area are avoided.

0286. The commander treats the assigned area like a zone reconnaissance. The area and any dominating terrain around it are enclosed in a boundary. Other control measures are used as in a zone reconnaissance (see Figure 2-4). If the area is to be occupied by another force as an assembly area, the unit reconnoiters trafficability of the area to support that force.

0287. An air cavalry troop may initially secure an area by establishing a screen. Upon completion of the reconnaissance, the troop or squadron departs the area on a different route. Alternatively, the unit may proceed on a different mission or secure an area by establishing a screen. The screen may orient in a particular direction or all around the area. If follow-on forces are to occupy the area, the cavalry is relieved by unit quartering parties and continues with other assigned missions.

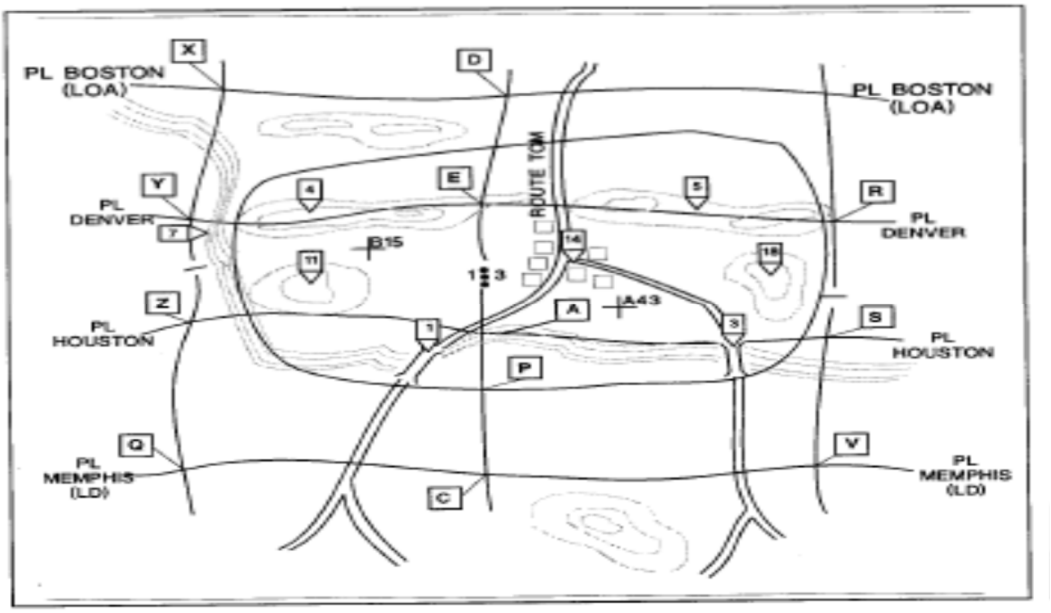


Figure 2.4 - Cavalry Troop Area Reconnaissance

0288. A reconnaissance in force is a limited objective operation by at least a battalion size force to obtain information and to locate and test enemy dispositions, strengths, and reactions, It may be assigned when limited information about the enemy is available, when the commander desires more specific information on the enemy, and when this information cannot be gathered by any other means. The division cavalry squadron may conduct a reconnaissance in force independently or as part of a larger force. Squadrons and troops perform this mission as a zone reconnaissance or a movement to contact.

0289. Even though the commander is executing a reconnaissance in force primarily together, he must be alert to seize any opportunity to exploit tactical success. If the reconnaissance in force will be conducted along a broad front, it may consist of a series of strong probing actions to test the enemy's reactions at selected points.

0290. The enemy reaction, or lack thereof, may reveal a weakness in his defenses. The commander assigning the reconnaissance in force must carefully weigh the risks involved. For instance, while the reconnaissance in force may reveal a weak point in the enemy's defenses, it may lead to a general engagement under unfavorable conditions. The reconnaissance in force may also reveal future plans to the enemy. Advance planning must be conducted for the extrication of the force or the exploitation of success.

Chapter III
Security Operations

0301. Security operations obtain information about the enemy and provide reaction time, maneuver space, and protection to the main body. Security operations are characterized by aggressive reconnaissance to reduce terrain and enemy unknowns, gaining and maintaining contact with the enemy to ensure continuous information, providing early and accurate reporting of information to the protected force. Security operation includes the following missions:

a. Screen.

b. Guard.

c. Cover.

d. Area security.

0302. Security operations may be considered in terms of the degree of security provided and the amount of combat power required to perform them. The squadron performs screen and guard. Separate brigades or task organized divisional brigades may perform cover as well.

0303. Cavalry units perform security operations as organized or reinforced. Reinforcements may include tank and mechanized infantry units, attack helicopter units, combat support units, and close air support. The nature of the security mission performed determines what reinforcements are needed. During security missions, squadrons and troops may perform reconnaissance and offensive, defensive, and retrograde operations. Integrated air and ground troop operations provide increased depth, flexibility, and responsiveness in performing these missions.

0304. Security is an essential part of all offensive and defensive operations. Cavalry provides security for the commander along an exposed front, flank, or rear of the main body where a threat may exist. Security along a common boundary with another friendly unit is the responsibility of the unit assigned to that zone or sector. Some cavalry units may perform security missions as part of a larger security force. In division cavalry, sustained security operations require the entire squadron. Fragmenting the squadron to provide security in multiple directions simultaneously should be avoided.

0305. Surveillance is continuous during security operations. Even during security missions that involve fighting the enemy, the scouts' primary task is still gathering information. Scouts do this by establishing Observation Posts (OP), conducting patrols, and performing reconnaissance. Air and ground scouts are coordinated to synchronize their complementary capabilities.

0306. Counter reconnaissance is an inherent task in all security operations. Counter reconnaissance is the sum of actions taken at all echelons to counter enemy

reconnaissance and surveillance efforts through the depth of an area of operations. It is active and passive and includes combat action to destroy or repel enemy reconnaissance elements. It also denies the enemy information about friendly units.

0307. Counter reconnaissance keeps enemy reconnaissance forces from observing the main body by defeating or blocking them. In the execution of counter reconnaissance, cavalry operates either offensively or defensively using whichever tactics to best accomplish the task. Hasty attack, ambush, and indirect fires are the principal techniques used. The cavalry must be organized to defeat enemy reconnaissance forces without requiring reinforcement. Enemy reconnaissance capabilities in any given situation must be compared to the cavalry unit's capabilities to determine if additional maneuver or combat support assets are required.

0308. Liaison with the protected force is critical during security missions. This ensures that both security force and protected force remain abreast of the full situation and maintain synchronized operations. This is most significant during flank and rear guard operations when the security force and the protected force are oriented in different directions. The security force accomplishes this task with liaison officers.

Purpose and Fundamentals

Purpose

0309. Cavalry performs security missions to provide information about the enemy and terrain and to preserve the combat power of friendly forces. Cavalry provides information about the size, composition, location, and direction of movement of enemy forces. Cavalry provides information about terrain to facilitate the movement or maneuver of other forces. Reaction time and maneuver space gained by this information allows the main body commander to prepare or to deploy to engage the enemy. Security prevents the main body from being surprised by the enemy. This allows the commander to preserve the combat power of maneuver forces to be concentrated at the point of decision.

Fundamentals

0310. Successful security operations are planned and performed with five fundamentals in mind:

a. Orient on the main body.

b. Perform continuous reconnaissance.

c. Provide early and accurate warning.

d. Provide reaction time and maneuver space.

e. Maintain enemy contact.

0311. **Orient on the Main Body.** The security force operates at a specified distance between the main body and known or suspected enemy units. If the main body moves, the security force must also move. The security force commander must know the scheme of maneuver of the main body and maneuver as necessary to remain between it and the enemy. The value of terrain occupied by the security force lies in the protection provides to the main body commander.

0312. **Perform Continuous Reconnaissance.** Security is active. The security force performs continuous, aggressive reconnaissance to gain all possible information about the enemy and terrain. Security comes in large part from knowing everything about the enemy and terrain within the assigned area of operations. Surveillance and patrolling required in security use the same techniques as in reconnaissance. The security force commander must know what the terrain will allow both the enemy and his own forces to do. If the security mission involves movement, reconnaissance is necessary for both the squadron and the main body.

0313. **Provide Early and Accurate Warning.** Information is security. Early warning of enemy activity provides the main body commander the time and information needed to retain the tactical initiative and to choose the time and place to concentrate against the enemy. Ground scouts and aero scouts are positioned to provide long-range observation of expected enemy avenues of approach and are reinforced with electronic surveillance devices when available. Flexibility and depth are built into the surveillance plan.

0314. **Provide Reaction Time and Maneuver Space.** This fundamental embraces the intent of security operations. The security force operates as far from the main body as possible, consistent with the factors of METT-T. This distance provides the reaction time and maneuver space required by the main body commander. It fights, as necessary, to ensure adequate time and space for the main body commander to maneuver and concentrate forces to meet the enemy.

0315. **Maintain Enemy Contact.** Unless otherwise directed, contact once gained is not broken. Contact does not have to be maintained by the individual scout who first makes it. The security force maintains contact as a whole. Continuous information on the enemy's activities must be gathered, and he must be prevented from endangering other friendly forces. This requires:

a. Continuous visual contact.

b. The ability to use direct and indirect fires.

c. Maintaining freedom to maneuver.

d. Depth.

Screen

0316. The primary purpose of a screen is to provide early warning to the main body. Based on the higher commander's intent and the screen's capabilities, it may also destroy enemy reconnaissance and impede and harass the enemy main body with

indirect and/or direct fires. Screen missions are defensive in nature and largely accomplished by establishing a series of observation posts and conducting patrols to ensure adequate surveillance of the assigned sector. The screen provides the protected force with the least protection of any security mission. This mission is appropriate when operations have created extended flanks, when gaps exist between major subordinate maneuver units that cannot be secured in force, or when required to provide early warning over gaps that are not considered critical enough to require security in greater strength. This permits the main body commander to maximize the security effort where contact is expected.

0317. Squadrons normally perform a screen with organic assets. Engineers may be available for specific tasks. For division cavalry, direct support artillery may be designated. The squadron operates within the range of the main body artillery for access to indirect fire support. An air or ground cavalry troop from the divisional cavalry squadron, armored or light, may be under the operational control of or attached to a brigade to perform a screen in support to brigade operations. When this occurs the troop should receive direct support artillery.

0318. Displacement of the screen to subsequent OP positions is event driven. The approach of an enemy force, relief by a friendly unit, or movement of the protected force dictates screen movements. The main body commander does not place a time requirement on the duration of the screen. Doing so may force the screening force to accept decisive engagement.

0319. Because a screen is defensive in nature, a screen may be performed for a stationary force to the front, flank, or rear of the main body. A screen is performed for a moving force to the flank or rear of the main body. A screen mission is not performed forward of a moving force. Zone reconnaissance, movement to contact, or advance guard is more suited for operations forward of a moving force. Figure 3-1 depicts the three locations a squadron may screen a moving force and the four locations a squadron may screen a stationary force.

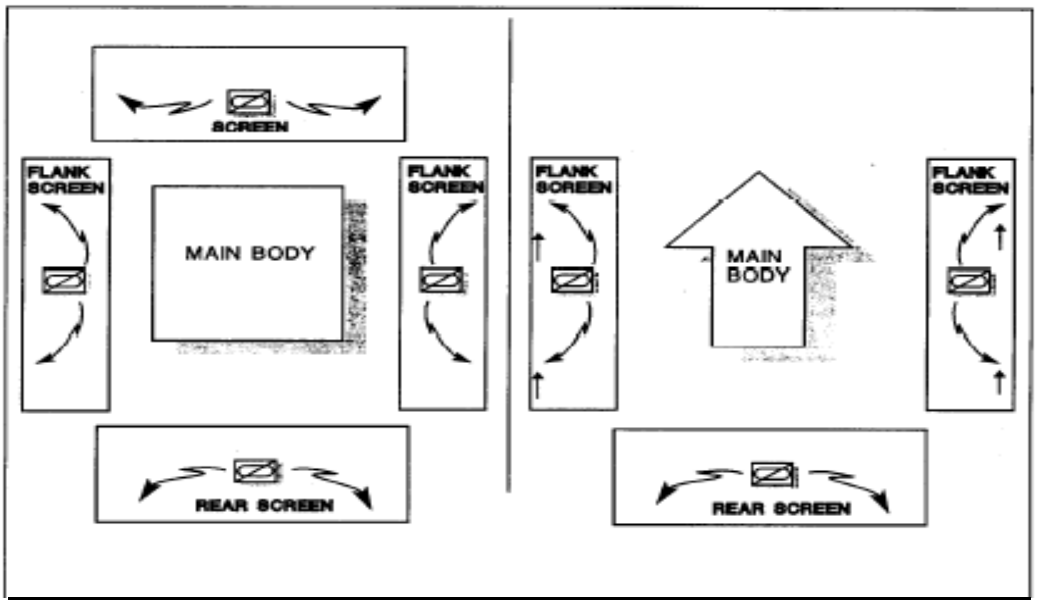


Figure 3.1 - Screen Locations

0320. All screens are active operations. Stationary OPs are only one part of the mission. Patrols, mounted and aerial reconnaissance and relocating OPs on an extended screen ensures that continuous overlapping surveillance occurs. Inactivity in an immobile screen develops complacency.

0321. Depth is important in a screen. The term screen line is descriptive only of the trace along which security is provided. Depth allows an enemy contact to be passed from one element to another without displacing. Depth is advantageous to:

a. Destroy an enemy reconnaissance patrol without compromising critical OPs.

b. Prevent the enemy from penetrating the screen line too easily.

c. Prevent gaps from occurring when OPs displace or are lost.

Critical Tasks

0322. A screen mission has certain critical tasks that guide planning. Critical tasks are not checklists or sequential execution guides. The level to which the critical task can be achieved is dependent on the unit's capabilities. To achieve the intent of a screen mission, the following critical tasks are to be accomplished:

a. Maintain continuous surveillance of all battalion-size avenues of approach into the sector under all visibility conditions.

b. Destroy or repel all reconnaissance elements within capabilities.

c. Locate the lead company of each suspected Advance Guard Battalion and determine its direction of movement.

d. Maintain contact with the lead company of the Advance Guard Battalion while displacing, and report its activity.

0323. **Cavalry Commander's Guidance.** The Main Body Commander provides the following broad guidance to the Cavalry Commander.

a. **Reinforcements.** Any unique requirement posed by the mission may require assets not organic to the screening unit. The cavalry may require reinforcement with additional air ground maneuver assets.

b. **The General Trace of the Screen and the Time, the Screen must be established.** This trace is indicated symbolically by a phase line placed along identifiable terrain (see Figure 3-2). This phase line considers the amount of early warning, range of indirect fires, and maneuver space desired by the Main Body Commander and is consistent with the limitations of a screen mission. When screening forward of the division or corps main body, this phase line represents the Forward Line of Own Troops (FLOT) and may be along or close to a coordinated fire line.

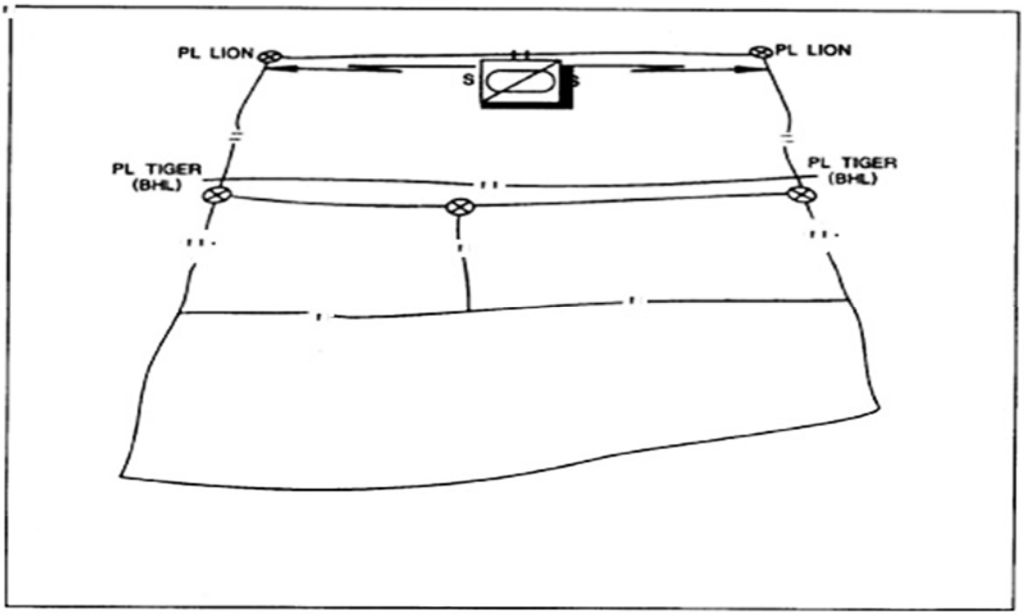


Figure 3.2 - Squadron Overlay

c. **The Width of the Screened Sector.** The tasks required of a screening force are minimal compared to other security missions. Therefore, the screening force may be assigned a wide frontage. The determining factor for the capacity of the squadron is the capability of the assigned scout platoons. (FM 7-92 and FM 17-98 discuss the capabilities of the scout platoon.) If the squadron is required to screen beyond the capacity it can handle, the commander requests ground reinforcement. Careful consideration must be given when assigning the air cavalry its own terrain. Limited visibility conditions, limited station time, and weather may affect the air cavalry's ability to cover the zone. It is also important to understand that air cavalry provides depth and flexibility to the security zone and is best used in concert with ground forces.

d. **The Force to be screened.** The protected force is often indicated by a command and control relationship.

e. **The Rear Boundary of the Screening Force.** The rear boundary of the screening force is depicted as a boundary. Responsibility for the area between the protected force and the screening force rear boundary lies with the screened force (main body). This boundary may also serve as a phase line internally to the squadron. This boundary reflects time and space requirements, clearly delineates terrain responsibilities, and provides depth required by the screening force. The rear boundary may serve as a battle handover line to control passing responsibility for the enemy to the protected force.

f. **Any Special Requirements and Constraints.** Requirements for observing specific Named Area of Interest (NAI) or Target Area of Interest (TAI) identified during the IPB are stated. If the screening force is to engage or control engagement of a threat at a TAI, the main body commander provides adequate resources.

0324. **Squadron Commander's Considerations.** Given the higher commander's guidance, the squadron commander considers the following areas:

a. **The Initial Screen Line.** The initial screen line is established by the controlling headquarters (see Figure 3-3). It is placed closer to the main body only with the permission of the higher commander of that headquarter. Requirements to observe specific NAI or TAI are considered. This screen line is placed on terrain that allows good fields of observation from behind the line. Because the initial screen line often represents the FLOT, it is considered a restrictive control measure. Coordination is necessary to move beyond the initial screen line to establish an air screen in depth or to perform reconnaissance. A phase line can designate the squadron limit of advance. This forward phase line then becomes the FLOT. Limited visibility surveillance requirements and depth are always incorporated in the screen. The initial screen should be within range of the main body's artillery support.

b. **Movement to the Screen Line.** Time determines the method of occupying the screen line. Given adequate time, the squadron performs a zone reconnaissance. This clears the sector of any enemy and familiarizes the squadron with the terrain. When time is critical, the screen force performs a movement to contact or a tactical road march to a position just short of the screen line.

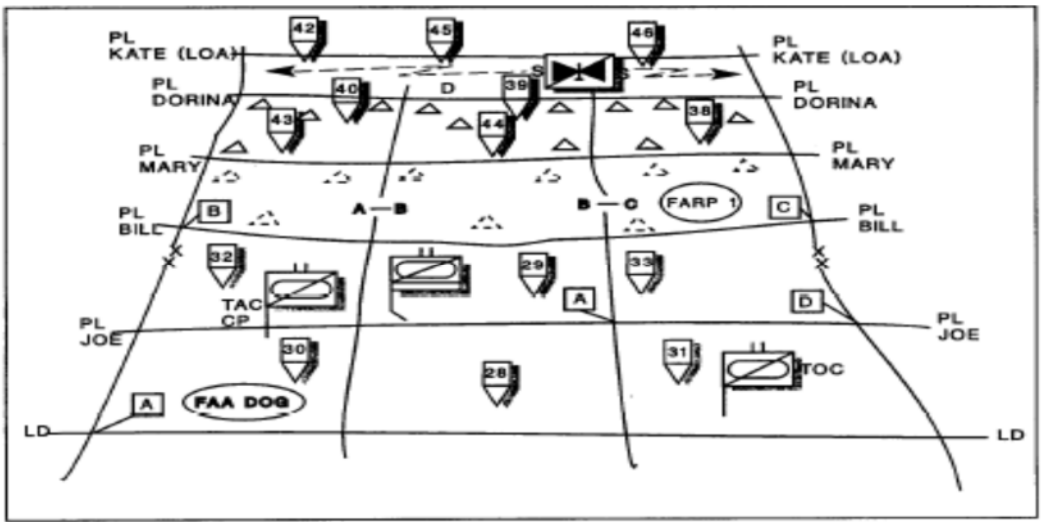


Figure 3.3 - Cavalry Squadron Screen

c. **Control of Displacement to Subsequent Positions.** The squadron commander uses additional phase lines to control the operation. Since displacement to subsequent positions is event driven, subsequent phase lines serve to guide the troop commander's initiative during the mission.

d. **Sectors for Subordinate Troops.** The commander designates sectors for the subordinate ground cavalry troops. Terrain responsibility for NAIs and TAIs goes with the sector. Ground troops are normally deployed abreast. The tank company provides depth for the regimental cavalry squadron, and the air

cavalry provides depth for the division cavalry squadron. Reduced depth is the trade-off when screening extended frontages. When forced to do so, the commander may have to assign terrain to the air cavalry troop. This terrain should not be the high-speed avenue of approach. Plans must compensate for the absence of the air cavalry by adjusting ground OPs during limited visibility or bad weather.

e. **Air and Ground Integration.** Air Cavalry Troops (ACT) may screen forward of the ground troops to add depth. When doing so, the ACTs should stay with range of the unit's indirect fires, either mortar or tube artillery. During the day or in higher threat environments, the distance between the ACTs and ground troops may be decreased to enhance survivability of the aircraft. The ACTs extend the capabilities of the ground screen (see Figure 3-4). They may screen an exposed flank of the squadron, assist in patrolling gaps between ground OPs on an extended screen, augment the surveillance of NAIs by ground OPs, and add depth within the squadron sector along subsequent screen lines. The concept of battle handover is used within the squadron as air and ground troops displace to subsequent OPs or a FARP. This ensures that the squadron maintains contact with the closing enemy. The use of attack helicopters may be constrained in case they are needed to respond to a rapidly developing situation. The Cavalry Squadron Commander determines the method of air cavalry employment. In either case, integrating air and ground assets greatly enhances the effectiveness of the screen.

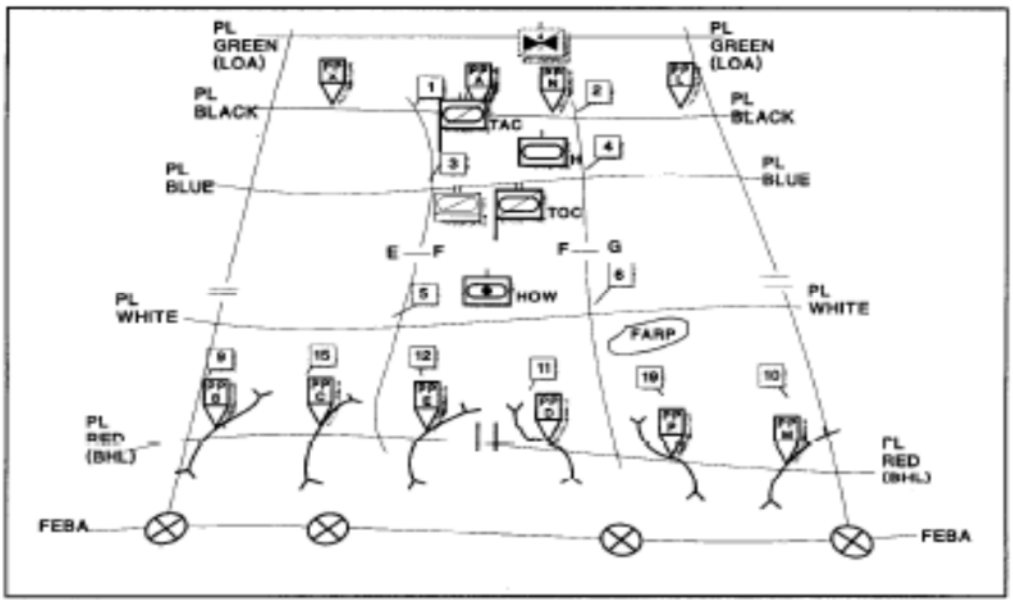


Figure 3.4 - Brigade Armored Cavalry Troop Screen

f. **Indirect Fire Planning.** Fire planning integrates artillery and mortar fires. Observers cover TAIs. Relationships with supporting artillery for division cavalry are clearly defined with the division fire support element.

g. **Mobility and Survivability.** Engineers, if attached, may be available for specific tasks. Typical engineer tasks are survivability, improvement of combat roads and trails, and emplacement of situational obstacles. Situational obstacles are obstacles that units plan, and possibly prepare, before beginning

an operation; however, they do not execute the obstacles unless specific criteria are met. Therefore, units may or may not execute situational obstacles, depending on the situation that develops during the battle. They are "be prepared" obstacles and provide the commander flexibility for emplacing tactical obstacles based on battlefield development.

h. **Positioning Of Command and Control, Maneuver Support, and Sustainment Assets.** These assets occupy positions to support extended frontages and remain highly mobile for rapid displacement. Both the TCP and the TOC may be required to operate continuously. In the cavalry squadron, a FARP is placed forward to facilitate rapid turn-around of aircraft. Sustainment assets prepare for extended operations as necessary.

0325. **Ground Troop Commander's Considerations.** The Ground Troop Commander considers the following factors when developing the troop concept.

a. **Scout Platoon Sectors.** The troop sector is divided between the scout platoons to delineate responsibility for surveillance (see Figure 3-5). The nature of a screen normally requires all scout platoons to be deployed abreast. Platoons receive clear responsibility for identified avenues of approach and designated NAIs.

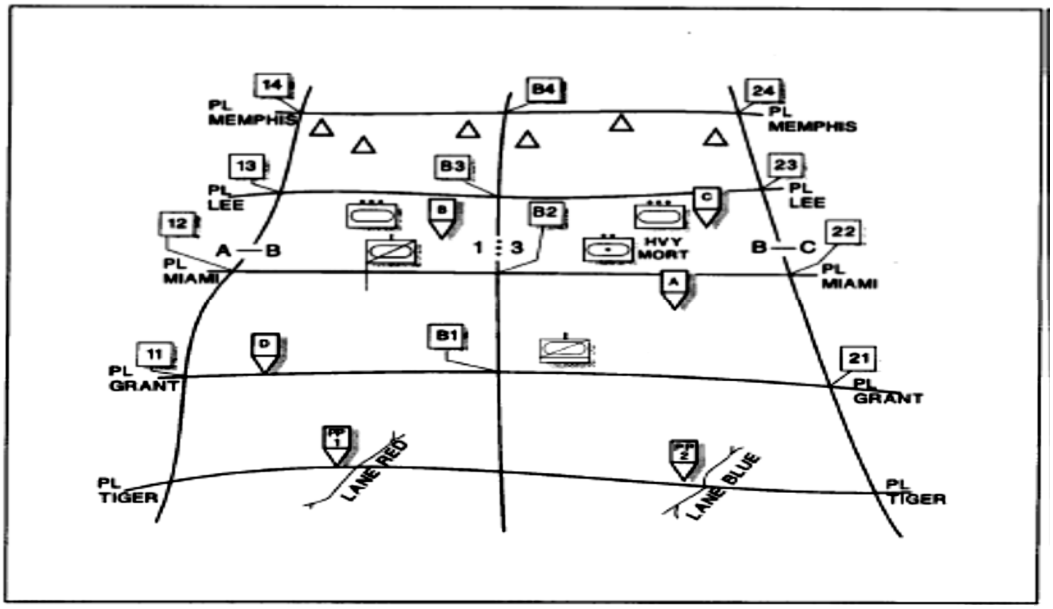


Figure 3.5 - Division Armored Cavalry Troop (S) screen

b. **Graphics.** Additional control measures and phase lines are added as necessary.

c. **Initial OP Locations.** The troop commander determines initial OP locations to ensure effective surveillance of the sector and designated NAIs. The scouts who occupy the OP always retain the responsibility to modify the location to achieve the commander's intent. The OPs are positioned along or behind the initial screen line. OPs are integrated with the indirect fire plan to ensure Target Reference Points (TRP) can be observed. Positioning forward of the

screen line requires coordination. Planning for depth in the screen eases the task of maintaining contact.

d. **Patrol Requirements.** Patrols may be required to cover gaps between OPs. The troop commander tasks the scout platoon leaders to perform specific patrols.

e. **Mortars.** The troop mortars are positioned to fire up to two-thirds of their maximum range forward of the initial screen line. A wide sector may require the commander to position them to provide effective coverage of the most likely enemy avenue of approach determined by IPB. The Troop Fire Support Officer (FSO) plans artillery fires to adequately cover any gaps in mortar coverage.

f. **Positioning Of Command and Control and Sustainment Assets.** The commander positions himself to observe the most dangerous avenue of approach. The command post establishes a position behind the initial screen line to provide continuous control and reporting during initial movements. After positions have been re-established in depth, the command post can displace. Combat trains are behind masking terrain close enough for rapid response. They are best suited along routes providing good mobility laterally and in depth.

g. **Coordination.** The Troop Commander coordinates his concept with Air Cavalry Troop Commanders who may be working the same ground, Flank Troop Commanders, and Tank Company Commanders as appropriate.

0326. **Air Cavalry Troop Commander's Considerations.** The Air Cavalry Troop Commander plans his concept using the following considerations that are critical:

a. **Aircraft Rotation.** Based on the rotation method selected by the squadron commander, the troop commander determines methods of rotating aircraft to sustain the aerial screen. He must consider any constraint concerning the use of attack helicopters.

b. **Platoon/Scout Weapons Team Organization.** The troop commander organizes platoon/scout weapons teams based on the squadron commander's guidance, the likelihood of enemy contact, size of assigned sector, duration of the mission, and aircraft availability. If large frontages or several avenues of approach need to be covered, the troop commander may break down to the team organization instead of using platoons. When augmented with additional attack helicopters, they may remain immediately available in the forward assembly area or holding area to respond to the troop commander as required or when directed by the squadron commander.

c. **Coordination.** The Troop Commander ensures locations of attack helicopters, forward assembly areas, and FARPs are known by all aircrews. The commander closely coordinates his concept with the ground troop commander(s). He must direct particular attention towards OP locations, mortar positions, and scheme of maneuver. Coordinating the air passage of

lines when operating forward of ground troops is essential. Understanding the ground troop's plan for displacing OPs is critical. Air troops will initially be forward to provide early warning, and when battlefield events dictate displacement for the ground elements, air cavalry may be required to engage with indirect and direct fires. Air cavalry's ability to use direct and indirect fires to maintain contact and to slow the enemy's rate of advance is critical to mission success.

d. **Moving Screen.** The same planning considerations discussed above apply to a moving screen. Emphasis may shift since the main body is moving. The squadron may screen the rear or flank of a moving force. Screening the rear of a moving force is essentially the same as a stationary screen. As the protected force moves, the squadron occupies a series of successive screen lines (see Figure 3-6). Movement is regulated by the requirement to maintain the time and distance factors desired by the main body commander. Air troops may assume the screen during ground troop movement. The moving flank screen poses additional considerations. It is similar to the moving flank guard. The width of the screen sector is not as important as the force being protected. The squadron screens from the front of the lead combat element in the main body to the rear of the protected elements, exclusive of front and rear security forces (see Figure 3-7). Combat trains move with the squadron and field trains with either the nearest brigade forward support battalion in the main body (division cavalry). If either support unit remains behind the original FLOT, the squadron field trains may remain with them.

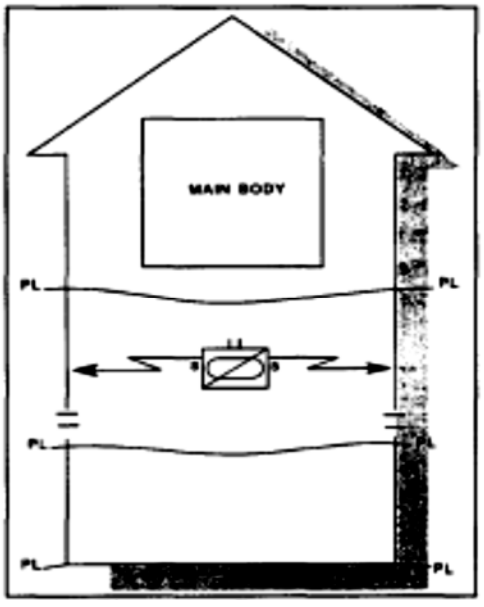


Figure 3.6 - Rear Screen

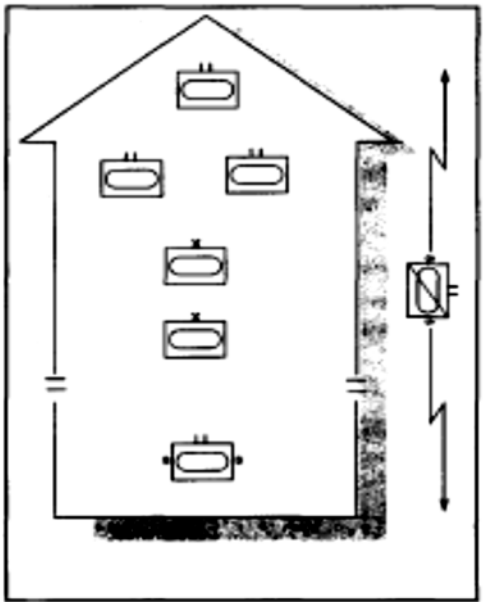


Figure 3.7 - Moving Flank Screen

0327. There are three basic methods of occupying the screen line. These methods may often be combined.

0328. In the first method, the squadron crosses the line of departure separately from the main body and conducts a tactical road march along a route of advance parallel to the main body (see Figure 3-8). Scout platoons occupy positions along a line of OPs as they reach them. This is the fastest but least secure method. Air cavalry troops are

well suited to maintain contact with the main body and to perform reconnaissance forward of the squadron. This method is appropriate when the main body is moving very quickly, the line of departure is not a line of contact, or IPB indicates enemy contact is not likely in the area that the squadron is moving through.

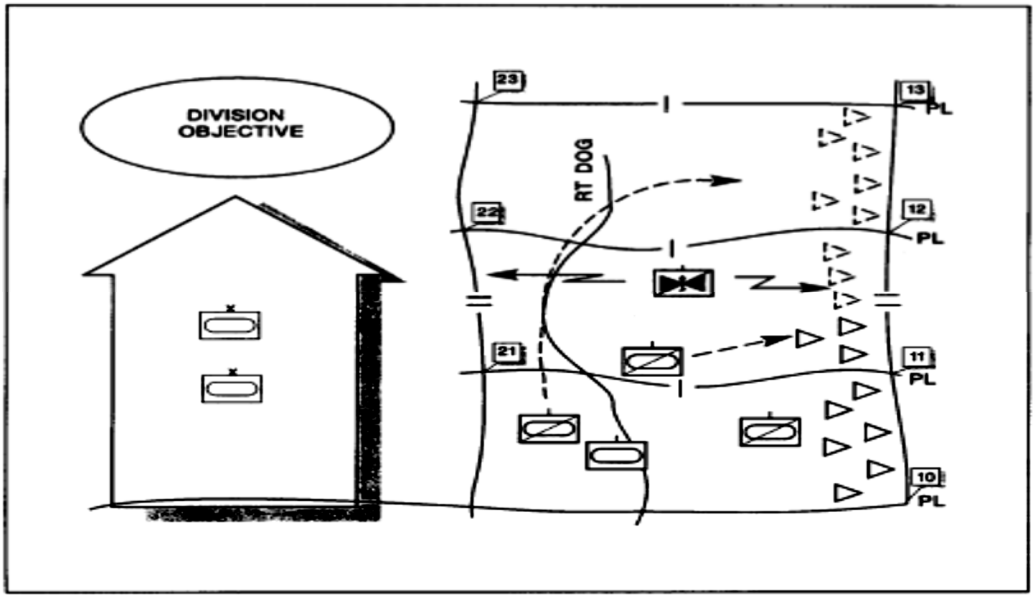


Figure 3.8 - Moving Flank Screen (Method One)

0329. In the second method, the squadron crosses the line of departure separately from the main body and conducts a zone reconnaissance forward (see Figure 3-9). Screen positions are occupied as they are reached. This method is slower but provides better security to the squadron. The distance from the screen line to the main body determines the squadron formation used. This method is appropriate when the main body is moving slower, the line of departure is not a line of contact, or IPB indicates that enemy contact is possible.

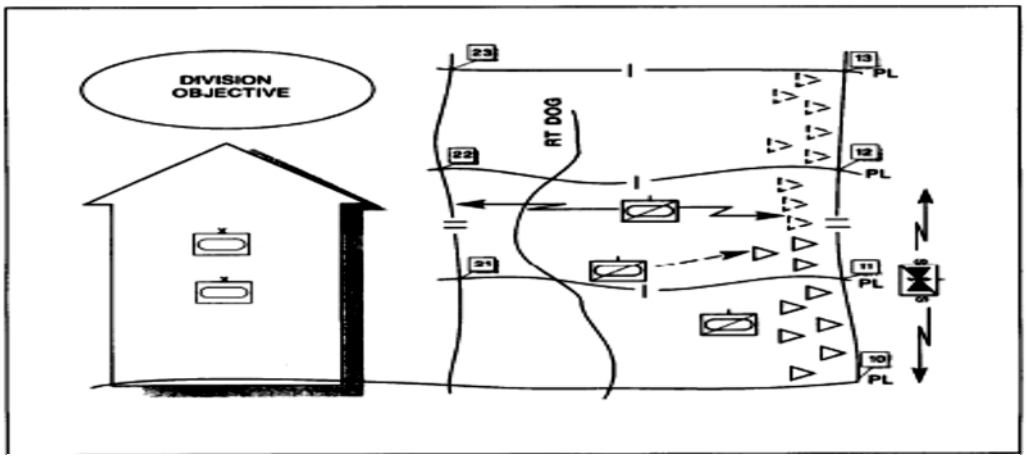


Figure 3.9 - Moving Flank Screen (Method Two)

0330. In the third method, the squadron crosses the line of departure with the main body and conducts a zone reconnaissance out to the screen line (see Figure 3-10). This method provides the most security for the squadron and the main body but requires more time. This method is appropriate when the main body is moving slowly, the line of departure is the line of contact, or the enemy situation is vague.

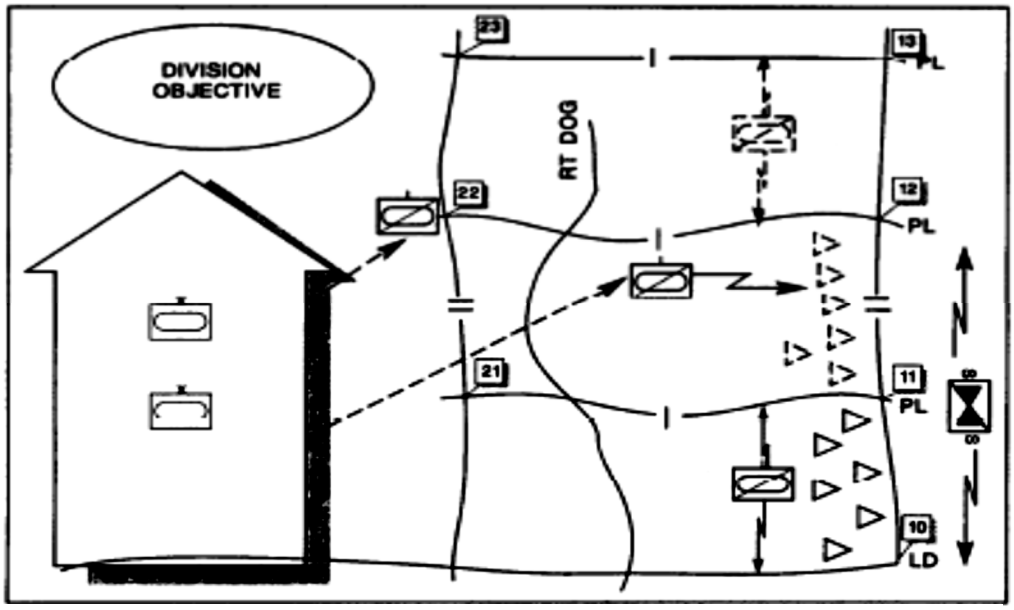


Figure 3.10 - Moving Flank Screen (Method Three)

0331. Because the squadron moves in one direction but orients in another, command and control is challenging. Control measures must facilitate both orientations. For example, phase lines serve as on-order troop boundaries and do not divide avenues of approach into the flank of the main body. The squadron not only plans for the advance and initial screen but also for a screen in depth back to the main body.

0332. Movement along the screen line is determined by the speed of the main body, the distance to the objective, and the enemy situation. Squadron movement centers on a designated axis of advance. This route is parallel to the axis of advance in the protected force, large enough to accommodate rapid movement of the squadron, and

facilitates occupation of the screen line. The route must be kept clear to ensure rapid movement of the cavalry troops. Command and control, combat support, and combat service support assets move off the route when stopping and may move along other routes in depth. Four basic methods of movement may be used:

a. Successive bounds.

b. Alternate bounds by individual OPs.

c. Alternate bounds by subordinate units.

d. Continuous marching.

0333. These methods are summarized in Table 3-1. The squadron may use more than one as the speed of the protected force changes or contact is made.

Table 3.1 - Methods of Screen Movement

METHOD	CONSIDERATIONS	ADVANTAGES	DISADVANTAGES
Successive Bounds	Main body slow; By platoon or troop; Contact possible; Simultaneously or in succession; Air cordon during ground move	Most secure; Maintain maximum surveillance; Maintain unit integrity	Slowest method; Less secure during simultaneous move; May leave temporary gaps
Alternate Bounds by OPs	Main body faster; By platoon or troop; Contact possible; Bound rear to front	Very secure; Maintain maximum surveillance	Slow; Disrupt unit integrity
Alternate Bounds by Units	Main body faster; By platoon or troop; Contact possible; Bound rear to front	Fast; Good surveillance; Maintain unit integrity	May leave temporary gaps
Continuous Marching	Very fast main body; Perform as route reconnaissance; Contact not likely; Air screen on flank	Fast; Maintain unit integrity	Least secure

0334. **Limited Visibility.** Limited visibility conditions often occur during screen to these conditions as they occur. The screen must never be left with gaps when aircraft cannot fly or scouts cannot observe. Ground OPs can be adjusted with OPs placed along dismounted avenues of approach. Depth in the screen can facilitate acquisition of enemy forces that may elude forward elements. Patrols are closely coordinated to prevent misidentification and engagement by friendly forces. Rigorous sound and

light discipline at night prevents compromise and bypass of OPs by enemy reconnaissance forces. Additional OPs can be established as listening posts to take advantage of the extended distance sound travels at night. Indirect illumination is planned and used as necessary.

Guard

0335. A guard force accomplishes all the tasks of a screening force. Additionally, a guard force prevents enemy ground observation of and direct fire against the main body. A guard force recons, attacks, defends, and delays as necessary to accomplish its mission. A guard force normally operates within the range of main body indirect-fire weapons. The main body commander assigns the guard mission when he expects contact or has an exposed flank that requires greater protection than a screen provides. A guard force is deployed over a narrower front than a screen to permit concentration of combat power. The momentum that the enemy attempts to achieve in an attack often forces a screen to transition rapidly into a guard.
0336. The guard mission is normally assigned to a squadron. The multiple requirements of the mission, which must often be performed simultaneously over large areas, require the command and control structure of the squadron. Troops within the squadron perform zone reconnaissance, movement to contact, screen, defend, delay, or hasty attack missions. The guard mission requires the squadron to fight the enemy. To defeat a mechanized enemy force, the squadron requires tank to mass the necessary combat power required for success.

0337. Depending on the threat, the division cavalry squadron may require reinforcement with additional maneuver assets to accomplish the guard mission. Either squadron may be reinforced with additional maneuver company teams when the zone or sector is large. Engineers often reinforce the squadron. Artillery may be provided in direct support to division cavalry. The intent of the main body commander in assigning the mission determines the nature and extent of reinforcement required.

0338. Conduct of the mission is governed by the main body commander’s intent. The squadron commander may be given freedom of action or be required to achieve time or event constraints. Permission to withdraw behind the rear boundary is normally required.

0339. A guard may be performed for a stationary or moving force and to the front, flank, or rear of the main body. Planning considerations discussed for the screen apply to the guard. Figure 3-11 indicates the four locations a squadron may guard a moving or stationary force.

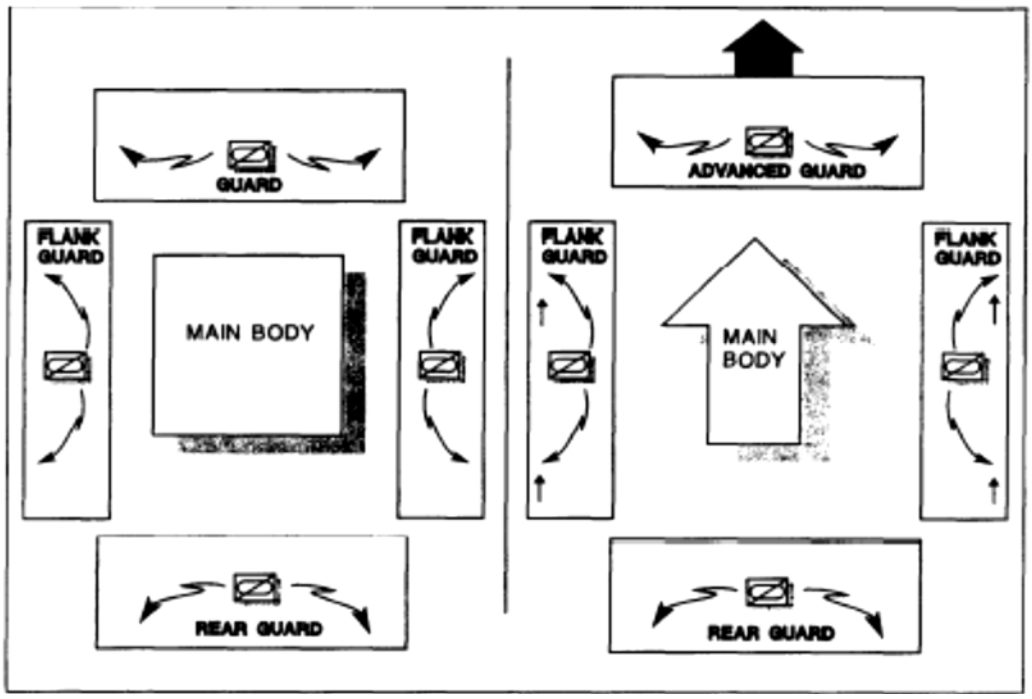


Figure 3.11 - Guard Location

0340. The main body commander provides broad planning guidance (see Figure 3-12):

a. Reinforcement of the squadron for the mission. Adequate combat and combat support assets are provided to achieve the commander's intent. Responsive fire support must be ensured.

b. The general trace of the guard and effective time, if appropriate. The same considerations that were discussed in Screen, apply.

c. The area of responsibility for the guard force.

d. The force to be secured. The squadron commander must understand the concept of the protected force. Location or direction of movement of the force is critical.

e. The rear boundary of the guard force. This boundary is placed far enough from the protected force so that the enemy cannot influence the main body without crossing the boundary. The rear boundary serves as the battle handover line to forces in the main battle area.

f. Any special requirements or constraints.

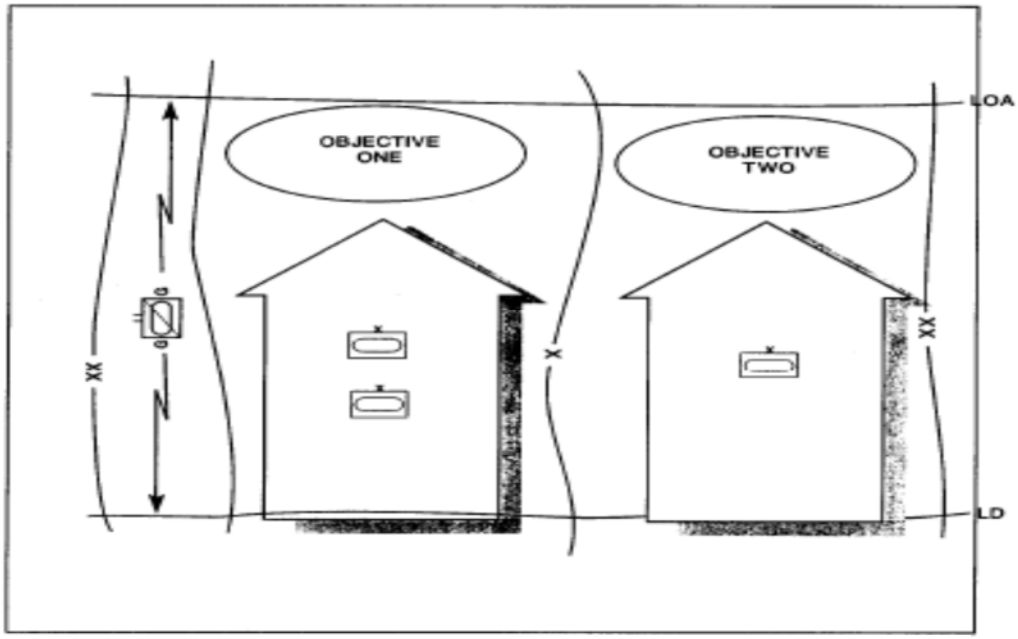


Figure 3.12 - Division Overlay

Advance Guard

0341. An advance guard for a stationary force deploys forward and defends. Once contact is made, the squadron continues to defend in sector or delay consistent with the commander's intent. An advance guard for a moving force is offensive in nature, finding and defeating enemy units along the axis of advance. The advance guard provides for the uninterrupted movement of the protected force. The squadron engages in offensive operations as necessary to accomplish the mission.

0342. Usually, movement to contact as the advance guard would be the squadron mission. If the squadron encounters enemy forces beyond its capability, the squadron defends, continues close reconnaissance, and prepares to pass elements of the main body forward and should brigades of a division be advancing on widely separated axes, the division cavalry squadron normally moves with the main effort. The supporting effort provides its own security.

0343. An advance guard accomplishes the following critical tasks:

a. Perform reconnaissance along the main body's axis of advance.

b. Maintain continuous surveillance of enemy battalion-size avenues of approach, when stationary.

c. Destroy or repel enemy reconnaissance and security forces.

d. Defeat, repel, or fix enemy ground forces before they can engage the main body with direct fire.

0344. The squadron commander clarifies, with the protected force commander, the interval to be maintained between the advance guard and the main body. The

squadron is not tied to the protected force. Rather, it leads the main body within the intent of the commander. Through reconnaissance pull, the squadron guides the main effort to take advantage of opportunities (see Figure 3-13). The commander considers the following:

a. **Missions for subordinate troops.** Subordinate troops of the squadron are normally assigned zone reconnaissance or movement to contact missions. Existing knowledge of the terrain or enemy situation, speed of advance of the main body, and nature of the main body objective may determine which mission is assigned.

b. **Missions for attached Company Teams or Tank Company.** In the cavalry unit, attached Company Teams are best employed as a reserve by the squadron commander. They generally follow center of zone but remain responsive to shift rapidly wherever required. They can be used to develop the situation, destroy enemy bypassed by the troops, or support cavalry troops that become decisively engaged. In a wide zone, a Company Team may receive a zone and perform a movement to contact.

c. **Zones for subordinate troops.** Missions assigned influence the size of zones for the subordinate troops. A movement to contact normally has a narrower zone than a zone reconnaissance to allow adequate concentration of combat power. Ground troops are normally deployed abreast to cover the axis of advance or zone of the protected force.

d. **Air and ground integration.** Air Cavalry Troops may perform reconnaissance forward of the ground troops or screen an exposed flank of the squadron. Additionally, they reconnoiter terrain that is hard to reach with ground troop vehicles. Other considerations discussed for the screen apply.

e. **Fire support planning.** Providing adequate indirect fire support may require the protected force to position artillery well forward in the main body.

f. **Mobility and survivability.** The possibility of receiving engineer support is increased while conducting a guard mission. Typical engineer tasks in support of a guard mission resemble those of a defense in sector: emplace tactical obstacles, dig survivability positions, and plan the emplacement of situational obstacles.

g. **Positioning Command and Control, Maneuver Support, and Sustainment assets.** Considerations that apply to reconnaissance may be used. Combat trains move with the squadron. Cavalry field trains normally move with the forward support battalion of a brigade in the main body. If the forward support battalion does not accompany the main body, the squadron’s field trains normally remain behind as well.

0345. The Ground Troop Commander plans his mission as he would, a zone reconnaissance or a movement to contact. The hasty attack is a likely contingency he prepares to execute.

0346. The Air Cavalry Troop Commander plans his mission as he would, a zone reconnaissance or a screen if placed on a flank of the squadron.

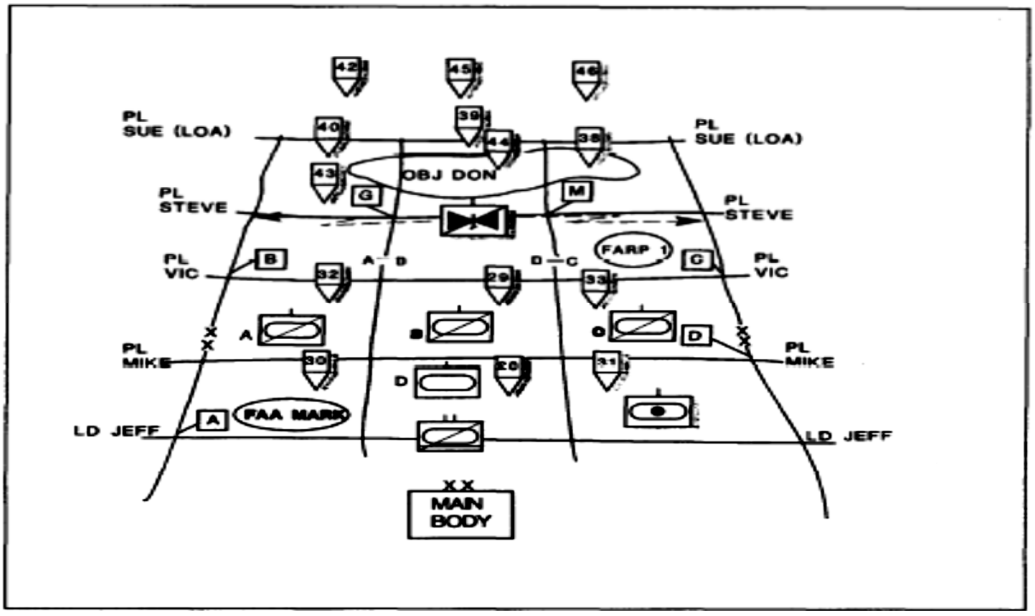


Figure 3.13 - Advance Guard (Cavalry Squadron)

Flank Guard

0347. A flank guard protects an exposed flank of the main body. A squadron can guard one flank of a division-size force. In performing this mission, the squadron operates beyond the assigned zone or sector of the protected force. Normally, the flank guard's responsibility begins at the trail element of the advance guard or the lead combat element in the main body and ends at the rear of the protected force or lead element of the rear guard. The protected force commander clarifies this responsibility as necessary. A flank guard is similar to a flank screen except that defensive positions are planned for as well as scout OPs.

0348. **Stationary Flank Guard.** A flank guard for a stationary force performs a zone reconnaissance when moving out to the initial security line positions. This allows the squadron to clear the zone and become familiar with the terrain that may subsequently be defended. Upon reaching the initial positions, the squadron establishes a defense (see Figure 3-14). The commander plans the defense or delay in depth from the initial positions. Troop commanders establish defensive positions in assigned battle positions or sectors, establish a screen forward of the positions, and plan defense in depth. Once contact is made, the squadron continues to defend in sector or delay as required. The following critical tasks apply during this mission:

a. Maintains continuous surveillance of enemy battalion-size avenues of approach.

b. Destroys or repels enemy reconnaissance forces.

c. Maintains contact with the main body.

d. Defeat, repel, or fix enemy ground forces before they can engage the main body with direct fire.

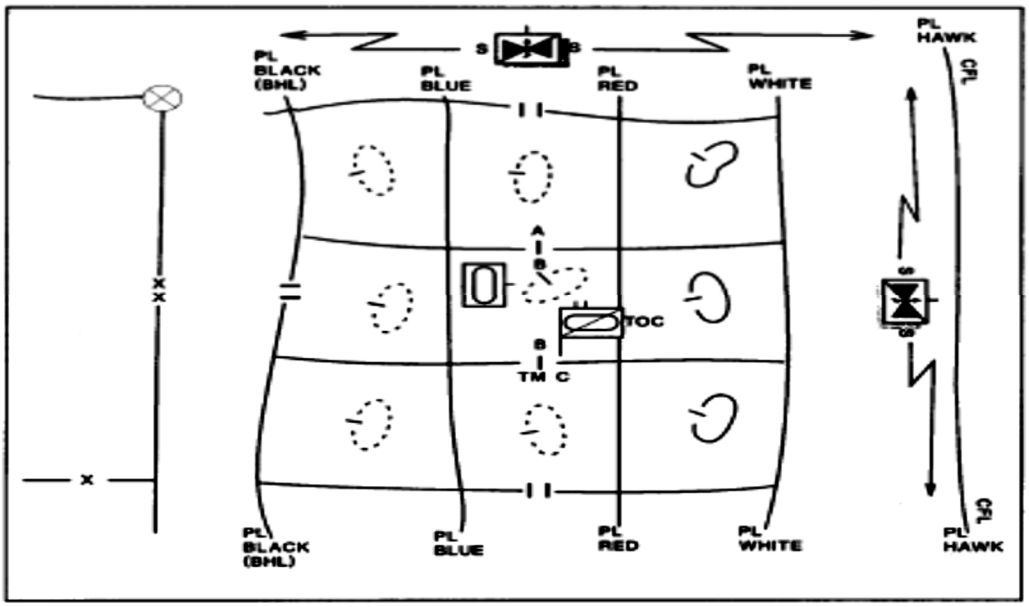


Figure 3.14 - Stationary Flank Guard

0349. Attached company teams can be used as a reserve or assigned defensive sectors. In a vague situation, the squadron requires a larger reserve than one where the enemy's actions are more predictable. Infantry teams are best employed on close terrain or along dismounted avenues of approach. Tank teams are best along high speed avenues of approach. A tank company defending may require a task organized scout platoon to establish the screen.

0350. **Moving Flank Guard.** A moving flank guard poses additional considerations. Many of the considerations for the moving flank screen apply. Instead of occupying a series of OPs, the squadron plans a series of troop battle positions. The following critical tasks are accomplished:

a. Maintains continuous surveillance of enemy battalion-size avenues of approach as long as they threaten movement of the main body.

b. Reconnoiter the zone between the main body and the guard force battle positions.

c. Maintains contact with the lead combat element of the main body.

d. Destroys or repels enemy reconnaissance forces.

e. Defeat, repel, or fix enemy ground forces before they can engage the main body with direct fire.

0351. The lead troop of the squadron has a critical three-fold mission: to maintain contact with the main body, to reconnoiter the zone between the main body and the squadron route of advance, and to reconnoiter the squadron route. The troop

accomplishes these tasks by performing a zone reconnaissance. The speed of the main body determines how thoroughly the reconnaissance is performed.

0352. Assistance is required if the zone is too wide for the lead troop. A zone that exceeds 10 kilometers from the guard line to the boundary with the main body generally should not be assigned to the three-fold mission troop. A three-fold mission troop tasked to conduct a zone reconnaissance greater than its doctrinal frontage (10 kilometers) will quickly find itself unable to match the tempo of the main body. When the distance from the guard line to the main body boundary exceeds 10 kilometers, commanders must consider using two troops abreast to ensure the troop maintaining contact with the main body is not over tasked, and can match the tempo of the main body.

0353. An Air Cavalry Troop may maintain contact with the main body or a following troop may perform route reconnaissance along the route of advance. The lead troop does not reconnoiter the battle positions or occupy them unless required when contact is made.

0354. The rest of the squadron marches along the route of advance and occupies battle positions as necessary. Criteria for the route are the same as in the moving flank screen. Troop-size battle positions are designated parallel to the axis of the main body, exterior to the squadron route of advance, and along the avenues of approach into the squadron. Follow-on troops reconnoiter these battle positions as they occupy them. Scouts occupy OPs along a screen line forward of the battle positions.

0355. Since the squadron is moving in one direction and orienting in another, the squadron commander plans control measures that facilitate this dual orientation. An objective may be assigned for orientation or to secure the flank of the main body objective. An air cavalry troop may assist the lead troop, reconnoiter the line of blocking positions, or screen the flank of the squadron beyond the blocking positions. Attached Company Teams may prepare to occupy battle positions, or they may be used to form a reserve.

0356. The squadron combat trains move with the squadron. Normally, the field trains move with the forward support battalion of the nearest brigade or with the regimental support squadron.

0357. Two methods may be used to initiate the moving flank guard operation. These methods are based on how the main body crosses the line of departure. The squadron should not make its own penetration of the line of contact when facing prepared enemy defenses. To do so may prevent or significantly delay the squadron in the assumption of the flank guard.

0358. In the first method, the squadron crosses the line of departure separately from the main body and deploys to perform the mission (see Figure 3-15). This method keeps the two forces from interfering with one another and it is faster. This method is appropriate when the line of contact has been penetrated by another force or the main body is not in contact with the enemy.

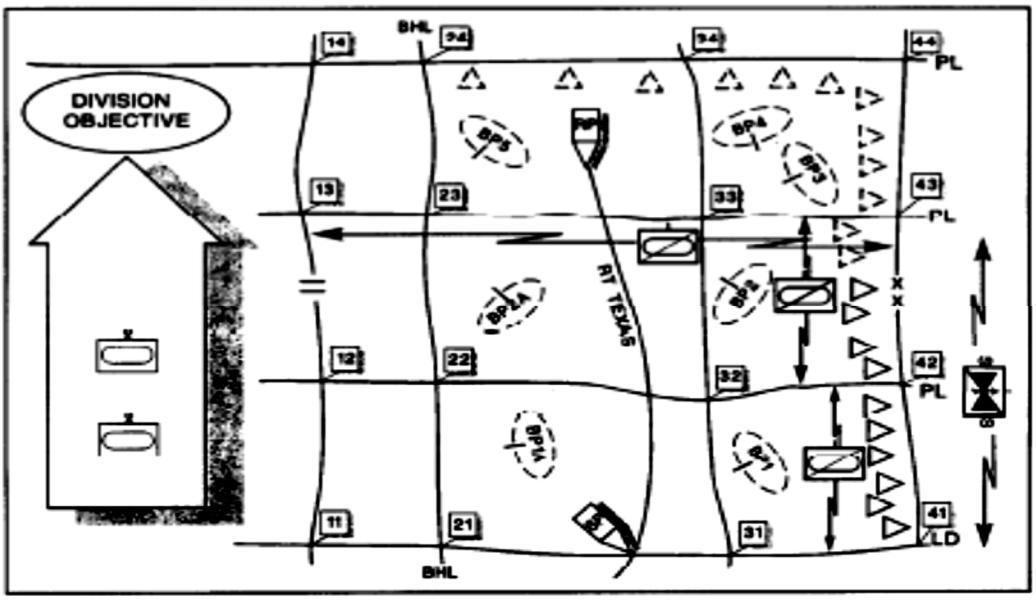


Figure 3.15 - Moving Flank Guard (Method One)

0359. In the second method, the squadron crosses the line of departure with the main body and then deploys out into the zone (see Figure 3-16). This method is appropriate when the division makes its own penetration of the enemy defenses along the line of contact. The squadron may follow the lead battalion task force of the division through the gap and deploy when the situation permits. Alternatively, the squadron follows the combat elements of the lead brigade. This method is slower, but provides security for the squadron before assuming the flank guard.

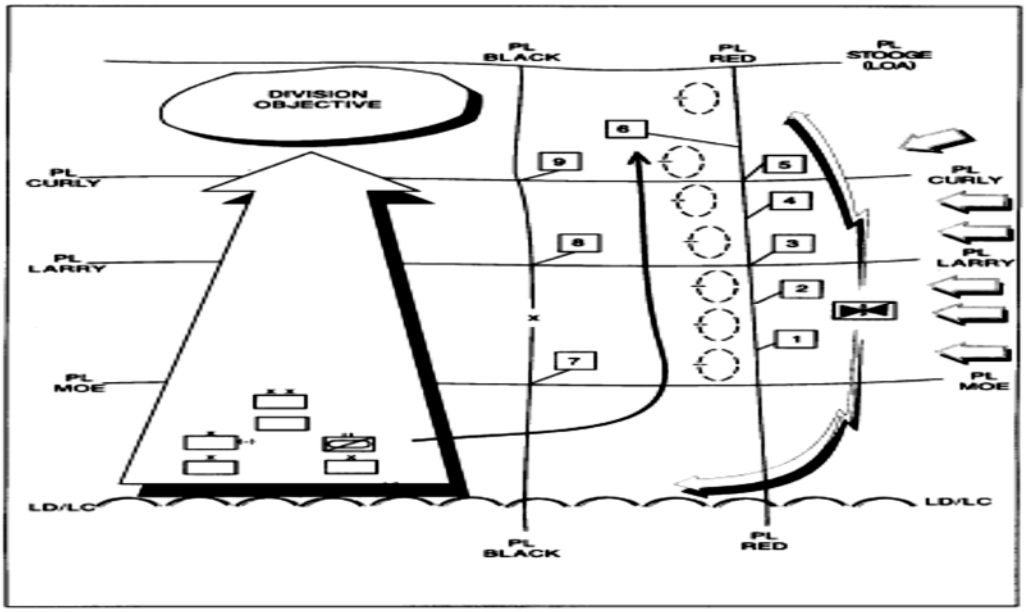


Figure 3.16 - Moving Flank Guard (Method Two)

0360. The squadron regulates movement along the route of advance by the pace of the protected force, distance to the objective, and the enemy situation. There are three methods of movement that the squadron may use:

a. Successive bounds;

b. Alternate bounds; and

c. Continuous marching.

0361. Table 3-2 summarizes these methods. If the protected force stops, the squadron occupies blocking positions. As the speed of the main body changes, the squadron changes movement methods. The squadron commander must not allow the squadron to fall behind the main body or present a lucrative target by remaining stationary along the route.

Table 3.2 - Flank Guard Movement

METHOD	CONSIDERATIONS	ADVANTAGES	DISADVANTAGES
Successive Bounds	Enemy contact likely; Main body slow; Bound by troops in succession or simultaneously	Most secure	Slowest
Alternate Bounds	Enemy contact likely; Main body slow; Troops bound from rear to front	Secure; Faster than successive	
Continuous Marching	Enemy contact not likely; Main body fast; Troops remain in march column on route; Air screen on flank	Fastest	Least secure

0362. If the squadron becomes overextended, the squadron commander informs the main body commander and recommends one of the following courses of action:

a. Reinforce the squadron;

b. Reduce the squadron’s area of responsibility; and

c. Screen a portion of the area and guard the rest.

0363. The squadron does not needlessly overextend itself by continuing to occupy positions that have been passed by the rear of the protected force.

Rear Guard

0364. A rear guard protects the exposed rear of the main body. This may occur during offensive operations when the protected force breaks contact with the FLOT or during retrograde operations. The rear guard deploys and defends for both moving and stationary main bodies. The critical tasks listed for the stationary flank guard apply. The rear guard for a moving force displaces to successive battle positions along phase lines in depth as the main body moves. The nature of enemy contact determines the method of displacement.

0365. Establishing the rear guard during retrograde operations may be done in two ways. The squadron may relieve other units in place along the FLOT as they move to the rear. Alternatively, the squadron may establish a position in depth behind the main body and pass those forces through. PAM 3-02 discusses Retrograde Operation.

Cover

0366. A covering force accomplishes all the tasks of screening and guard forces. Additionally, a covering force operates apart from the main body to develop the situation early and deceives, disorganizes, and destroys enemy forces. Unlike screening or guard forces, a covering force is tactically self-contained and capable of operating independently of the main body. Cover may be performed as an offensive or defensive mission. A covering force, or portions of it, will often become decisively engaged with enemy forces; therefore, the covering force must have substantial combat power to engage the enemy and still accomplish its mission.

0367. The requirements placed upon the covering force, the command and control structure necessary for the forces involved, and the large areas of operations involved requires an adequate level of command for successful accomplishment. Should the division be required to establish a covering force, it does so with a reinforced brigade. The division cavalry squadron may participate as part of the division covering force performing reconnaissance or security missions. If the division sector is narrow enough, an adequately reinforced cavalry squadron may perform cover.

0368. A covering force performs the following functions:

a. Operates beyond the artillery range of the main body. The distance from the main body is determined by METT-TC factors. A reinforced regiment may act as a covering force as far as 50 to 60 kilometers from the main body.

b. Develops the situation earlier than a guard force, fights longer and more often, and defeats larger enemy forces.

c. Reconnoiters, screens, attacks, defends, and delays as necessary. These missions are normally performed by subordinate elements of the covering force.

d. Must not allow it to be bypassed.

e. An offensive covering force seizes the initiative early for the main body commander, allowing him to attack decisively. A defensive covering force prevents the enemy from attacking at the time, place, and combat strength of his choosing. Defensive cover is intended to disrupt the enemy's attack, destroy his initiative, and sets him up for defeat.

Offensive Cover

0369. During offensive operations, a covering force may operate in front or flanks of the main body. Offensive covering forces perform the following functions:

a. Conduct reconnaissance along the main body's axis of advance.

b. Deny the enemy information about the size, strength, composition and objective of the main body.

c. Destroy or repel enemy reconnaissance and security zone forces.

d. Develop the situation to determine enemy strengths, weaknesses, and dispositions.

e. Defeat, repel, or fix enemy forces as directed by the higher commander.

f. Exploit opportunities until main body forces are committed.

0370. **Advance Covering Force.** An advance covering force is conducted forward of the main body and has enough combat power to:

a. Locate and penetrate the security zone and forward defenses of an enemy force deployed to defend.

b. Destroy enemy reconnaissance, advance guard units, and as required, the first-echelon regiments of a moving enemy force.

0371. An advance covering force is similar to a zone reconnaissance or movement to contact. The distance operates forward of the main body depends on METT-TC and the intent and instructions of the main body commander (see Figure. 3-17).

0372. Planning for advance covering force operations is similar to the zone reconnaissance or movement to contact. The width of the zone to be covered, and areas or routes of special importance are determined by mission analysis and IPB. Specific missions for subordinate squadrons are determined. Squadron or battalion boundaries are then assigned.

0373. The covering force commander will retain a reserve. The reserve may be centrally located and ready to be deployed anywhere in the covering force zone, located in the most dangerous or critical portion of the covering force zone, or positioned to support the covering force commander's tactical scheme of maneuver by executing a specific mission. Squadron commanders normally retain their tank company as the squadron reserve. The reserve must be prepared to attack, counterattack, or defend.

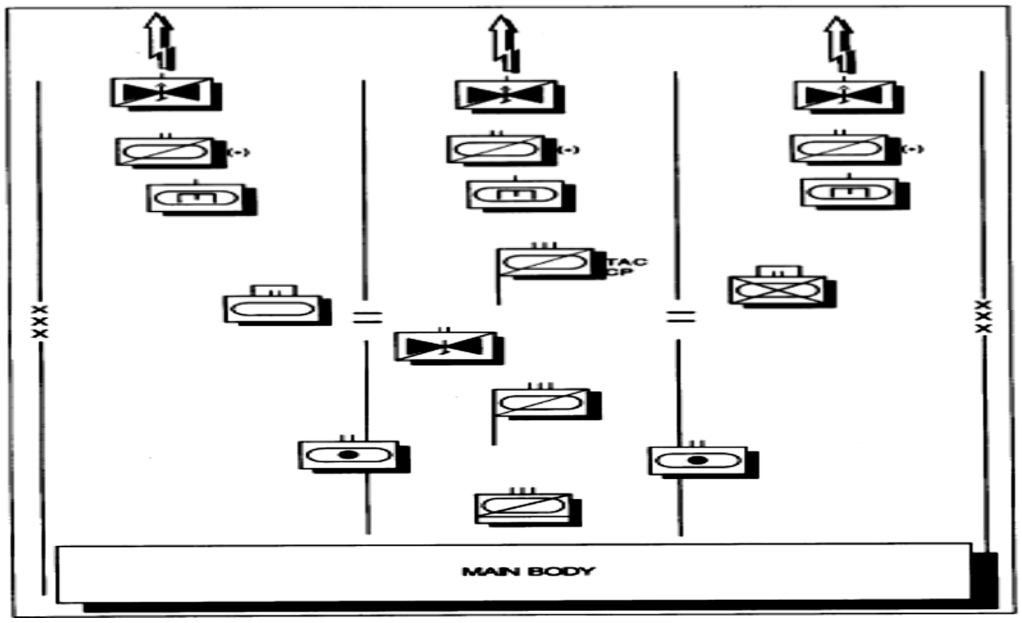


Figure 3.17 - Reinforced Cavalry Squadron Performing Advance

0374. Air cavalry normally reconnoiters forward of advancing ground squadrons or battalions. Upon enemy contact, the air cavalry reports the enemy location to the ground unit in that zone and maintains contact. Once contact is made, the situation is rapidly developed. Supporting artillery fires are called in by air and ground scouts, and the enemy force is fixed and destroyed by fire and movement. The covering force will not bypass enemy forces without the permission of the main body commander.

0375. When the covering force can advance no further, it defends and prepares to assist the forward passage of lines at main body units. It continues to perform close reconnaissance of enemy positions to locate gaps or vulnerable flanks. It reports enemy dispositions immediately to the main body commander so that he can exploit enemy weaknesses. The covering force may guide main body units as they attack through or around the covering force. If the covering force has done its job well, the main body commander will be able to attack the enemy's weak point at the time of his choosing with previously uncommitted main body forces.

0376. If the squadron finds a gap in enemy defenses, it prepares to aggressively penetrate and disrupt the integrity of the defense. The squadron commander reports this to the brigade/division commander immediately so he can divert follow-on forces. The squadron penetration is synchronized with the arrival of other maneuver units, combat support, and combat service support to prevent its subsequent isolation and destruction by counter attacking enemy forces. Caution should not needlessly delay

the squadron. The squadron is ideally organized to seize the initiative by penetrating, keeping the enemy off balance until the main body can move to reinforce the effort.

0377. **Flank Covering Force.** A flank covering force is a security force operating to the flank of a moving or stationary force. A flank covering force mission is normally assigned if the main body commander perceives a significant threat to one of his flanks. The flank covering force is conducted much the same as a flank guard (see Figure 3-18). The main differences between the two missions are the scope of operations and the distance the covering force operates from the main body.

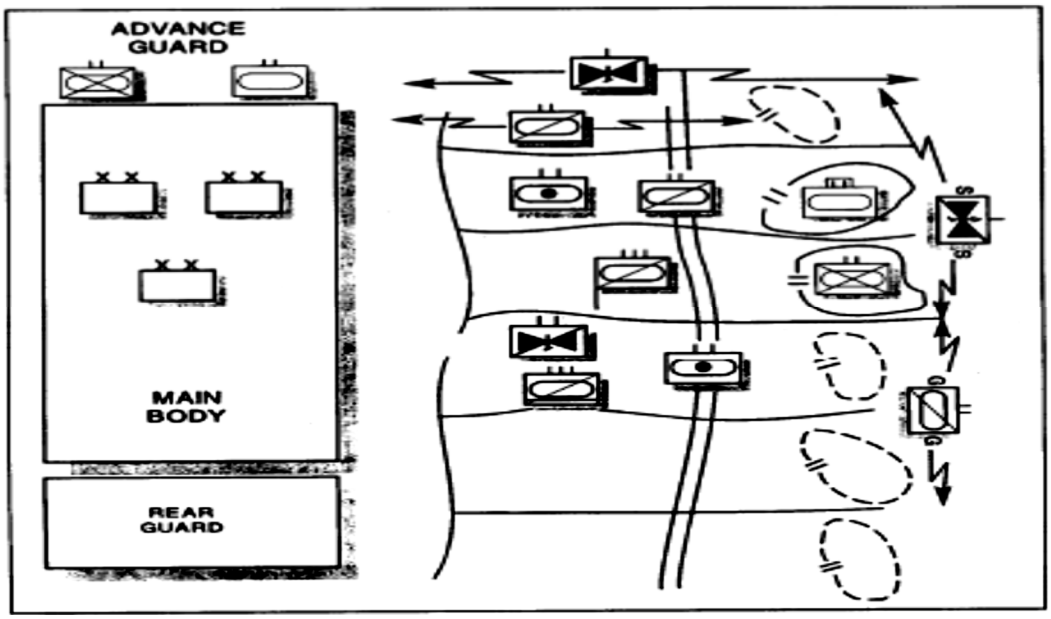


Figure 3.18 - Reinforced Cavalry Squadron Performing Flank Cover

0378. The area of operations for the flank covering force and the force to be protected are designated by the commander assigning the mission. Just as in the flank guard mission, the flank covering force must clear the area between its route of advance and the main body. It must also maintain contact with an element of the main body specified by the main body commander. This element is normally part of the advance guard for the flank division of the main body.

0379. Air cavalry is invaluable in the conduct of a moving flank covering force. Integration of air and ground operations is essential. Air cavalry may be used to:

a. Assist in clearing the area between the covering force and the main body.

b. Assist in maintaining contact with the protected force.

c. Screen to the front of the units conducting the flank covering force.

Defensive Cover

0380. A defensive covering force operates to the front, flanks, or rear of a main body deploying to defend. Defensive cover is performed most frequently forward of the

brigade/division main body (see Figure. 3-19). The primary mission of a defensive covering force is to make the enemy reveal his main effort, disrupt his attack, and destroy his initiative. Defensive covering forces perform the following functions:

a. Maintains continuous surveillance of battalion-size avenues of approach.

b. Destroys or repels enemy reconnaissance and security forces in order to deceive enemy of the disposition and location of main defensive effort.

c. Determines the size, strength, composition, and direction of the enemy's main effort.

d. Defeats lead enemy echelons as directed.

e. Forces the commitment of and maintain contact with enemy second-echelon forces.

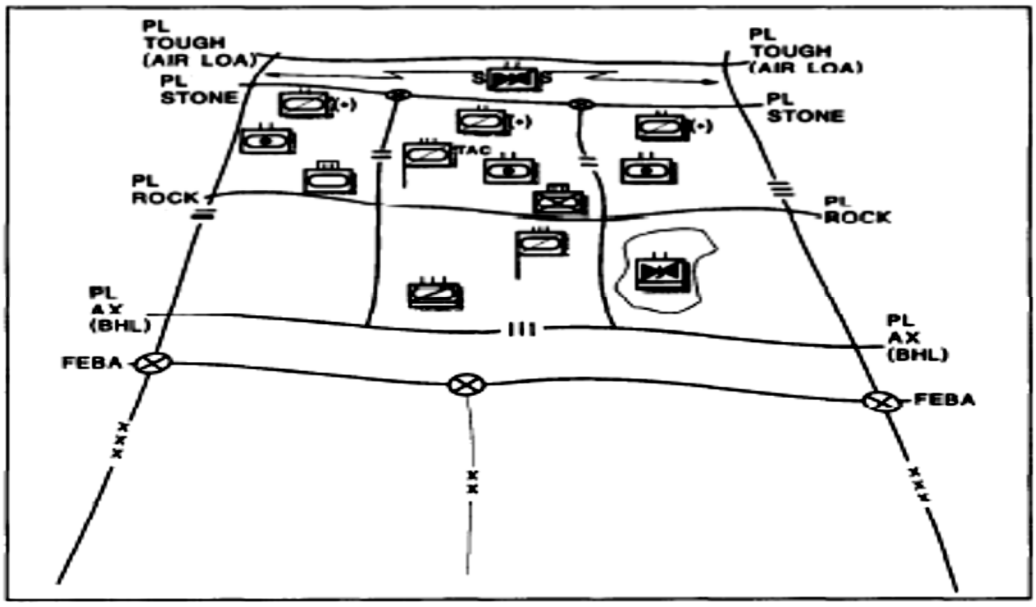


Figure 3.19 - Reinforced Cavalry Squadron Performing Defensive Cover

0381. The main body commander designates the forward and rear boundaries of the security force with phase lines. The lateral boundaries of the security area are normally extensions of the main body boundaries. The rear boundary of the security force is the battle handover line, which should be within range of main body artillery. The squadron designates additional control measures to help control the operation.

0382. The Squadron Commander assigns sectors to each troop. Squadron missions are normally defend in sector or delay. If certain terrain is key to the operation, battle positions may be assigned to battalion task forces. Squadron commanders have the same options in the deployment of their units. If the terrain and situation permits, the squadron boundaries should be the extensions of the boundaries in corresponding main body units (divisions and brigades). This will serve to simplify the battle handover, and the transfer of control in any supporting assets from the covering force to main body units.

0383. Reserves are critical to a defensive cover. They allow the covering force commander to seize the initiative during the early stages of an enemy attack. The tank company is the squadron commander's primary reserve force. Ground reserve forces are normally positioned in depth and prepared to execute a series of contingency missions (such as counterattack, block, support ground squadron, and assume defensive sector). Aviation reserves may counterattack in coordination with ground reserves, conduct joint air attack team operations, attack deep to delay second-echelon enemy forces, support ground squadrons, and react to unforeseen enemy actions.

0384. As in any cavalry mission, integration of ground and air operations is critical to the success of the defensive covering force mission. The Air Cavalry can assist the reconnaissance of the security area as the regiment moves forward, screen forward of the covering force, cover areas between ground units, and assist in the disengagement of ground units (especially valuable during the conduct of battle handover and passage of lines with the main body).

0385. Battle handover and passage of lines is inherent in the conduct of defensive cover. This is a complex and dangerous task, and must be thoroughly planned as an integral part of the covering force mission.

0386. Battle handover and passage of lines may not occur simultaneously for all covering force units. As some units begin passage, others may still be taking advantage of offensive opportunities in other parts of the security area. The squadron commander prepares to continue fighting in those portions of the security area where his forces are successful in order to set up offensive opportunities for the brigade/division.

a. **Flank Security Force.** A defensive flank cover is performed in the same manner as defensive cover forward to the protected force.

b. **Rear Covering Force.** A rear covering force mission is similar to a rear guard mission. A rear covering force normally protects a force moving away from the enemy. The covering force deploys behind the forward maneuver units of the main body, conducts battle handover and passage of lines, and then defends or delays. Alternatively, the covering force may conduct a relief in place as part of a deception plan or to take advantage of the best defensive terrain.

0387. The squadrons establish passage points and assist the rearward passage of the main body, as necessary. From that point on, the mission is conducted the same as any other defensive covering force operation. As the main body moves, the covering force displaces to subsequent phase lines in depth. If the enemy does not follow the withdrawing forces, contact may eventually be lost. Fighting a defense or delay is necessary if the enemy detects the movement and attacks.

Area Security

0388. Area security is a form of security that includes reconnaissance and security of designated personnel, airfields, unit convoys, facilities, and main supply routes, lines of communications, equipment, and critical points.

0389. An area security force neutralizes or defeats enemy operations in a specified area. It operates in an area delineated by the headquarters assigning the area security mission. It screens, reconnoiters, attacks, defends, and delays as necessary to accomplish its mission. Area security operations may be offensive or defensive in two. Commanders may balance the level of security measures with the type and level of threat posed in the specific area; however, all-around security is essential.

0390. Area security operations are conducted to deny the enemy the ability to influence friendly actions in a specific area or to deny the enemy use of an area for his own purposes. This may entail occupying and establishing a 360-degree perimeter around the area being secured; or taking actions to destroy enemy forces already present. The area to be secured may range from specific points (bridges, defiles) to areas such as terrain features (ridgelines, hills) to large population centers and adjacent areas. Proper IPB is vital to provide adequate security for the assigned area. The factors of METT-TC and unit capability will determine specific unit missions. Factors are as follows:

a. The natural defensive characteristics of the terrain.

b. Existing roads and waterways for military lines of communication and civilian commerce.

c. The control of land and water areas and avenues of approach surrounding the area to be secured extending to a range beyond that of enemy artillery, rockets, and mortars.

d. The control of airspace.

e. The proximity to critical sites such as airfields, power generation plants, and civic buildings.

0391. Due to the possibility of commanders tying their forces to fixed installations or sites, these types of security missions may become defensive in nature. This must be carefully balanced with the need for offensive action. Early warning of enemy activity is paramount in the conduct of area security missions and provides the commander with the time to react to any threat. Proper reconnaissance and surveillance planning coupled with dismounted/mounted patrols and aerial reconnaissance is key to successful operations.

0392. A perimeter is established when a unit must secure an area where the defense is not tied into an adjacent unit. Perimeters vary in shape depending on METT-TC. If the commander determines the most probable direction of enemy attack, he may weigh that part of the perimeter to cover that approach. The perimeter shape conforms to the terrain features that best use observation and fields of fire.

0393. Perimeters are divided into troop/platoon sectors with boundaries and contact points. Mutual support and coordination between defensive elements require careful planning, positioning, and coordination due to the circular aspects of the perimeter. A screen line is established, integrating OPs, ground surveillance radar, and patrols. Tanks and anti-armor weapons systems are placed on armor-restrictive terrain and high-speed avenues of approach. Likely enemy drop zones or landing zones are identified and kept under observation. Air cavalry assets, if available, are integrated into the reconnaissance and surveillance plan. Figure 3-20 depicts an armored cavalry squadron conducting an area security of an urban area.

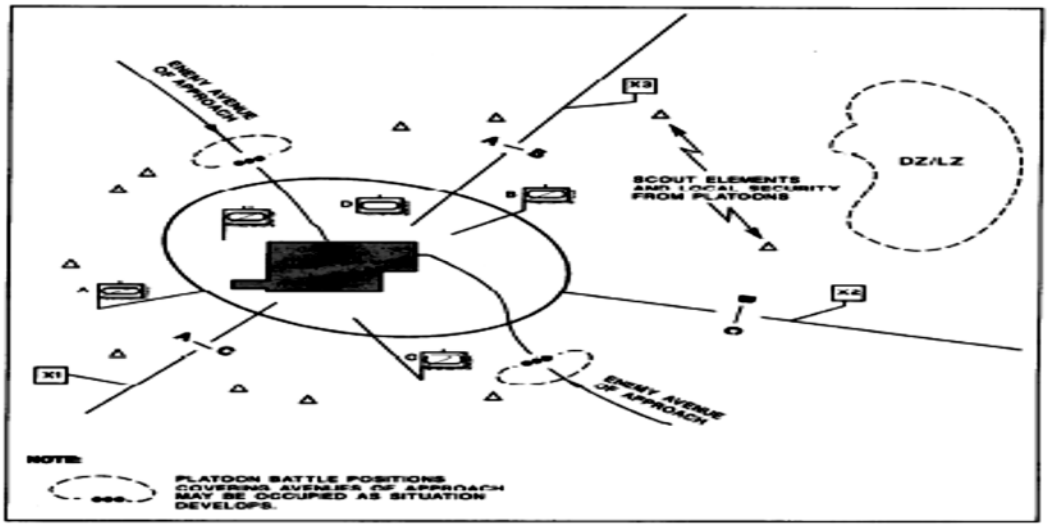


Figure 3.20 - Cavalry Squadron Conducting Area Security

0394. Depth is provided through the use of subsequent fighting positions and mobile reserves. The mobility and firepower of armored forces will allow for rapid traverse of large areas and the ability to quickly mass to destroy any enemy penetration. The size of the reserve depends on the size of its parent unit and the tactical situation. Immediate reaction to intelligence information or any type of attack is vital. This reaction to accurate and timely intelligence may permit destruction of enemy elements prior to an attack on the area being secured. Reaction operations or commitment of the reserve is simple, planned, and rehearsed day and night.

0395. Combat support and combat service support elements may support from within the area being secured or from another location, depending on the mission and status of the unit, the type of transport available, the weather, and the terrain. Area security missions are conducted by platoons, cavalry troops, squadrons, and regiments who employ the techniques of screen, guard, offense, and defense, depending on the nature and purpose of the mission.

Route Security

0396. Cavalry squadrons conduct route security missions to prevent enemy ground maneuver forces or insurgents from coming within direct fire range of the protected route. A route security force operates on and to the flanks of a designated route. Route security operations are defensive in nature and, unlike guard operations, are terrain oriented. A route security force prevents an enemy force from impeding, harassing,

containing, seizing, or destroying traffic along the route. To accomplish this task, the force will perform the following functions:

a. Conducts continuous mounted and dismounted reconnaissance of the route and key locations along the route to ensure the route is trafficable.
b. Conducts sweeps of the route at irregular intervals to prevent emplacement of enemy mines along the route.

c. Cordons sections of the route to search suspected enemy locations.

d. Establishes roadblocks/checkpoints along the route and lateral routes to stop and search vehicles and persons on the route and those entering the route.

e. Occupies key locations and terrain along or near the route. If possible, establish a screen line oriented to prevent enemy direct fire weapons and observation from influencing the route.

f. Aggressively conducts ground and aerial patrols to maintain route security.

0397. While route security is a mission commonly associated with environments of conflict or peace, it may be executed under the environmental conditions of war as well. Usually due to the distances involved in securing a route, squadrons will be assigned route security missions. Subordinate ground troops could conduct the following missions:

a. Screen.

b. Zone, area, and route reconnaissance.

c. Cordon and search.

d. Establish traffic control points.

e. Defend.

f. Hasty attack.

g. Raid

0398. Air Cavalry Troop could conduct the following missions:

a. Screen.

b. Zone, area, and route reconnaissance.

c. Hasty attack.

d. Raid.

0399. Enemy forces may try to sever supply routes and lines of communications by

various methods. Roads, waterways, and railways may be mined; ambush sites can be located adjacent to the route being secured; or bridges and tunnels can be destroyed by demolitions. Due to the nature of this mission, very long routes may be extremely difficult to secure; however, measures can be enforced to reduce the effect of enemy forces. Figure 3-21 depicts an armored cavalry squadron conducting a route security mission.

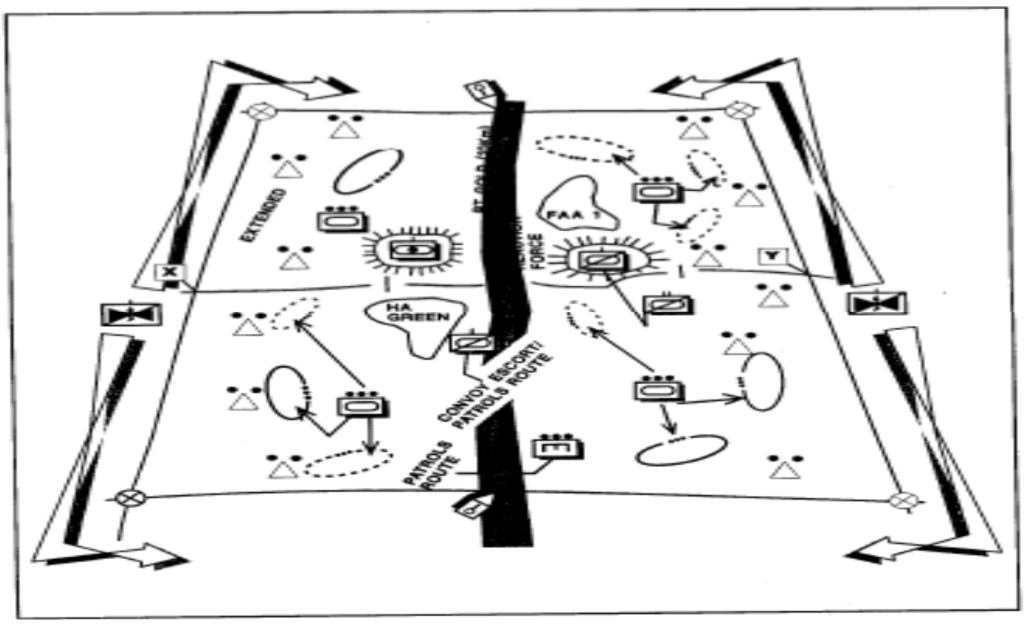


Figure 3.21 - Cavalry Squadron Conducting Route Security

03100. Patrolling the route, mounted and dismounted, greatly increases the chances of detecting enemy forces before they can effectively emplace mines or demolitions, or establish ambushes or roadblocks. Patrolling is performed regularly, but patrols should not establish a routine. This helps avoid possible enemy ambushes and aids in detection of enemy forces. Patrols must be aware of probable ambush sites and choke points where roadblocks or mines and demolitions would be effective. Personnel conducting patrols must be trained in detecting mines and booby traps. Patrols are organized with enough combat power to survive initial enemy contact. Recent enemy activity provides guidance on the organization of patrols.

03101. Patrols can be augmented with combat engineers, infantry (both light and mechanized forces), military police, or other assets, when available, to increase their combat capability. Usually, lack of combat power prohibits a patrol's ability to deal with large enemy forces; therefore, indirect fire plans and air cavalry assets should be integrated into the patrol plan at all times when available.

03102. Roadblocks, checkpoints, and guard posts may be placed at crucial choke points (such as bridges and tunnels) to effectively prevent acts of sabotage to keep the route open and available to friendly forces. Forces stop and search vehicles and persons before they proceed. Forces do not allow vehicles to stop on or under bridges or in tunnels.

03103. Personnel maintain constant surveillance over critical checkpoints at night by the use of night vision equipment integrating ground surveillance radars and sensors

to cover the immediate and surrounding areas. Mining indirect approaches to sensitive areas may help lessen the chances of a ground attack. Artillery fires are planned to assist in defeating enemy attempts to influence the critical areas. Personnel construct bunkers to protect observation posts and to provide positions from which to fight until reinforced.

03104. Air Cavalry assets can assist in securing the route by conducting patrols, effectively covering large areas in a short time. Additionally, air cavalry troops can assist in maintaining the screen line or perimeter securing the route.

03105. Engineers help to keep the route open. Engineers assist in locating and clearing mines, clearing terrain at potential ambush sites, and repairing damage to roads and trails. Engineers can also assist in preparing defensive systems around critical areas and choke points.

Convoy Security

03106. Convoy security operations are conducted when insufficient friendly forces are available to continuously secure lines of communication in an area of operations. They may also be conducted in conjunction with route security operations. A convoy security force operates to the front, flanks, and rear of a convoy element moving along a designated route. Convoy security operations are offensive in nature and orient on the force being protected.

03107. A convoy security mission has certain critical tasks that guide planning and execution. To protect a convoy, the security force must accomplish the following critical tasks:

a. Reconnoiter the route the convoy will travel.

b. Clears the route of obstacles or positions from which the enemy could influence movement along the route.

c. Provides early warning and prevent the enemy from impeding, harassing, containing, seizing, or destroying the convoy.

03108. Convoy security operations are performed as a minimum by a cavalry troop. Cavalry troops are well suited to the requirements of protecting a convoy due to their organic reconnaissance capability and combat power. The cavalry troop may be reinforced with engineers and military police. METT-TC considerations, such as restrictive terrain and limited time, may dictate a coordinated effort with air cavalry assets.

03109. The convoy security force is organized into three or four elements (see Figure 3-22):

a. **Reconnaissance Element.** The Reconnaissance Element performs tasks associated with zone and route reconnaissance forward of the convoy.

b. **Screen Element.** The Screen Element provides early warning and security to the convoy's flanks and rear.

c. **Escort Element.** The Escort Element provides close-in protection to the convoy. May also provide a reaction force to assist in repelling or destroying enemy contact.

d. **Reaction Force.** Provides firepower and support to the elements above in order to assist in developing the situation or conducting a hasty attack. May also perform duties of the escort element.

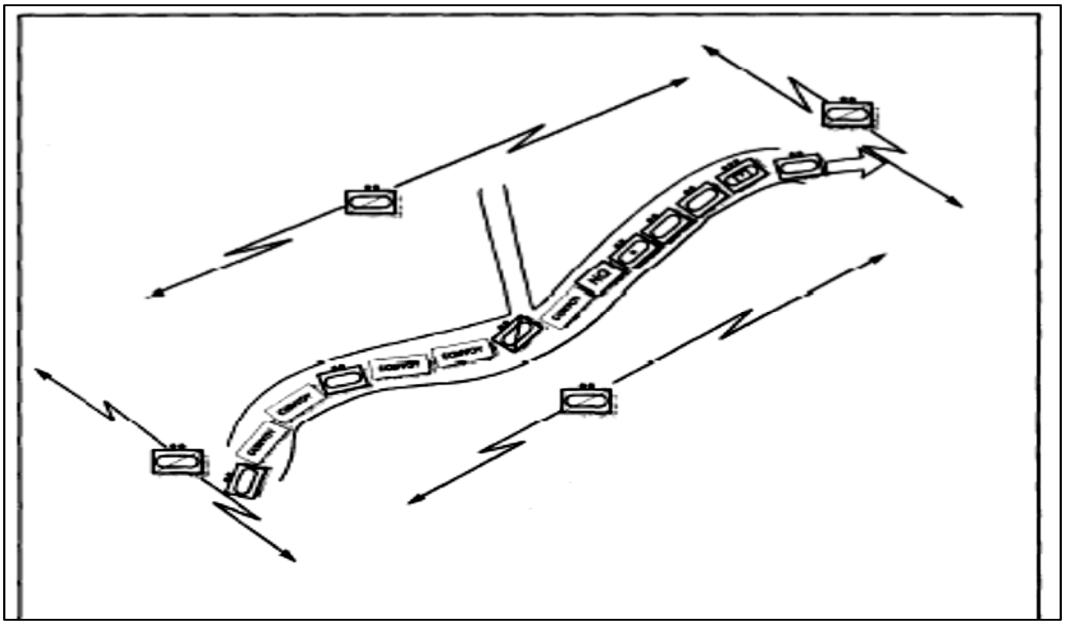


Figure 3.22 - Cavalry Troop Conducting Convoy Security

03110. Commanders plan and execute all movements of troops and supplies as tactical operations. Convoy security operations are conducted in high risk areas that are not controlled by friendly forces; medium risk areas where friendly forces operate but have been frequented by insurgents, and low risk areas where the friendly forces have control of the area. Due to the inherent dangers of convoy operations, emphasis is on extensive security measures. These security measures include the following:

a. Secrecy when planning and disseminating orders, strict noise and light discipline during movement, and varying routes and schedules.

b. Coordination with supporting air units to ensure an understanding of air support used to assist the movement, both in enforcing preventive measures and in conducting close combat operations.

c. Fire support elements that provide close and continuous fire support for the movement.

d. Maneuver for counter ambush actions. This includes contingency plans for immediate actions against an ambush and use of formations, which allows part of the column to be in position to maneuver against an ambush force.

e. Communications and coordination with supporting units and units along the route, and higher headquarters, to include airborne radio relay.

f. Various locations for leaders, communications, medical support, and weapons systems within the movement formation.
g. Questions asked of the local civilians along the movement route for intelligence information, to include possible enemy ambush sites.

03111. Convoy security mission generates unique requirements that the commander and staff must take into account when formulating a plan. The convoy security commander and his subordinates are briefed on the latest information regarding on the enemy situation and an area through which the convoy will pass. The commander formulates his plans and issues his orders, to include formation, intervals between echelons and vehicles, rate of travel, and detailed plans for actions if an enemy force is encountered. Since there is seldom time to issue orders during an ambush, leaders plan the escort element and reaction force element actions should an ambush occur. These actions should be rehearsed prior to movement and executed as drills in the event of enemy contact.

03112. A quick reaction force may be maintained by the higher headquarters command. The quick reaction force will remain at high alert, monitoring the progress of the convoy and ready to respond if the convoy encounters an enemy unit that is greater than the security element's capability. Enemy forces must be convinced that ambushes will produce a fast, relentless, hard-hitting response. The ready reaction forces may have to be moved forward so they can respond quickly if the convoy is moving a long distance.

03113. Communications are vital to the success of movements. Leaders plan radio communication and ensure availability between convoy elements and indirect fire support assets, air cavalry assets, and with units and population centers in the areas along the route of movement. Visual and sound signals are pre-arranged. These signals include colored smoke, identification panels, and whistles or horn signals. While limited, these communications means are effective when pre-arranged signals and responses are understood and rehearsed.

03114. Units must ensure that artillery and mortar support is planned to support the entire route of movement. Units may have mortars integrated into the escort element itself or may have indirect fire support provided by artillery elements that are positioned along the route. Coordination with Fire Direction Centers (FDC) that can provide fire along the route of movement ensures that FISTs can enter the FDC net, send routine location reports, and request and adjust fires. Leaders must coordinate call signs, frequencies, areas of employment, schedules of movement, and target numbers prior to the convoy movement.

03115. Air cavalry assets, if available, can participate in the convoy security operation by screening the convoy movement as the element moves along the route of march or

by assisting in clearing the route ahead of the convoy in conjunction with the route reconnaissance element. Air cavalry can also assist by controlling indirect fire and directing on-call close air support. For support, the air cavalry units must know what the maneuver intentions of the ground elements are should contact with the enemy occur.

03116. Convoy security operations in an urban environment or built-up area require different emphasis and techniques than those in rural areas. The population density and characteristics of the area require the use of non-lethal weapons and the careful application of weapons of destruction. When applying minimum-essential force to minimize loss of life and destruction of property, leaders must conduct detailed planning, coordination, and control.

03117. Convoys, whenever possible, should move through populated areas during times that these areas are least congested and therefore less dangerous to the security of the convoy. Convoy operations may require assistance from military police or local police and other government agencies to secure the route prior to the convoy entering the built-up area.

03118. The squadron S4 and unit commanders must carefully plan for combat service support in convoy security operations. Fuel and maintenance elements should be included in the convoy itself or prepositioned in secured areas along the route. A detailed pre combat inspection must be performed to ensure that vehicles are full of fuel, PMCS have been performed, and potential maintenance problems are eliminated before the convoy starts movement.

03119. Casualty evacuation must be planned in detail along the entire movement route. Coordination must occur and be maintained between the convoy security forces; the squadron aid station, the squadron command post, the CTCP, and designated units along the route to ensure immediate medical support is available. Due to the possibility of operating over extended distances from the squadron aid station, aero medical evacuation is the preferred means of evacuation and must be planned and rehearsed in detail.

Chapter IV
Cavalry in the Offense

0401. Offense is the decisive form of war. The main purpose of the offense is to defeat, destroy, or neutralize an enemy force. The Army doctrine emphasizes the necessity to quickly seize the initiative. The commander uses initiative to select the time and place to concentrate and synchronize his combat power to overcome the enemy defense; destroy his command, control, and communications system; and to defeat him in detail. Initiative is used at lower echelons to achieve the commander's intent.

0402. Brigades and battalion task forces are the principal offensive force in the division. Cavalry units normally perform reconnaissance and security missions in support of brigade/division offensive operations. Cavalry units may also perform certain offensive operations. These are normally performed during the conduct of reconnaissance or security missions. If required, cavalry units may perform offensive operations as an economy of force for the division.

0403. The ability of cavalry units to find the enemy, to develop the situation, and to provide the commander with reaction time and security make them ideal for economy of force. The division cavalry squadron often requires augmentation with additional combat, combat support, and combat service support assets. Augmentation requirements are based on the organization and status of the squadron and the situation.

Economy of Force Role

0404. Offensive missions may be assigned to cavalry as an economy of force by the division commander. Economy of force is a principle of war that refers to the allocation of minimum essential combat power to secondary efforts so that forces may be concentrated in an area where a decision is sought. The commander assumes risk when assigning an economy-of-force role to have decisive combat power elsewhere.

0405. The Cavalry is a natural organization around which to build an economy of force. This allows the commander to preserve the combat power of divisions, brigades, and battalion task forces for the main effort. As an economy of force, cavalry may attack, perform movement to contact and spoiling attack, raid, defend, delay or conduct deception operations.

0406. To the commander executing a mission, economy of force is the intent. These missions are performed in the same manner as any other offensive mission, but often entail greater risk and intensity. When assigned a mission as an economy of force, cavalry loses its ability to perform reconnaissance and security in support of the corps or division. The risk entailed in the mission may result to a long-term loss or reduction of the unit's capability as well. These considerations are weighed against the requirement to perform the mission in an economy-of-force role.

Cavalry Squadron Role

0407. During reconnaissance operations, the squadron may conduct hasty attacks to destroy enemy reconnaissance and security forces encountered. Hasty attacks may also occur during security missions. These hasty attacks are a part of actions on contact. During an advance guard, the squadron commander may assign movement to contact to subordinate troops or attached maneuver companies to focus the effort on finding and defeating the enemy.

0408. The squadron can perform offensive operations as an economy of force for the division commander. The specific situation may require, however, that the squadron be reinforced to perform the mission desired by the division commander. The squadron commander makes this assessment and recommends the minimum additional combat power required to perform the mission if none is already provided. These missions may involve decisive engagement that the squadron will have to fight to a conclusion with the forces available.

Armored Cavalry Troop or Company Team Role

0409. Ground troops may perform zone or route reconnaissance during a squadron offensive operation. A troop may perform movement to contact as part of a squadron advance guard mission or offensive operation. They conduct hasty attacks as required during all missions. During the squadron's attack on an objective, the troop may provide the supporting attack, security along an exposed flank, or reconnaissance to guide the main attack.

0410. Attached company teams form an ideal reserve force for the cavalry. They provide the assault force to attack the objective. This causes the least disruption to the operational teamwork of the squadron prior to the attack. If the enemy forces are already clearly identified on the objective, the company team may conduct the main attack for the squadron.

Battlefield Framework of the Offense

0411. Offensive operations are organized into three complementary elements: deep, close, and rear operations.

0412. **Deep Operations.** In critical parts of the attack zone, deep operations contribute to the success of the close fight. Deep operations limit the enemy's options and disrupt its coordination and synchronization. Deep operations are conducted against enemy forces out of contact using indirect fires, electronic warfare, air interdiction, Army aviation, deception, and maneuver forces. These operations are performed by division commanders. Identification division operations assist the squadron in targeting units and setting priorities for brigade/division deep operations.

0413. **Close Operations.** The main attack, with supporting attacks as necessary, is identified. The commander designates the main effort and allocates the necessary combat power and combat support assets to ensure its success. Reconnaissance and security operations are conducted forward and to the flanks and rear of the main and

supporting attacks. The reserve force and potential missions are clearly designated and available for commitment at the decisive point and time.

0414. **Rear Operations.** Rear operations are necessary to maintain offensive momentum. Rear operations ensure freedom of action of committed and uncommitted forces and protect the means necessary to sustain offensive operations and support the force. Lines of communications, reserves, and displacing support elements are logical targets for enemy deep operations. Commanders protect them by planning for and remaining capable of quick reaction to any posed threat.

Forms of Maneuver

0415. Forms of maneuver are the general orientation of a force approaching an enemy. Commanders determine which form of maneuver to use by careful analysis of METT-T. However, this is an art — not a science — and more than one form of maneuver may apply. Forms of maneuver include envelopment, the turning movement, penetration, frontal attack, and infiltration. Frequently, an attack will use more than one form of maneuver. Not all forms of maneuver are appropriate for squadrons or troops. They are the basis for the scheme of maneuver used during any operation when the commander decides to attack the enemy force.

0416. Envelopment**.** Envelopment uses movement and fires to put greater relative combat power against the defender and strip him of his advantages. To use this form of maneuver, commanders must find or create an assailable flank. The Cavalry commanders locate unassailable flank through aggressive reconnaissance. Sometimes the enemy will expose his flank by his own forward movement, unaware of his opponent's location.

0417. In a fluid battle involving noncontiguous forces, the combination of air and indirect fires may isolate the enemy on unfavorable terrain and establish the conditions for maneuver against an assailable flank. The attacker may develop the assailable flank by arriving from an unexpected direction. He may also fix the defender's attention forward through a combination of fires and supporting or diversionary attacks while he maneuvers his main effort to strike at the enemy's weak flanks or rear. The attacker must be agile enough to concentrate his forces and mass his combat power effects before the enemy can reorient his defense. (See Figure 4-1.)

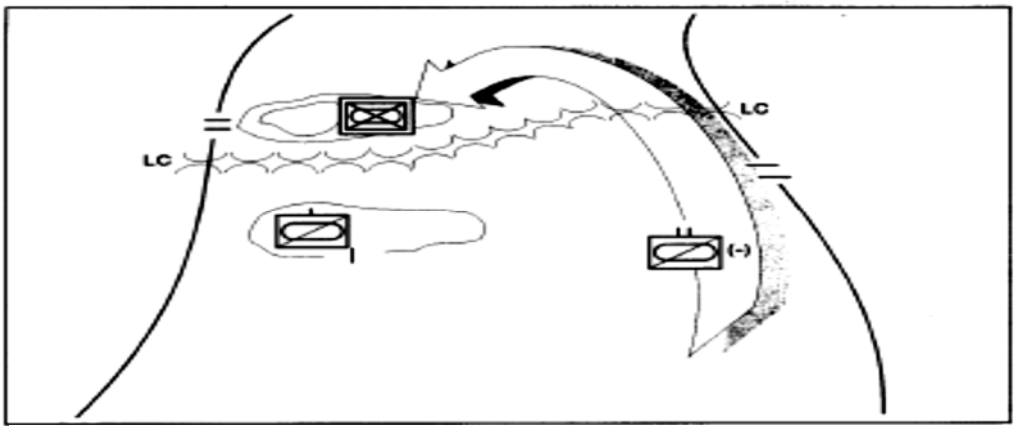


Figure 4.1 - Squadron Conducting Envelopment

0418. The enveloping force may be air cavalry or mounted or dismounted ground cavalry. It must have the mobility and enough combat power to achieve its purpose. The surprise achieved by envelopment often allows a smaller force to defeat a larger one.

0419. Squadrons participate as part of a larger force. An encirclement is an extension of either an envelopment or a pursuit. A direct pressure force maintains contact with the enemy, preventing his disengagement and reconstitution. It attempts to inflict maximum casualties. Meanwhile, an encircling force maneuvers to envelop the enemy, cutting off his escape routes. If necessary, the encircling force establishes a hasty defense behind the enemy, synchronizing fires to complete the destruction of the encircled force.

0420. In the double envelopment, the attacker seeks to pass simultaneously around both flanks of the enemy. This requires two assailable flanks. Precise coordination, sufficient combat power, and detailed timing are required.

0421. Turning Movement. The turning movement is a variation of the envelopment in which the attacker seeks to pass around the enemy, avoiding his main forces, to secure an objective deep in his rear. Faced with a major threat to his rear, the enemy is forced out of his defensive positions to attack rearward at a disadvantage. The Cavalry normally conducts a turning movement as part of a larger force. Bypassing security zone forces during reconnaissance achieves this effect as the enemy seeks to fall back into the main defensive area.

0422. Penetration. In the penetration the attacker concentrates his forces to rupture the defense on a narrow front. The gap created is then widened and used to pass forces through to defeat the enemy in detail and to seize objectives in depth. A successful penetration depends on surprise and the attacker's ability to suppress enemy weapons, to concentrate forces and weapons effects at the point of attack, and to quickly pass sufficient force through the gap to destroy the enemy's defense.

0423. A penetration is normally attempted when enemy flanks are unassailable, or when the enemy has a weak or unguarded gap in his defense. A penetration is planned in three phases:

a. Isolation of the site selected for penetration.

b. Initial penetration of the enemy position.

c. Exploitation of the penetration.

0424. The penetration of a well-organized position requires a quick rupture and a rapid destruction of the continuity of the defense to deny the enemy time to react. Without rapid penetration, the enemy can reposition forces to block or counter the maneuver.

0425. A penetration normally requires substantial combat power and dismounted infantry to make the initial penetration. The Cavalry seldom conducts a penetration of

a prepared enemy position, but may participate in a penetration as part of a larger force.

0426. Frontal Attack. The frontal attack strikes the enemy across a wide front and over the most direct approaches. It is normally used when commanders possess overwhelming combat power and the enemy is at a clear disadvantage. Commanders mass the effects of direct and indirect fires on enemy positions, shifting indirect and aerial fires just before the assault.

0427. The frontal attack is the least preferred and may be the most costly form of maneuver since it exposes the attacker to the concentrated fires of the defender while limiting the effectiveness of the attacker's own fires. As the most direct form of maneuver, however, the frontal attack is useful for overwhelming light defenses, covering forces, or disorganizing enemy defenses.

0428. This attack is an appropriate form of maneuver to be employed when the mission is to fix the enemy in position or to deceive him. Although the frontal attack strikes the enemy's entire front within the zone of the attacking force, it does not require that the attacker do so on line or that all subordinate unit attacks be frontal. Frontal attacks, unless in overwhelming strength, are seldom decisive. The attack is conducted as an attack by fire or assault.

0429. Infiltration. Infiltration is a form of maneuver where combat elements move by stealth to objectives to the rear of the enemy's position without fighting through prepared defenses. All or part of the unit may move by infiltration. Infiltrations are slow and are often conducted during reduced visibility. Cavalry seldom conducts a large scale infiltration. Scouts may infiltrate at times to conduct stealthy reconnaissance of enemy forces in depth.

Sequence of Offensive Operations

0430. Generally, the following sequence is executed in an offensive operation:

a. Reconnaissance**.** Reconnaissance begins as soon as possible after receipt of the mission and continues throughout the attack.

b. Rehearsal.

c. Movement to a line of departure. When the attack is not made from positions in contact, the unit moves from an assembly area in the rear, through an attack position behind the line of contact, conducts a forward passage of lines, and begins the attack;

d. Maneuver**.** Once the forward passage of lines is complete, the unit maneuvers to accomplish the commander's intent, which may include breaching operations and changes in formations and movement techniques. Reconnaissance elements report changes in the enemy situation and Fragmentary Orders (FRAGO) are issued to ensure units respond to the changing situation;

e. Deployment. The unit deploys to attack the enemy or to fix the position for bypass. The unit may briefly occupy an assault position while other units occupy attack-by-fire positions. At this point, final adjustments and instructions are executed to maximize unit effectiveness during the attack. Because of the proximity of the enemy during the attack, the time spent in the assault position is minimal. If the unit mission is to fix and bypass, similar measures must be taken to ensure that the enemy cannot respond to friendly maneuver. Enemy handover to follow-on forces must occur with minimum confusion; and

f. Attack**.** The attack consists of the break-in and fight-through phases. The break-in phase begins with the approach to the objective. This includes the isolation of the objective by indirect and direct fires - artillery fires and smoke missions to isolate the objective from the supporting fires and observation of adjacent positions. Artillery and mortars provide suppression of the objective in support of the assault. Once the objective is isolated, the unit begins the actual penetration of the enemy defensive position. It is the responsibility of the breach force commander, who has been task organized with specific breaching equipment, to accomplish the obstacle breaching. The support force continues to suppress the enemy position and the assault force prepares to move through the breach. Once the breach is completed, the assault force begins the actual assault on the enemy position. After the assault force is on the enemy position, the fight-through phase begins. Scouts may suppress and destroy enemy bunkers and Infantry Fighting Vehicles (IFV). Tanks concentrate on the ground fight by destroying hard targets and enemy antitank systems. Tanks also assist in sealing off the objective, suppressing adjacent enemy positions, and preparing to defeat enemy counterattacks. Fire Support Teams (FIST) continue to keep the objective isolated by shifting suppressive fires and smoke missions to other enemy positions. The commander positions himself where he can best control the operation. He must be prepared to commit the reserve, while also protecting the objective from the influence of other enemy positions.

g. Reorganization and consolidation or continuation**.** The attacker eliminates remaining enemy resistance and prepares for further operations or continues the previous operation.

Movement Techniques and Formations

0431. The three movement techniques of Traveling, Traveling over watch, and Bounding over watch are used as in reconnaissance or security operations. Troop or squadron formations may differ to provide the required degree of concentration. Techniques and formations may change during the mission as terrain conditions or enemy situations change. PAM 3-02 provides detailed discussion of movement techniques and formations.

Planning Offensive Operations

0432. The planning process for all operations is outlined in Chapter 2. When planning offensive operations, certain considerations apply as the scheme of

maneuver is developed. The scheme of maneuver is the central expression of the commander's concept of the operation and describes the movement, positioning, and tasks of subordinate units from the line of departure through actions on the final objective.

Intelligence Preparation of the Battlefield

0433. Intelligence Preparation of the Battlefield or IPB is the first essential step of planning. Terrain is analyzed from both friendly and enemy perspectives. Enemy avenues of approach are defined. The situation template indicates how the enemy can use the terrain and how he may deploy along the avenues of approach. Named Areas of Interest (NAI) identify critical decision points where enemy action indicates his intent. Decision support templates aid critical maneuver or fire support decisions. Terrain analysis also provides information that the S3 and the commander can use to plan the scheme of maneuver.

Objective

0434. An objective is assigned to orient the efforts of the attacking force. The objective may be either terrain or force oriented. Terrain oriented objectives require the attacker to seize or secure the designated terrain feature. If the mission is to destroy an enemy force, an objective is assigned for orientation and control, but the effort is focused on the enemy's actual location. Intermediate objectives may be assigned when necessary to control a critical piece of terrain. Objectives are easily identifiable terrain features and should facilitate consolidation, reorganization, and continuation of the mission. During reconnaissance and security operations, objectives are normally force oriented and are frequently assigned by FRAGOs as the situation is developed.

Main and Supporting Attacks

0435. The main and supporting attacks are designated. The main attack is the principal attack into which the commander places the bulk of the offensive capability at his disposal. It is assigned to a ground maneuver unit. The main attack is directed against the objective of the mission. As the battle develops, the commander may change or redirect the main effort. To weigh the main attack, he will perform the following actions:

a. Allocate resources in task organization. Unlike reconnaissance or security operations, squadron commanders may task organize the cavalry troops to provide adequate combat power where required;

b. Position overmatching elements;

c. Assign priority of fires and priority targets;

d. Assign priority of combat service support assets; and

e. Position and determine priorities for the reserve.

0436. The supporting attack is the secondary effort designed to hold the enemy in position, deceive him as to where the main attack is being made, prevent him from reinforcing the elements opposing the main attack, and cause him to commit his reserves prematurely at an indecisive location. Supporting attacks should come from a different direction than the main attack. This forces the enemy to defend in two directions and avoids masking friendly fires as the main attack closes on the objective. At troop level, the supporting attack may be the base of fire element. The supporting attack contributes to the success of the main attack by accomplishing one or more of the following:

a. Occupy terrain to support by direct fire.

b. Attack by fire and movement to seize or secure terrain dominating the objective.

c. Control indirect fires on the objective.

d. Isolate the objective.

e. Prepare to assume the main attack or reserve, or assist in final clearing of the objective.

Reserve

0437. A reserve is normally designated at the squadron and regiment level. Troops seldom have adequate combat power to do so. The reserve is that, portion of the force which is withheld from action at the beginning of an engagement so it is available for commitment at a decisive moment. The reserve should receive contingency missions to provide the commander planning focus and to accelerate execution on commitment. Several considerations guide organization and employment of the reserve. These are:

0438. Size. In a vague enemy situation, such as a movement to contact, the commander may organize a strong reserve. With a well-defined situation, a smaller reserve maybe adequate.

0439. Composition. The reserve is normally structured around a ground maneuver unit. In division cavalry, this may be a cavalry troop or an attached company team. An attached company team is appropriate as a reserve when the squadron is performing a movement to contact. The reserve may also be an air and ground team under control of the S3 or the EX-O.

0440. Location**.** The reserve follows the main effort at a distance sufficient to keep it from interfering with the movement of the main effort and to maintain its own freedom to maneuver. The reserve remains flexible to shift if the main effort changes. The reserve may move on order, at a prescribed distance behind the main effort, or triggered by the main effort crossing predetermined control measures. When not moving, the reserve occupies blocking or hides positions. An air cavalry troop reserve occupies a series of holding areas.

0441. Commitment. The reserve commander must understand the squadron commander's intent, particularly the decision points for commitment. The reserve remains abreast of the developing situation by eavesdrop. The decision to commit the reserve is a critical command decision. In the absence or loss of the commander, the reserve is committed according to the intent. When committed, the commander reconstitutes or re-designates a reserve as soon as possible. The reserve is used to:

a. Exploit success.

b. Assume the mission of a committed unit.

c. Maintain the momentum of the attack.

d. Destroy bypassed elements that remain a threat.

e. Hold key terrain seized by the attacking force.

f. Defeat or block counterattacks.

g. Block enemy escape routes.

Synchronization

0442. The commander synchronizes combat support and combat service support assets with the scheme of maneuver. These assets build combat power and the concentration necessary for a successful attack.

0443. Fire support is used to destroy, suppress, or neutralize enemy direct-fire weapons and to obscure unit maneuver. Fires support breaching operations, soften enemy forces on the objective before the assault, and suppress the objective area. Fires are shifted as the attack progresses through the enemy defense. The commander and his staff develop the scheme of maneuver and supporting fires concurrently. The fire support officer plans, prepares, distributes, and continually updates the fire support plan. The fire support officer recommends and the commander chooses the fire support tasks that contribute most to the attack.

0444. Fire support available to cavalry normally includes artillery, troop mortars, and close air support. Naval gunfire may also be available. The commander may task organize troop mortars into a platoon to provide more effective massed fire support. Fire support tasks in the attack includes the following:

a. Suppressing antitank systems that inhibit maneuver;

b. Preparation fires. Preparation fires are delivered on targets before an assault. The preparation is planned by a direct support artillery battalion or higher echelon. It is an intense volume of fire delivered in accordance with a time schedule. The fires may start at a prescribed time or be held on-call. The duration of the preparation is influenced by factors such as the fire support needs of the entire force number of targets and firing assets, and available time. The value of preparation fires is weighed against the potential loss of

surprise. Preparation fires are normally associated with a deliberate attack, seldom conducted by cavalry;

c. Obscuration and screening fires. Fires using smoke assist breaching efforts, conceal friendly maneuver, and aid in deception efforts;

d. Illumination fires. Illumination fire is always planned for night attacks, but usually held on order of the squadron commander;

e. Priority targets. Priority targets are normally allocated to weigh the main attack; and

f. Fires during the assault. These assault fires are usually executed in the following sequence: 1) Suppression fires to prevent the enemy from observing and engaging friendly elements and to conceal the movement of troops and teams. 2) Destruction fires to destroy enemy fighting positions near the initial objective. 3) Suppression or neutralization fires that concentrate on deeper objectives. 4) Fires during consolidation. The unit places fires on retreating enemy forces and on deeper positions. Targets are planned on likely enemy counterattack routes or placed on enemy withdrawal routes to force his destruction or capture.

0445. Mobility is normally the priority of support by engineers in offensive operations. Engineers reduce or eliminate obstacles as part of combined arms breaching operations, bridge dry or wet gaps, and improve routes for maneuver and supply forces. Combat engineer assets are normally located well forward in the unit formation to provide responsive support.

0446. Combat service support functions are performed as far forward as the tactical situation permits. Class III and Class V are pushed forward to subordinate units at logistical release points. The combat trains move with the main body of the squadron. FARPs normally remain in the rear until consolidation on the objective occurs; then they may displace forward.

Night and Limited Visibility Attacks

0447. An attack at night or during limited visibility provides several advantages to the attacker. Surprise and deception are enhanced. Opportunities that are impractical during daylight conditions may succeed. Night attacks compensate for inadequate combat power during an economy-of-force mission. Concentration and movement of forces are more difficult to detect and remain concealed longer. In division cavalry, the availability of the air cavalry troop is carefully weighed during consideration of these attacks. Air cavalry troops are more survivable at night due to the reduced effectiveness of enemy direct fire weapon systems.

0448. Planning for a night attack begins as early as possible to allow daytime preparation. Sleep plans are adjusted and commanders ensure leaders are rested before the attack begins. The plan should be simple to facilitate execution. These attacks are planned basically the same as a daylight attack. Night-vision devices and thermal imaging sights facilitate controlled but rapid execution.

0449. Night attacks are frequently made by dismounted infantry. If a squadron has infantry attached, this method is considered. A mounted attack should be planned to support the dismounted effort. A mounted attack may also serve as the supporting effort or a deception. SOPs provide guidance for marking vehicles and positions and for signaling at night.

0450. Control measures at night are usually more restrictive than those used during daylight conditions. All control measures must be easily identifiable on the ground. The commander should impose only those control measures necessary for effective control such as route reconnaissance and marking of the direction of attack facilitate rapid execution. This reconnaissance may begin in daylight. The intent and concept must be well-understood to prevent confusion and engaging each other during execution of the mission. Leaders at all levels are well forward to maintain unit orientation during the attack. Indirect illumination is planned, but used only as necessary.

Actions on the Objective

0451. Actions on the objective consist of the attack on the objective, consolidation, and reorganization. The attack may be by fire or by assault. Both methods of attack may involve fire and movement to position forces on advantageous terrain. Attack by fire is used when the objective can be secured by direct and indirect fires without requiring an assault.

0452. This method is particularly appropriate for a force oriented objective. It is advantageous when a squadron is attacking with organic troops and reduces the risk to the attacking force. An assault closes with the enemy by fire and movement to overrun and seize a position occupied by the enemy. This method is used when attack by fire is unsuccessful or the objective must be physically occupied. Infantry may be required. In division cavalry, an attached company team is the best force to assault. The unit making the assault is the main effort of the squadron.

0453. An assault may be mounted or dismounted. During either type, the attacking force executes a rapid, violent, but well-ordered attack. The supporting attack or base of fire provides direct fire support, controls indirect fires, and on order, shifts fires across and beyond the objective. Techniques for conducting an assault should be well rehearsed and part of the unit SOP.

0454. A mounted assault is more rapid, provides greater shock action, and provides protection against small arms and artillery fires. It may be conducted under or closely following friendly indirect fires. Following the mounted assault, the infantry may be required to dismount and sweep the objective to clear remaining resistance. A mounted assault is appropriate when:

a. Inadequate infantry is available for dismounted assault.

b. Enemy positions are weak or hastily prepared.

c. A meeting engagement with a moving enemy force is in progress.

0455. A dismounted assault provides greater security for the attacking force, but it is slower. To maintain maximum speed, to gain maximum protection against small arms fire and indirect fires, and to conserve the strength of the infantry, the assaulting force dismounts as close as possible to the objective. A dismounted assault is appropriate when:

a. The enemy is in well-prepared positions.

b. Tanks are not available to lead a mounted assault

c. Terrain favors a dismounted assault.

d. Obstacles prevent maneuver across the objective.

e. Stealth is required to close in on the objective.

f. A mounted assault stalls.

0456. Consolidation will organize and strengthen the seized objective against enemy counterattack. The attacking force also prepares for follow-on operations or to continue the previous operation. The unit that provided the supporting effort during the assault may or may not join the assault force on the objective. Consolidation emphasizes speed, security, and dispersal. These actions are part of the unit SOP. If an attack by fire is successful, scouts should subsequently sweep the objective for remaining forces and combat information. During reconnaissance and security operations, consolidation is a rapid process allowing the cavalry unit to return to the mission as soon as possible.

0457. Reorganization occurs on the objective as necessary to prepare the unit to continue the mission. Continuing the mission is not delayed in the conduct of Sustainment Operations or to wait for a Logistics Package (LOGPAC), unless the unit is incapable of further action. Squadrons push emergency resupply forward based on reports or assessment of the nature of the fight. Combat service support operators do not wait for a request.

0458. Hasty reorganization actions are part of the unit SOP and are the responsibility of NCO leaders. The following reorganization actions typically occur:

a. Collect and forward combat service support reports.

b. Cross-level ammunition and other critical supplies.

c. Treat and evacuate casualties and prisoners of war.

d. Repair or evacuate damaged equipment.

e. Reorganize combat crews.

Forms of Offense

0459. There are four general forms of offensive operations. These are Movement to Contact, Attack, Exploitation, and Pursuit. Although it is convenient to think of these actions as sequential, they may not be. Offensive operations are fluid; they ebb and flow from one form of maneuver to another.

Movement to Contact

0460. A movement to contact gains initial ground contact with the enemy or regains lost contact. The Cavalry performs the movement to contact like a zone reconnaissance. Unlike a zone reconnaissance, the effort focuses on finding the enemy force, developing the situation early, and preventing the premature deployment of the main body following the cavalry. Terrain reconnaissance is conducted as necessary to support the intent of locating the enemy. As a result, movement to contact proceeds much faster than a zone reconnaissance. The division cavalry squadron frequently performs this mission when serving as the advance guard during a division movement to contact. The squadron assigns this mission to troops during a squadron advance guard or movement to contact.

0461. The division cavalry squadron, conducting a movement to contact as an independent force, organizes itself similarly with security forces, an advance guard, and a main body. The division cavalry squadron will normally use the air cavalry troops, with their increased speed and mobility, as security forces. Figure 4-2 depicts a reinforced division cavalry squadron conducting a movement to contact. The movement to contact terminates when the unit reaches the objective or limit of advance without enemy contact or upon contact with an enemy force.

0462. Actions on contact occur at this point and the unit attempts to defeat the enemy force within its capability. Each successive cavalry commander attempts to defeat the enemy as subordinates report the situation. The organization of the cavalry unit is the major factor in determining the size of an enemy force that can be defeated at platoon, troop and squadron.

0463. The enemy should prove to be too strong, the cavalry establishes a hasty defense, delays, or conducts close reconnaissance as appropriate within the intent of the higher commander. Follow-on main body forces then deploy, conduct battle handover, and assume the fight. In a division movement to contact, these actions by the squadron are frequently the opening phases of a division meeting engagement.

0464. A movement to contact is characterized by rapid, aggressive action. The commander rapidly develops the situation and may be permitted, particularly in division cavalry, to bypass enemy forces to maintain momentum. Main body forces subsequently relieve squadron elements left in contact and eliminate the bypassed force. Relieved elements rejoin the squadron to avoid dissipating its strength. Increased consumption of Class III and vehicle maintenance requirements are anticipated.

0465. Critical Tasks. During a movement to contact, certain critical tasks are accomplished. Unless the higher commander gives guidance otherwise, the unit will

perform the following actions: Reconnoiter and determine the trafficability of all high-speed routes within the zone. Inspect and classify all bridges, culverts, overpasses, and underpasses along high-speed routes. Identify all bypasses and fords that cannot support rapid, heavy movement. Clear all high-speed routes of mines and obstacles within its capability, or locate bypasses. Find and report all enemy forces within the zone and determine their size, composition, and activity.

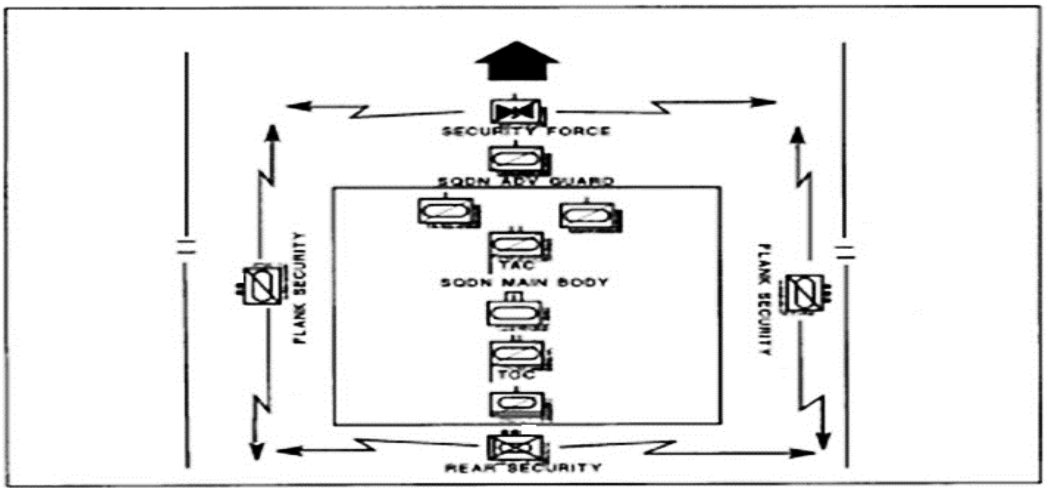


Figure 4.2 - Reinforced Cavalry Squadron Conducting Movement to Contact

0466. **Planning Considerations.** While similar to a zone reconnaissance, the requirements of a movement to contact pose some differing planning considerations (see Figure 4-2).

0467. A movement to contact is normally performed in a zone narrower than that assigned for zone reconnaissance. This gives the cavalry unit adequate combat power to develop the situation on contact and to maintain the required momentum. Necessary reconnaissance may proceed faster, scouts are readily available to remain in contact with bypassed enemy, and troop and squadron commanders have uncommitted forces available. Required route reconnaissance for main body movement is a specified task for a troop.

0468. The squadron gains contact with the smallest element possible. This is normally scouts or aero scouts performing reconnaissance for their troop. Actions on contact occur rapidly at platoon and troop level to prevent unnecessarily deploying other squadron assets.

0469. Division cavalry facilitates speed by using air cavalry to reconnoiter forward of the ground troops or to screen along exposed flanks. The reserve allows flexibility on contact and rapid resumption of movement by the troops. Engineers are well forward to facilitate obstacle reduction. Nuclear, Biological, Chemical (NBC) Reconnaissance Elements are well forward to conduct area reconnaissance of a known or suspected contaminated area, allowing troops to bypass and continue movement. Command posts and trains travel along good routes in zone and occupy hasty positions.

0470. Combat formations at troop and squadron level are chosen to provide efficient movement and adequate reserves. These formations are part of the unit SOP.

0471. Speed increases risk. A thorough IPB enhances security by indicating where greater risk is acceptable and more deliberate movement is required. Rapid movement techniques and continuous air and ground surveillance provide security as well.

0472. Combat service support assets are tailored to the mission. Combat trains move with the squadron. Field trains may move in depth, with a forward support battalion in the main body of the division. Minimum essential assets move in the combat trains to prevent unnecessarily slowing the squadron. If the division cavalry squadron is well forward of the division, a FARP may move with the squadron to reduce aircraft turn-around time. In the regiment, the aviation squadron establishes its FARPs far enough forward to support deployed air cavalry assets. Alternatively, the squadron coordinates with a follow-on force to integrate a FARP into its zone of action. Main supply routes frequently become extended as the operation proceeds.

0473. **Meeting Engagement.** A meeting engagement occurs when a moving force, incompletely deployed for battle, engages an enemy at an unexpected time and place. The enemy may either be stationary or moving. Cavalry units frequently participate in meeting engagements when acting as the main body security force or during a movement to contact. As such, they are already deployed and are the force that develops the situation for the main body commander. If contact is made while moving in a non-deployed formation, cavalry units immediately execute actions on contact. This response during a tactical road march is an established part of unit SOP.

Attack

0474. There are two types of attack: hasty and deliberate. A hasty attack most often follows a movement to contact. (However, a movement to contact may terminate in a hasty defense, a deliberate attack, or even a retrograde. Commanders direct the appropriate action based on their analysis of the situation.) In combat, the force that first deploys and assaults its enemy with maneuver and fires normally gains an initial advantage.

0475. Commanders launch hasty attacks with minimum preparation. Hasty attacks are used to seize an opportunity or destroy an enemy before he is able to concentrate forces or establish a coordinated defense.

0476. Deliberate attacks involve much more detailed planning. Deliberate attacks fully synchronize the support of every available asset to defeat an enemy force. Detailed reconnaissance, thorough planning and rehearsal, violent concentration of combat power, rapid exploitation of enemy weaknesses and positive, aggressive leadership at all echelons of command characterize the deliberate attack.

0477. **Hasty Attack.** A hasty attack is an attack for which a unit has not made extensive preparations. It is conducted with the resources immediately available to maintain momentum or to take advantage of the enemy situation. A hasty attack is a course of action available during actions on contact; it may occur during reconnaissance, security, or movement to contact missions. A counterattack is

normally conducted as a hasty attack, although prior rehearsal is sometimes possible. The enemy force attacked may be moving or stationary.

0478. A hasty attack is characterized by rapid, immediate action without elaborate planning or orders. Normally, only limited intelligence information about the enemy force is available. The attack terminates with the destruction of the enemy force, disruption of his movement forcing him to employ larger forces, or lack of success. The troop or squadron subsequently prepares to continue the original mission, if possible, or establishes a hasty defense. If hasty defense is required, the force in contact continues close reconnaissance and prepares to conduct a battle handover with a following force as the higher commander continues to develop the situation.

0479. Time is the critical factor in a hasty attack. A rapidly executed attack before the enemy can act often spells success even when combat power is not as favorable as desired. Detailed planning and orders are not possible. The unit plans and rehearses maneuver techniques and drills as part of the SOP to execute the attack rapidly and with minimum FRAGO guidance. Flexible control measures provided in the original operation are essential. They facilitate clear and simple orders and rapid execution (see Figure 4-3).

0480. The attack is not launched blindly at the enemy upon receipt of a contact report from a scout. The commander does not violate the fundamentals of offensive operations in the haste to begin the attack. Adequate reconnaissance, especially of a stationary force, allows the commander to reach a sound decision on a scheme of maneuver. Stealth prevents the scouts from being discovered by the enemy and forcing more abrupt action. Aero scouts may detect the enemy early, allowing more time for the squadron commander to make a decision. If the enemy discovers elements of the squadron first, those elements may be forced into a hasty defense while other assets develop the situation.

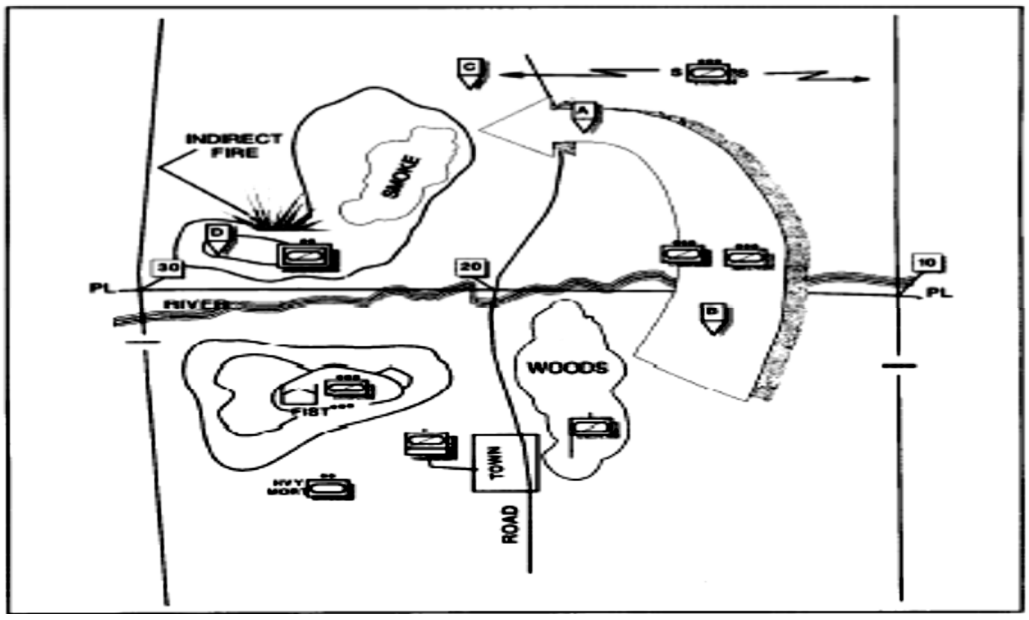


Figure 4.3 - Hasty Attack

0481. A simple scheme of maneuver forms a framework for the attack. A base of fire or supporting attack is designated. This is often the element that first makes contact. His platoons or troops continue reconnaissance to a designated limit of advance to provide more maneuver space and security, and to determine if other enemy forces are present. A maneuver force is designated and assumes the main effort to destroy the enemy. This may be a squadron reserve. An envelopment of an exposed flank or rear of the enemy is preferred. The commander moves with the main effort. Task organization is not changed, unless absolutely necessary, to preclude delay and confusion.

0482. Available fire support is massed to support the attack. Other missions may be terminated if necessary. Troop mortars assume hasty firing positions if moving. Mortars are displaced, if time permits, to provide adequate fire support. The FIST moves to a position where he can observe the objective and personally control fires.

0483. Trains and command posts deploy to hasty positions, if moving. Local defensive measures may be necessary for adequate security. By eavesdropping, combat service support executors monitor the developing fight to determine what support is required.

0484. **Deliberate Attack.** A deliberate attack is planned and carefully coordinated with all concerned elements based on thorough reconnaissance, evaluation of all available intelligence and relative combat strength, analysis of various courses of action, and other factors affecting the situation. It is generally conducted against a well-organized defense when a hasty attack is not possible or has been conducted and failed. Deliberate attacks normally include large volumes of supporting fires, main and supporting attacks, and deception measures.

0485. Cavalry units seldom conduct deliberate attacks. They may be the force maintaining contact and performing close reconnaissance after attempting a hasty attack or upon identifying a strong enemy position. Cavalry performs reconnaissance, security, or deception operations as part of or division deliberate attack. If cavalry units are in contact, they prepare to conduct a battle handover with the force designated to conduct the deliberate attack. Division cavalry squadrons must receive substantial reinforcement if required to conduct a deliberate attack.

Exploitation

0486. Exploitation is an offensive operation that usually follows a successful attack to take advantage of weakened or collapsed enemy defenses. Its purpose is to prevent reconstitution of enemy defenses, to prevent withdrawal, and to secure deep objectives. Exploiting forces may receive a mission to secure objectives deep in the enemy rear area, cutting lines of communication, surrounding and destroying enemy forces, denying escape routes to an encircled force, and destroying enemy reserves. Terrain is secured only as necessary to accomplish the mission. Aggressive reconnaissance to the front and flanks of the exploiting force maintains contact, assists in locating enemy strongpoint, and avoids ambush.

0487. The division cavalry squadron does not have the organizational depth for a sustained exploitation. However, it may be part of a larger exploiting force. This

exploiting force may be a brigade or the division. The squadron will normally perform reconnaissance or security operations for the main exploiting force.

0488. In any exploitation operation, planning is hasty, FRAGOs are the rule, and orders and control measures are simple and flexible. Exploitation is characterized by decentralized execution, rapid movement, deep penetration, and increased consumption of Class III. The regiment or squadron must tailor its combat service support assets to sustain this effort.

Pursuit

0489. Pursuit is an offensive operation against a retreating enemy force. It follows a successful attack or exploitation and is ordered when the enemy cannot conduct an organized defense and attempts to disengage. Its objective is to maintain relentless pressure on the enemy and destroy him. It differs from the exploitation in that its primary function is to complete the destruction of the enemy force. While a terrain objective may be designated, the enemy force itself is the primary objective. The pursuit usually consists of direct pressure and encircling forces (see Figure 4-4). Command and control is the same as in the exploitation. Like exploitation, combat service support must be mobile and tailored to support rapid movement and increased consumption of Class III and Class V.

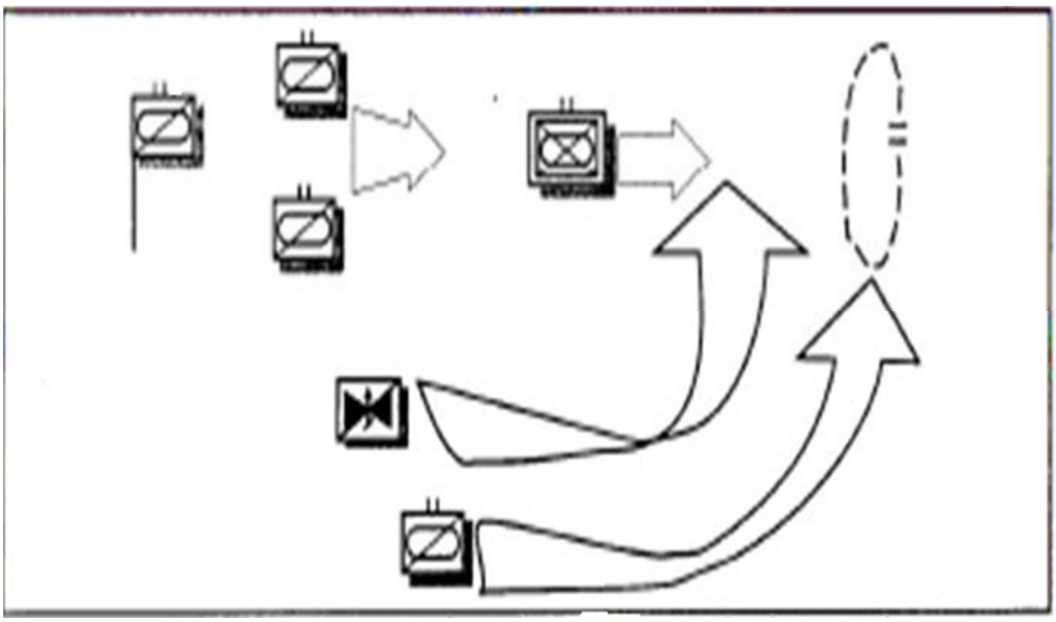


Figure 4.4 - Cavalry Squadron Conducting Pursuit

0490. The direct pressure force orients on the enemy main body to prevent enemy disengagement or defensive reconstitution prior to envelopment by the encircling force. It normally conducts a series of hasty attacks to slow the enemy's withdrawal by forcing him to stand and fight. It does this by attacking constantly. The enemy is denied any opportunity to rest or reconstitute. Lead elements of the direct pressure force move rapidly along all available routes, containing or bypassing small enemy pockets of resistance that are reduced by follow-and-support units.

0491. The encircling force envelops an enemy force that has lost its ability to defend or delay in an organized fashion. The encircling force cuts off escape routes and, with direct pressure forces, attacks and destroys the enemy force. The encircling force penetrates the rear of the enemy and blocks his escape so that the enemy is destroyed between the two attacking forces. The encircling force advances along parallel routes to the enemy's line of retreat to reach defiles, communications centers, bridges, and other key terrain ahead of the enemy main force. If the enemy cannot be outdistanced, he is attacked on the flank. Speed is paramount. Hasty attack and hasty defense frequently occur.

0492. The division cavalry squadron normally performs pursuit as part of a larger force. The squadron may be part of or form the direct pressure or encircling force. It may be required to perform reconnaissance, security, and movement to contact, hasty attack, and hasty defense in the conduct of pursuit operations.

Other Offensive Operations

0493. Cavalry units may perform, or participate as part of a larger force, in other operations such as raids, spoiling attacks, and search and attacks.

Raid

0494. A raid is a small scale operation involving a swift penetration of hostile terrain to secure information, to confuse the enemy, or to destroy his installations. It ends with a planned withdrawal to friendly lines upon completion of the assigned mission. It is not intended to hold ground. The cavalry squadron may perform a raid as organized, be reinforced or participate as part of another force. Armored cavalry troops may also be designated to conduct the raids. The Air Cavalry can increase the speed of the raid by performing reconnaissance in advance of the raiding force. Raids may be conducted to:

a. Capture prisoners.

b. Capture or destroy specific command and control installations.

c. Destroy logistical installations.

d. Obtain information concerning enemy locations, dispositions, strength, intentions, or methods of operation.

e. Disrupt enemy plans.

0495. An objective is normally assigned to orient the unit during the raid. It should be very specific in nature. It should define the target and the desired effects upon the target. Other enemy forces are avoided en route to the objective to maintain surprise (See Figure 4-5.)

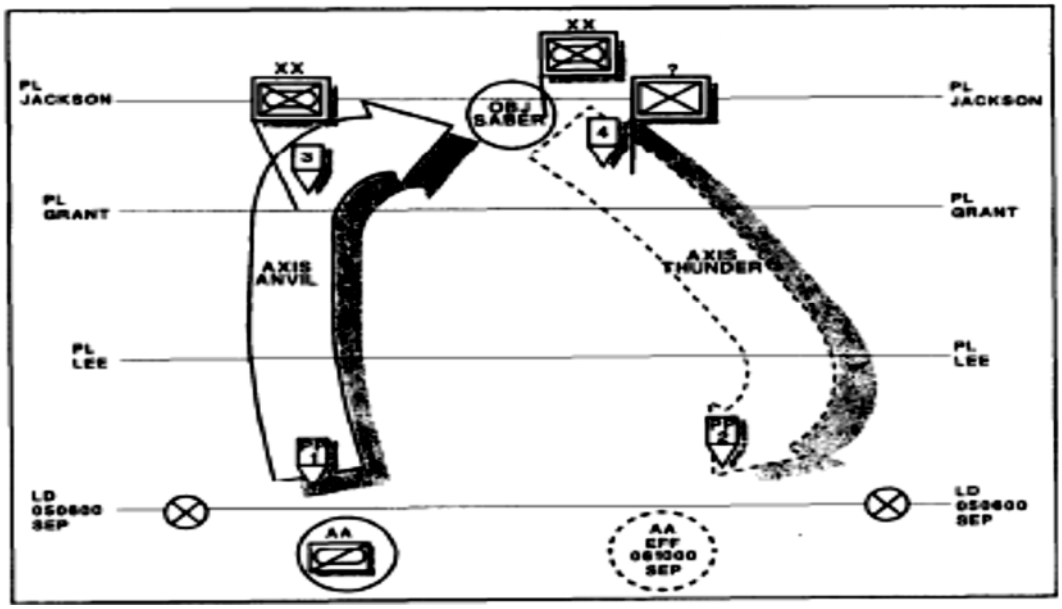


Figure 4.5 - Raid

0496. Raids may be conducted in daylight or darkness, within or beyond supporting distance of the parent unit. When the area to be raided is beyond supporting distance of friendly lines, the raiding party operates as a separate force.

0497. Security is vital because the raiding force is vulnerable to attack from all directions. Speed, stealth, limited visibility, and gaps in enemy lines are capitalized upon during the raid. During movement in daylight, the raiding force uses covered routes of approach. During reduced visibility, reconnaissance precedes the force to prevent premature discovery of the raid by locating enemy forces and directing the raiding force around them. Raids are timed so the raiding force arrives at the objective area at dawn, twilight, or during other low-visibility conditions.

0498. The raiding force conducts the attack on the objective like a hasty attack.

0499. The withdrawal is usually made over a different route from the one used to approach the objective. Reconnaissance ensures that the routes of withdrawal are open. Protective fires are planned along the axes of advance and withdrawal. Rally points are planned for units to assemble to prepare for the attack on the objective or to withdraw to for contingency.

04100. Logistical considerations in raids include the type and number of vehicles and weapons that the raiding force will have; movement distance, length of time the raiding party will operate in enemy territory; and expected enemy resistance. Usually, the raiding force carries everything required to sustain itself during the operation. Resupplying the raiding force, if required, is by aircraft.

04101. **Spoiling Attack.** A spoiling attack is a limited objective attack made to delay, disrupt, or destroy the enemy's capability to launch an attack. The spoiling attack is normally associated with defensive operations and attempts to strike the enemy when he is most vulnerable during preparations in an assembly area or moving to his line of

departure. Usually, circumstances preclude full exploitation, and the attacking force halts on its objective or withdraws to its original position.

04102. **Search and Attack.** Search and attack operations may be conducted by air cavalry units. They may be conducted by an individual air troop or as a squadron-level operation. The purpose of these operations should be to destroy enemy forces, protect the force, or deny an area to the enemy.

04103. Commanders use search and attack when the enemy is dispersed in an area of close terrain that is unsuited to heavy forces, when they cannot find enemy weaknesses, or when they want to deny enemy movement in an area. Search and attack missions are performed much like area security missions. The difference is in the commander's intent for the operation and the aggressive execution of the mission.

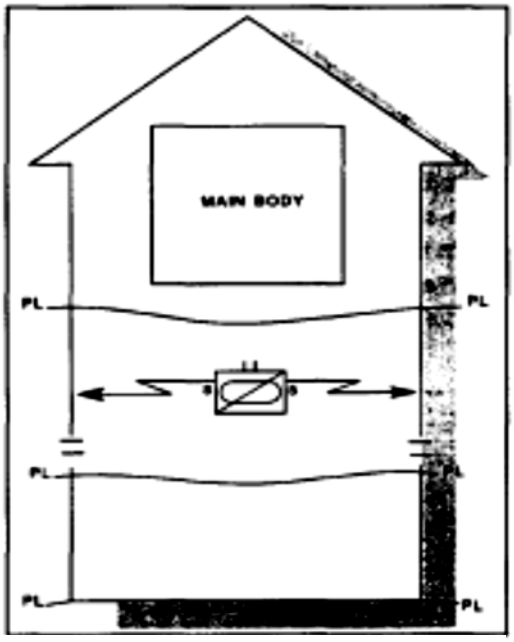


Figure 4.6 - Rear Screen

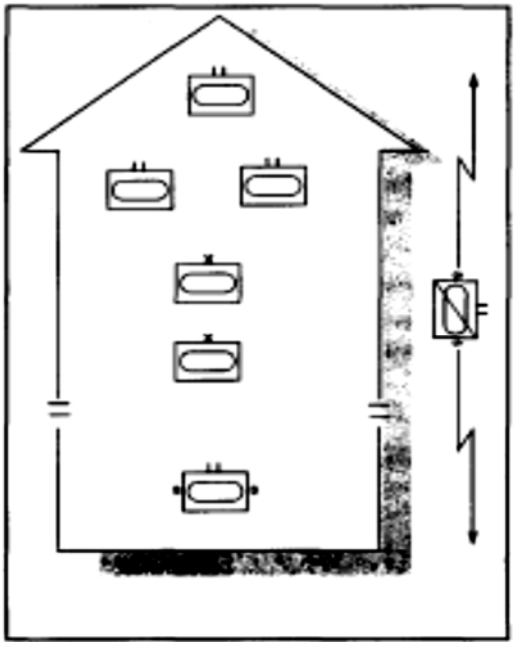


Figure 4.7 - Moving Flank Screen

Chapter V
Cavalry in the Defense

0501. The defense is not the decisive form of war. While the defense can deny success to the enemy, it seldom assures victory. The defense however, is the stronger form of war because of the advantages to the defender. Army doctrine recognizes the strength of the defense but emphasizes on the necessity to quickly transition to offensive operations after a successful defense.

0502. A defender cannot be purely passive. Depth, flexibility, and retaining an offensive capability are all part of the defense. The defender seizes every opportunity to go over to the offensive. Brigades and battalion task forces are the principal maneuver elements of the division defense.

0503. Cavalry units normally perform security missions for the defense or reconnaissance missions to support attacks. Cavalry units frequently perform defensive operations as a part of these security and reconnaissance missions, or when they are required to defend as an economy of force. Division cavalry may require augmentation with additional combat, combat support, and combat service support assets based on the organization and status of the squadron and the situation.

Battlefield Organization for the Defense

0504. The Defensive Framework within which divisions fight is generally organized into three interrelated but equally important operations (see Figures 5-1 and 5-2). These operations are as follows:

a. Deep Operations

b. Close Operation

c. Rear Operations

0505. **Deep Operations.** Deep operations create opportunities for offensive action by reducing the enemy's closure rates, separating attacking echelons; disrupting his command and control, combat support, and combat service support; and by slowing the arrival times of succeeding echelons. Deep operations are conducted against forces not in contact using indirect fires, electronic warfare, air interdiction, Army aviation, deception, and maneuver forces. These operations are performed by division commanders Deep reconnaissance forces provide combat information on enemy actions at Named Areas of Interest (NAI) and along avenues of approach.

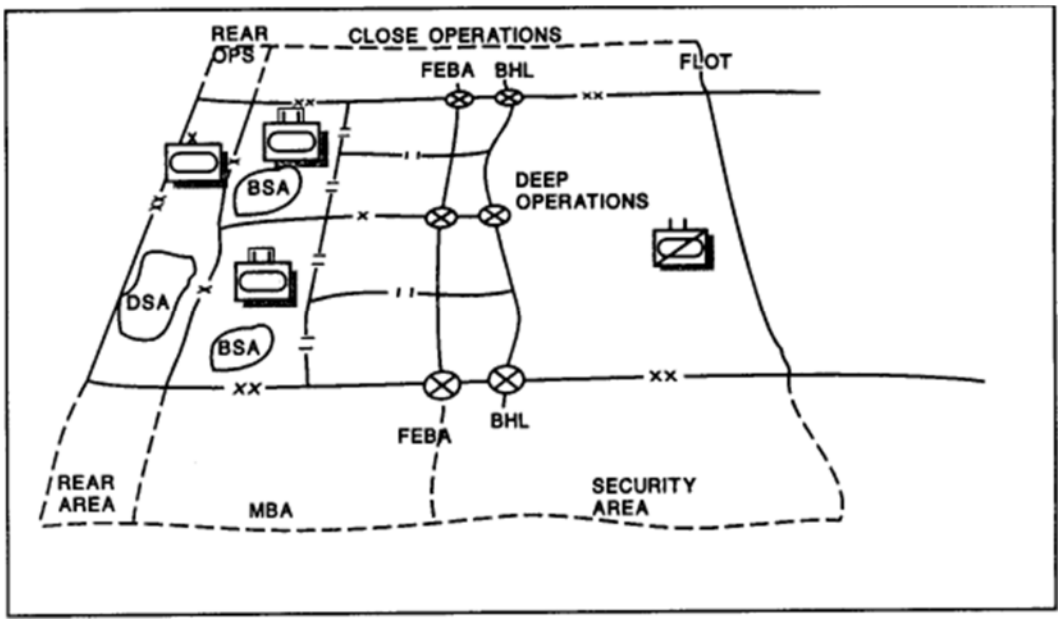


Figure 5.1 - Organization of the division defensive battlefield

0506. **Close Operations**. Close operation includes security force operations, main battle area operations, and reserve operations.

a. **Security Force Operations**. Divisions may establish the security force. The Main Battle Area (MBA) Forces assume control of the battle at the battle handover line and assists securing force units in breaking contact and withdrawing. Cavalry units, when defending, establish security area at all tactical echelons. Divisions perform security operations to the front, rear, and flanks to protect their freedom of action by reducing vulnerability to hostile acts, influence, or surprise. Cavalry is the primary force for these operations.

b. **Main Battle Area Operations**. The main battle area is the critical area for the defeat of assaulting enemy forces. Division commanders synchronize and integrate the fight. Brigade commanders fight the battle. They assign sectors or battle positions to task forces based on their estimate of the situation and intent. Assigned sectors coincide with avenues of approach. The commander designates and sustains the main effort by giving priority of artillery, engineer, air defense, and close air support assets to the force responsible for the most dangerous avenue of approach into the sector. Alternatively, the enemy may be allowed to penetrate and the main effort rests with a reserve force to attack and destroy the enemy from the flanks or rear. The commander can strengthen the effort along the most dangerous avenue of approach by narrowing the sector of the unit astride it. Task force commanders structure their defenses by deploying units in depth. Amounted reserve of one-quarter to one-half of the task force strength provides additional depth and gives the commander a maneuver capability against the enemy. A commander can create a reserve by taking risks on less likely enemy avenues of approach into his sector. Penetration by enemy forces must be anticipated and provided for in the plan. Separation of adjacent units is likely, especially if the enemy is conducting

nuclear and chemical operations. The Main Battle Area Forces continue to strike at the enemy's flanks and counterattack across penetrations.

c. **Reserve operations.** The primary purpose of the reserve is to provide flexibility to seize the initiative through offensive action. The commitment of reserve forces at the decisive point and time is key to the success of a defense. The reserve becomes the main effort upon commitment. The reserve force can expect to receive one or more of the following missions upon commitment: 1) Counterattack. 2) Spoiling attack. 3) Block, fix, or contain. 4) Reinforce. The squadron-level reserve's most common use is in the counterattack role. The composition, location, and mission of a reserve are based on the commander's estimate of the situation and intent.

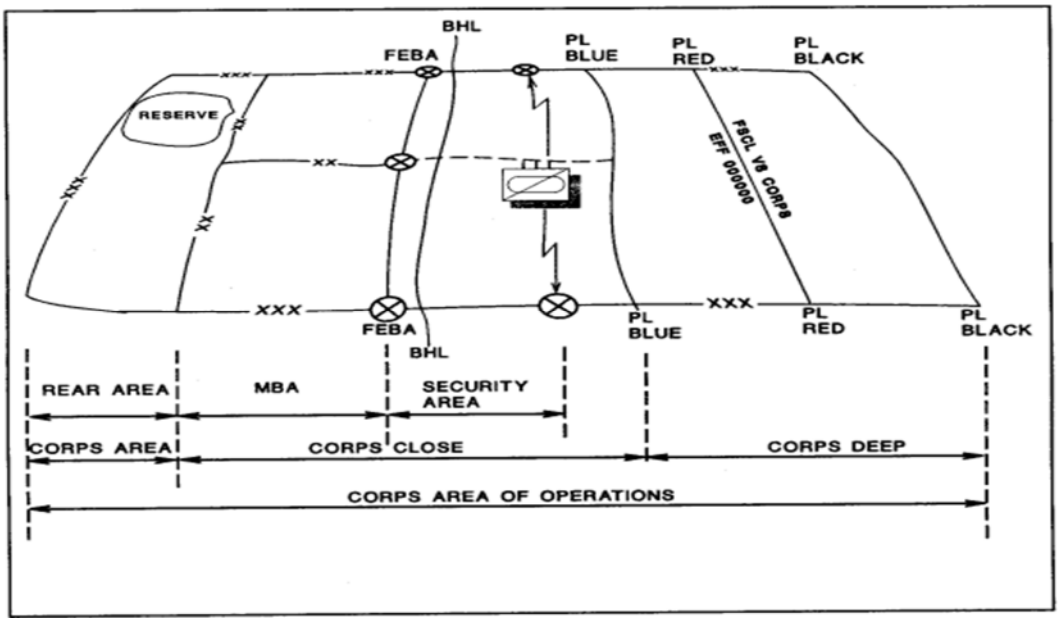


Figure 5.2 - Battlefield organization for the defense

0507. **Rear Operations**. Rear operations assure freedom of maneuver and sustained operations. Rear operations must not divert forces from the main effort.

Forms of Defense

0508. Defensive patterns follow two broad categories: mobile and area. The mobile defense focuses on destroying the attacking enemy force. It permits the enemy to advance into a position that exposes him to counterattack and envelopment by a mobile striking force. The area defense focuses on retaining terrain by absorbing the enemy into an interlocked series of positions from which he can be destroyed largely by fire. Smaller mobile reserves are used for this.

0509. **Mobile Defense.** The mobile defense employs a combination of offensive, defensive, and delaying actions over great depth to defeat the enemy attack. The minimum force possible is committed to pure defense; maximum (two-thirds) combat power is placed on a mobile striking force that attacks the enemy as it attempts to overcome that part of the force dedicated to the defense. The mobile defense is normally conducted by division and larger forces.

0510. **Area Defense.** The area defense is usually conducted to deny the enemy access to specific terrain or facilities for a specific time. Area defense does not normally result in decisive defeat of the enemy. Other simultaneous or subsequent action achieves this objective. The bulk of the defending forces is deployed to retain ground, using a combination of defensive positions and small mobile reserves.

0511. Commanders organize the defense around a framework provided by defensive positions, seeking to destroy the enemy forces with interlocking fires. Commanders also employ local counterattacks against enemy units penetrating between defensive positions. Area defenses may be conducted in varying depth. Less flexibility in this defense requires early identification of the enemy's main effort to allow for concentration.

Sequence of the Defense

0512. A defense is often conducted in a sequence of integrated and overlapping steps:

a. Occupation

b. Security Force Fight

c. Passage of the Security Force

d. Defeat of Enemy Reconnaissance and Preparatory Fires

e. Approach of the Enemy Main Attack

f. Enemy Assault

g. Counterattack

h. Reorganization and Consolidation

0513. **Occupation**. During this phase, the scouts are usually the first to clear the proposed defensive position. They check for enemy observation posts and NBC contamination. Leaders then reconnoiter and prepare their assigned areas. Security (scout screen) is established forward of the defensive area to allow occupation of positions and preparation of obstacles without compromise. During occupation, movement is minimized to avoid enemy observation. Units also initiate deception plans.

0514. **Security Force Fight.** The security force makes initial contact with the approaching enemy. Depending on the mission, organization, and size of the security force, it may do anything from providing early warning to defeat the enemy's lead echelons. The Main Battle Area Forces eavesdrop on the security force fight to remain abreast of the situation.

0515. **Passage of the Security Force.** The main battle area force establishes contact with and assists the disengagement and passage of the security force. Chapter 8 discusses battle handover and passage of lines.

0516. **Defeat of Enemy Reconnaissance and Preparatory Fires**. The enemy will attempt to discover the defensive scheme using reconnaissance elements and attacks by advance guard elements. The enemy will also attempt to breach the defender's obstacles. Consistent with the requirement to maintain security, units should remain in defilade, hide, and prepared positions to avoid the casualties and shock associated with indirect fires.

0517. **Approach of the Enemy Main Attack**. The defender's security elements observe and report enemy movement during the security force fight. The main battle area commander repositions or reorients his forces to mass against the enemy's main effort. Enemy formations are engaged at maximum range by supporting fires and close air support to cause casualties, to slow and disorganize formations, to cause the enemy to button up, and to impair his communications. Obstacles and lanes are closed. Direct fire weapons are repositioned as required, or maneuvered to attack the enemy from the flank. The commander may initially withhold direct fires to allow the enemy to close into an engagement area where decisive concentrated fires destroy him.

0518. **Enemy Assault.** As the enemy deploys, he becomes increasingly vulnerable to obstacles, blocking positions, and fires intended to break up the assaulting formation. Continued maneuver to enemy flanks and rear is used to destroy him and to increase the number of directions in which he must react. Some security elements may stay in forward positions to monitor enemy second-echelon movement and to direct supporting fires on these forces as well as on his artillery, air defense, supply, and command and control elements.

0519. **Counterattack**. As the enemy assault is slowed or stopped, the commander will launch his counterattack forces to complete the destruction of the enemy. In some cases, the opportunity to counterattack can occur before the enemy is slowed or stopped. The counterattack may be by fire or by fire and movement.

0520. **Reorganization and Consolidation**. The defender must quickly reorganize to continue the defense. Attacks are made to destroy enemy remnants, casualties are evacuated, and units are shifted and reorganized to respond to losses. NCO leaders cross-level ammunition and other critical items. Emergency resupply is conducted if necessary. Commanders reestablish security and obstacles and submit reports.

The Cavalry Squadron Role

0521. The Cavalry Squadron may conduct hasty defensive operations during reconnaissance and screen missions. The squadron conducts more deliberate defensive operations in the conduct of guard missions, when acting as part of a covering force, or performing as part of a defensive economy of force.

0522. During reconnaissance operations, the squadron may establish a hasty defense upon contact with an enemy force too large to attack or bypass. This is part of actions

on contact. During a guard mission, the squadron may be required to defend and accept decisive engagement to provide the time and space required by the division commander. The squadron may be part of a covering force and receive a defensive mission. Following security area operations, the squadron may become part of the division reserve, or it may perform rear operations.

0523. Defensive missions in the main battle area may be assigned to the squadron as an economy of force for the division commander. The same considerations guide this role as in offensive operations. Reinforcements are normally required. Commitment of the squadron to this role normally requires other division assets to assume the division security function. As an economy of force, the squadron may defend in sector, delay, counterattack, or perform deception operations.

Armored Cavalry Troop and Company Team Roles

0524. Ground troops prepare to establish hasty defenses during reconnaissance operations as part of actions on contact. During security missions, the troop may defend in sector, defend a battle position, or delay. These same missions apply when the squadron is performing in an economy-of-force role.

0525. Air cavalry troops perform reconnaissance or screen along exposed flanks, between troops, or forward of the ground troops. In the division cavalry squadron, attached company teams may form the reserve. If there is a major avenue of approach into the squadron sector, a company team may be placed astride it, while a ground troop forms the reserve.

Planning Defensive Operations

0526. When planning defensive operations, certain considerations apply as the scheme of maneuver is developed.

Intelligence Preparation of the Battlefield

0527. Intelligence Preparation of the Battlefield or IPB is the first essential step of planning. Terrain is analyzed from both friendly and enemy perspectives. Enemy avenues of approach are defined. The situation template indicates how the enemy can use the terrain and how he may deploy along the avenues of approach. Named Areas of Interest (NAI) identify critical decision points where enemy action indicates his intent. Decision support templates aid critical maneuver or fire support decisions. Terrain analysis also provides information the S3 and commander can use to plan the scheme of maneuver.

Unit Positioning Considerations

0528. The commander and staff develop courses of action and determine tentative unit positions. The squadron commanders array troop-size forces against battalion-size avenues of approach. In doing this, he considers the positioning of platoons. The positions must provide for an integrated defense so that all available weapon systems can be effectively used. Positioning should allow shifting of fires and forces to meet

enemy actions during the battle. Once this is completed, the commander considers the formation of teams. Available maneuver space and subordinate combat power are considered when forming teams.

0529. Division cavalry commanders must consider task organizing organic ground cavalry troops and attached companies.

0530. Commanders organize and assign missions in the defense based on the considerations described in the following paragraphs.

0531. **Dispersion**. Commanders disperse units and weapons laterally and in depth to reduce the enemy's ability to suppress. This also allows the unit to engage the enemy from multiple directions.

0532. **Cover and Concealment**. Elements are placed in positions where cover and concealment are available; obvious terrain is avoided. Hide positions are used. To check the adequacy of concealment, leaders travel approach their units from the enemy's direction of movement. Covered routes must be available to allow movement in and between positions and for maneuver against the enemy.

0533. **Flanking Fire**. Flanking fires are far more effective than frontal fires. Initial positions for anti armor weapons may maximize long-range engagements, but primary positions are normally picked to maximize flanking fires from defilade positions.

0534. **Security**. Battle position security includes patrols, observation posts, and other measures to provide security from enemy attacks, mounted or dismounted, along covered routes.

0535. **Ability to Maneuver**. Units must be able to concentrate on the avenues of approach being used by the enemy. To do this, there is a need to plan and rehearse routes between on-order positions with sectors of fire and positions in depth.

0536. **Range of Weapon Systems**. When selecting tentative positions for weapon systems, the commander considers the effective range and acquisition capabilities of each system. Weapons are positioned to engage the maximum effective range and to provide an increasing volume of massed fires. Tanks have a fast rate of fire and short engagement time. Antitank missiles provide long-range fires but are limited by rate of fire and time of flight.

0537. **Transition to Limited Visibility**. An attacker uses night, bad weather, smoke, and suppressive fire to limit the defender's visibility. The defender anticipates this problem and prepares to occupy predetermined, limited visibility fighting positions. Limited visibility capabilities of fire control systems are a key factor in determining the amount of adjustment required.

0538. **Dismounted Infantry.** Battle positions or sectors for dismounted infantry are chosen to hold or deny mounted and dismounted avenues of approach to key terrain. Positioning dismounted infantry on forward slopes may needlessly expose them to long-range direct and observed indirect fires. Positions to the flanks or on reverse

slopes that deny approaches to key terrain avoid exposing dismounted infantry and provide cover and concealment.

0539. Dismounted infantry is best suited to close-in fighting on restrictive terrain with limited fields of fire. Dismounted infantry should be positioned so they can only be threatened inside the ranges of their antitank weapons. When good infantry terrain is not available, construction of obstacles and time to construct strong fighting positions are required to allow infantry to hold terrain and defeat armor.

0540. Based on the reconnaissance and security plan, infantry units provide observation posts and patrols between battle positions to augment the efforts of the scouts. Infantry can be used to provide manpower for constructing obstacles, clearing fields of fire, securing obstacles, and closing lanes and gaps in obstacles. When assigning infantry additional tasks outside their battle positions, the time for movement as well as time to construct their fighting positions must be considered. Positions for subordinate troops or companies may be designated by battle positions or sectors. The considerations listed in Table 5-1 guides planning.

Table 5.1 - Positioning Considerations

FACTOR	BATTLE POSITION	SECTOR
Avenues of approach	Well defined; enemy can be canalized	Multiple avenues prohibit concentration
Terrain	Dominates avenues of approach	Dominating terrain not available
Areas of operation	Narrow	Wide
Mutual support	Achievable	Cannot be achieved
Squadron commander's ability to see and control	Good	Degraded
Enemy situation	Known/clear	Unknown/unclear/vague
Troops available	Attached infantry	Pure or attached armor

Reserve

0541. A reserve is normally designated at squadron level. Troops seldom have adequate combat power to do so. Troop commanders prepare contingencies for platoons that allow them to rapidly shift or assume new missions. As in offensive operations, the reserve commander is assigned missions as contingencies to provide planning guidance and to ensure timely execution on commitment. Considerations that guide organization and employment of the reserve are explained in the following paragraphs.

0542. **Size.** With a vague enemy situation, multiple avenues of approach, force oriented mission, or narrow sector, squadron can organize a strong reserve. A delay

mission also normally requires a strong reserve. With a well-defined enemy situation, few avenues of approach, or terrain-oriented mission, a smaller reserve may be adequate. An economy-of-force role or wide sector may not afford the luxury of a large reserve.

0543. **Composition.** The reserve is normally structured around a ground maneuver unit providing speed and firepower. The reserve must not be dependent on the availability of aircraft. A mix of air and ground assets is the most effective. A ground troop or attached company team normally forms the reserve in the Cavalry Squadron.

0544. **Location.** Positioning the reserve is critical for effective employment. It is positioned in adequate depth to have a degree of protection and to prevent inadvertent commitment too early in the fight. However, the reserve must be close enough that it can rapidly enter the fight when committed. The reserve can occupy battle, blocking, or hide positions.

0545. **Commitment.** The same considerations apply that govern commitment of the reserve in offensive operations. The reserve can be used for:

a. Counterattack

b. Spoiling attack

c. Blocking, fixing, or containing enemy forces.

d. Reinforcing committed forces.

e. Supporting disengagement of troops.

0546. Counterattack is the most frequent mission executed by the reserve. Normally, more than one counterattack option is planned for and rehearsed. Counterattacks may be conducted to block an impending penetration of the Forward Edge of the Battle Area (FEBA), to stop a force that has penetrated, to attack through forward defenses to destroy an enemy force, or to attack enemy forces from the flank and rear. Counterattacks may be conducted by fire or by fire and movement. Combat power is increased by using surprise, flanking attacks, speed, and violent execution.

0547. The counterattack begins movement early to launch before the enemy has time to consolidate any local gains made. Units other than the reserve may also be tasked to carry out local counterattacks. The counterattack is conducted like a hasty attack. The execution of the counterattack is based on decision points developed during the construction of the decision support template.

0548. Regardless of the type of counterattack being conducted, the following basic considerations apply:

a. Attack one objective at a time, and weigh it with all available fire support. Once committed, the counterattack becomes the main effort;

b. Plan the battle. Determine movement times and probable lines of departure/lines of contact before committing the force to the counterattack. Rehearse to learn routes, objectives, and time requirements.

c. Defeat the enemy before subsequent echelons close. Even for a force oriented counterattack, use an objective to orient the counterattacking force.

d. Attack the enemy's flanks and rear, taking advantage of the protection offered by the terrain and limited visibility.

0549. The squadron commander may designate on-order battle positions from which the reserve can conduct counterattacks by fire. The Reserve Commander conducts a reconnaissance of the battle positions and assigns his subordinates battle positions from which they can fire into engagement areas to stop enemy forces. Since those on-order battle positions are often close to occupied battle positions, or are in other unit sectors, close coordination is required for:

a. Routes from the reserve position to the battle position.

b. Fire coordination measures.

c. Tie-in of fires with forward units.

d. Supplementary positions for flank units.

e. Completion of the counterattack by fire and movement if necessary.

f. Continuation of attacks beyond the FLOT.

g. Coordination of the limit of advance.

0550. The commander coordinates direct fire and indirect fire control measures to protect the reserve from both enemy and friendly fire. A restricted fire area around the counterattack axis of advance or direction of attack and its objective can be established. Fires are planned along the flanks of the axis, on the objective, and to separate enemy echelons. Clear recognition signals are used to prevent engagement by friendly ground or air units. The actual attack executed seldom mirrors what is planned. The control measures used for the defense must be flexible enough to facilitate a rapid FRAGO, changing a counterattack while retaining a synchronized fight.

Mission Command

0551. Mission command in defensive operations involves the use of fire control measures to help the commander mass fires on the enemy while providing adequate distribution. Combined with a well-planned obstacle system, fire control measures allow the defender to fully exploit the effects of organic and supporting weapons.

0552. **Engagement Priority**. Fires can be distributed by assigning each weapon or section a type of vehicle to engage first. Generally, the most dangerous targets are shot first.

0553. **Trigger Line or Point.** A trigger line or point is readily identifiable on the ground and indicates the location at which engagement of the enemy force is to begin. It allows for massed opening volleys, desired surprise, and prevents wasting ammunition. It may be indicated graphically as a phase line or target reference point on either fire plans or the operations overlay.

0554. **Sector of Fire. A**n area required to be covered by an individual weapon or a unit. Primary and secondary sectors may be assigned. Sectors of fire are used to orient the fires of the designated force. This is not a restrictive fire control measure. Dangerous targets or targets of opportunity outside the sector should be engaged.

0555. **Disengagement Criteria.** Disengagement criteria provide guidance to the unit commander or leader on the decision point at which displacement to subsequent positions is to occur. Execution of the mission without delay is the benefit. The commander may designate a break line or point to begin disengagement. The operation can proceed in the absence or breakdown of communications. Disengagement is not rote execution. The commander or leader of the unit weighs the criteria against the commander's intent.

0556. Disengagement criteria are defined in recognizable terms. They must allow time for the unit to successfully disengage once the decision has been made. Based on the commander's intent, they may be established as destroying a certain number. They may not be established as a percentage of enemy vehicles or a percentage of friendly unit losses. Rather, they should be defined in terms of enemy unit actions, such as:

a. Penetrating an obstacle.

b. Crossing a phase line.

c. Effective suppression on the position.

d. Specified maneuver action of an enemy unit (flanking move by advance guard battalion against a position).

0557. **Back brief and Rehearsal.** Back briefs and Rehearsals are particularly valuable while preparing for defensive operations. They allow the commander to ensure that his concept is understood, problems are resolved, and details are coordinated. Rehearsals are critical for movements and coordinated engagements. Back briefs should occur at the location of the subordinate.

0558. **Engagement Area.** An engagement area is an area in which the commander intends to trap and destroy an enemy force with the massed fires of all available weapons (see Figure 5-3). The destruction of the enemy in an engagement area is frequently the critical part of the battle or phase of the operation. Engagement areas are routinely identified by a target reference point in the center of the area or by

prominent terrain around the area. They are not intended to restrict or cause operations to become static or fixed.

0559. Defensive systems are not designed around engagement areas, but rather around avenues of approach. Do not use an engagement area when less restrictive fire control measures are appropriate. An engagement area may be developed through terrain analysis determining locations along avenues of approach where the enemy can mass, presenting a lucrative target. A defensive plan to destroy the enemy at this location is designed using the engagement area as a critical component.

0560. Engagement areas are normally terrain dependent and must be recognizable on the ground. They are open areas. To mass fires, the engagement area is structured. Obstacles canalizes the enemy into the area, and once there, slows his progress, providing extended engagement times and massed targets. Indirect fires are planned on the obstacles, in the area, and in depth to suppress the attacker and to separate echelons. Troops are positioned, frequently in battle positions, to mass their fires. Sectors of fire within the engagement area may be designated.

0561. Counterattacks are planned to hit the enemy on a flank or his rear. These counterattacks are controlled by the use of a direction of attack and possibly on-order battle positions to prevent squadron units from engaging each other. Counterattacks are planned both deep and shallow. Air and ground assets are most effective when used together, forcing the enemy to fight in multiple directions. A joint air attack team may be part of the attack.

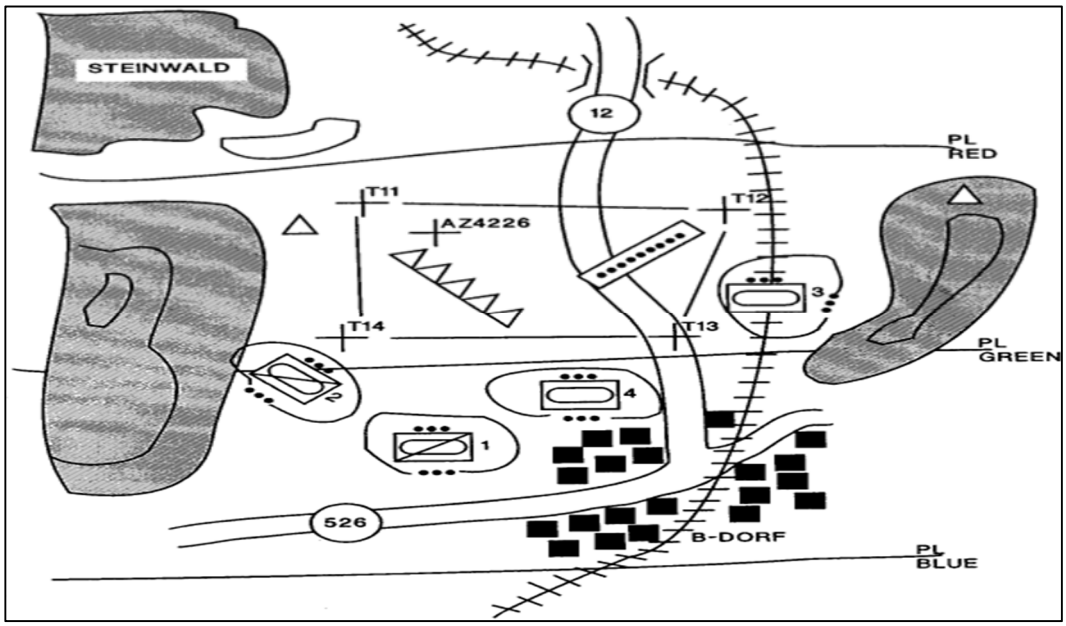


Figure 5.3 - Engagement area

0562. **Ambush.** During a security mission, the scheme of maneuver may be an ambush of a moving enemy force in depth as it passes the screen line. An ambush is a surprise attack by fire from concealed positions on a moving or temporarily halted enemy. An air and ground team is especially effective for an ambush. Hasty obstacles

stopping or slowing the enemy provide increased effectiveness of the ambush. (See Figure 5-4.)

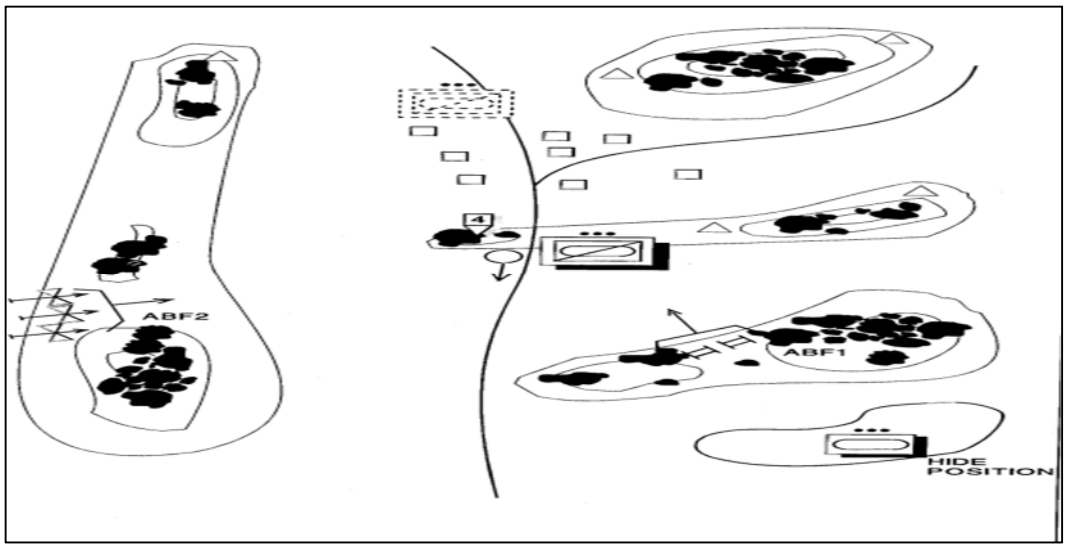


Figure 5.4 - Ambush

Synchronizing Operations

0563. **Fire Support.** Supporting fires are planned and used in the following situations:

a. At long-range to disrupt, slow, and disorganize the enemy and force him to button up.

b. On likely enemy over watch positions.

c. To provide illumination.

d. To cover disengagement, movements, and counterattacks.

e. Along covered and concealed avenues of approach to destroy enemy dismounted infantry. Mortars and field artillery are particularly effective against dismounted infantry. Final protective fires used to destroy assaulting infantry are planned close-in to battle positions and are fired to break the assault.

f. To defeat dismounted breaching attempts

g. To provide smoke for disengagement.

h. To deliver Field Artillery Scatterable Mines (FASCAM) on avenues of approach where movement is choked, and to close lanes, gaps or enemy breaches in obstacles. FASCAM is most effective when tied up with other obstacles and covered by observation and direct fire.

i. To suppress enemy forward air defense.

0564. The squadron commander develops the scheme of maneuver and his intent for fire support concurrently. The fire support officer must know when and where the commander wants fire support. In addition, he must fully understand what the commander wants in the way of effects, duration, and timing. The fire support officer then coordinates with the air liaison officer and engineer to develop an initial fire plan. This plan is refined based on input from troop commanders and fire support officers. The troop fire support officer and scouts execute fires. The squadron commander and fire support officer may orchestrate this by establishing an event-oriented scheme of fire support.

0565. The Commander of the Howitzer Battery serves as the Squadron Fire Support Coordinator, and works in conjunction with the Squadron Commander and Fire Support Officer in developing the fire support plan.

0566. Squadron priority targets are planned on the most dangerous enemy avenues of approach. They may be sub-allocated to units covering these approaches. The designated priority targets are shifted as the battle develops. The commander also designates priority of fires, normally to the unit designated as the main effort.

0567. **Mobility and Survivability.** The commander establishes a general priority of engineer tasks to be accomplished. Priority of effort is normally to counter-mobility, survivability and mobility. At squadron level, the commander determines the priority of engineer tasks to be accomplished.

0568. Priorities may be further assigned to key pieces of engineer equipment. Priority tasks and allocation of engineer assets must support the main effort and work must begin as soon as possible. The squadron may provide manpower, additional equipment, and supplies to support the engineer effort.

0569. Mobility tasks are performed to develop covered and concealed routes into and out of battle positions along critical displacement routes in sector. Emphasis is on improving or maintaining existing routes rather than constructing new ones.

0570. Survivability positions are prepared in battle positions to protect dismounted troops, weapons, and vehicles. Individual and crew-served weapons positions are constructed to provide protection against shrapnel from air burst, but not direct hits. Fighting positions for vehicles are constructed with both hull-down and turret-down locations.

0571. Obstacles support the commander’s intent and are fully integrated into the concept of the operation. Obstacles are grouped into two general categories: existing and reinforcing.

0572. **Obstacle Integration**. Obstacle integration is the process of ensuring that the obstacle effects are integrated into the scheme of maneuver. Obstacle integration cuts across all functional areas and all echelons. Commanders at all levels must integrate existing and reinforcing obstacles in their engagement area as part of their planning considerations. An understanding of the basic principles behind obstacle integration is

essential for commanders and staffs at all levels. Commanders and staffs consider the following to ensure that obstacles have the desired impact on the battle:

a. Intelligence.

b. Obstacle intent.

c. Fires and obstacle effects;

d. Obstacles and operations in depth.

e. Obstacle control.

f. Echelons of obstacle planning.

0573. Obstacles are used by defending forces to canalize the enemy into areas where he is most vulnerable to concentrated direct fires and to hold him there as long as possible. Additionally, squadrons emplace reserve obstacles that are typically directed by higher headquarters. The following are guidelines for obstacle employment:

a. Obstacles are continuously observed and covered by direct and indirect fires. A specific unit is assigned responsibility for protecting each obstacle. This includes protecting the obstacle during limited visibility and checking it at first light to ensure that it has not been breached.

b. Point obstacles placed at irregular locations are used along secondary, restrictive approaches to slow rapid movement. These might not always be covered by direct fire.

c. Emplacement time is reduced and effectiveness increased when emplaced obstacles reinforce existing obstacles. The combined effect produces a substantial barrier that may form a key part of the defense.

d. Obstacles must not hinder planned friendly movement. Lanes and gaps through obstacles may be needed to allow movement. If so, a plan prescribes who closes the lane or gap. Troop commanders usually control and close gaps and lanes in their areas.

e. Obstacles are emplace in depth. Obstacles must be far enough apart so that each one will require a new deployment of the enemy’s counter obstacle force and equipment.

f. Hasty protective minefields are used for short periods or for specific missions. They are emplace at troop level without regard to any standard pattern or density. Mines must be readily detectable and removable by the installing unit. Normally, mines carried on fighting vehicles are used for hasty protective minefield.

g. Obstacles are emplace to surprise the enemy. Security forces must be forward to deter enemy observation of obstacle construction. Obstacles should be in

defilade and camouflaged if possible. Dummy obstacles are used to confuse the enemy.

h. The exact position of each obstacle is coordinated between the engineer, Troop Commander, and the Fire Support Officer to ensure adequate coverage. Since planned obstacle sites are often adjusted on the ground to accommodate direct fire coverage, the fire support officer must reconfirm target locations after obstacles are emplace.

i. Situational obstacles allow the commander to shift scarce assets to the location he needs them most, based on the situation. The commander can use situational obstacles to- 1) Attack an enemy vulnerability. 2) Exploit success. 3) Separate follow-on enemy forces. 4) Provide flank protection.

j. The design components of the situational obstacles are intent, target, location, and effect. Situational obstacles can be made of both conventional mines and FASCAM.

0574. **Air Defense Artillery.** During preparation of the defense, Air Defense Artillery (ADA) priority goes to units preparing positions and obstacles. Once positions are prepared, priority goes to critical assets or locations. These may include command posts, trains, the reserve, choke points, river-crossing sites, or other high payoff targets. IPB determines the air avenues of approach into and through the defensive sector. ADA assets may be positioned along these avenues of approach to provide area coverage or at critical locations to provide point defense.

0575. **Intelligence.** The division cavalry squadron relies on support from the Division Military Intelligence Battalion. The Cavalry Squadron employs Intelligence and Electronic Warfare (IEW) assets in the same manner. The amount of IEW support it receives from the division MI battalion is METT-TC dependent.

0576. **Combat Service Support.** Combat trains are positioned well forward to provide rapid support during preparation and at the start of the battle. They are positioned out of range on enemy direct fire weapons and make use of available cover and concealment. Positions are prepared for defense against enemy attack. Subsequent positions are planned and reconnoitered to maintain survivability without degrading support. Class IV and Class V are normally the most critical logistical considerations. Movement of support traffic along main supply routes must not interfere with movement of maneuver units, especially the reserve.

Night and Limited Visibility Planning

0577. The commander can expect an attacker to use night and limited visibility conditions to:

a. Reconnoiter the defender’s weapons, obstacles and positions.

b. Move assault over watch elements into position.

c. Infiltrate infantry.

d. Breach obstacles.

e. Move elements through gaps in the defender's coverage caused by reduced ranges of weapons.

0578. Defending during limited visibility, especially at night, will be a normal condition. The defender must be able to rapidly modify or design the defense to negate the impact of limited visibility on the operation. Squadrons establish signals that initiate direct fire and indirect fire engagements, lift and shift fires, and initiate movement. The following considerations apply to limited visibility operations:

a. Use long-range detection equipment (radar, sensors, and night observation devices) on well-defined avenues of approach.

b. Increase surveillance of obstacles, potential enemy over watch and assault positions, and routes into them.

c. Redeploy some units and weapons along avenues of approach that the enemy will likely use during limited visibility.

d. Use more scouts, observation posts, patrols, and infantry (if available) on secondary avenues of approach and between positions to detect and slow enemy infiltration.

e. Use point obstacles and early warning devices along likely night approaches to slow the enemy and to alert defenders to enemy presence;

f. Plan and rehearse the required movement of weapons and units and the massing of fires.

g. Plan illumination on or behind likely engagement areas to silhouette enemy while leaving defenders in the shadows and darkness. While illumination is not needed with thermal sights, it may be needed for dismounted infantry; and

h. Movement at night defensive positions should begin just before dark, and the return to daylight positions should be completed before dawn.

Defend In Sector

0579. Defend in Sector requires the defending unit to prevent enemy forces from passing beyond the rear boundary of the sector, while retaining flank security, and ensuring integrity within the parent unit's scheme of maneuver. Initial positions are generally established as far forward as possible, but a commander may use any technique to accomplish the mission. This is the least restrictive defensive mission and is the most common mission assigned to cavalry. The sector is defined by boundaries that enclose the area of responsibility.

0580. The commander is expected to defeat the enemy within his assigned sector boundaries. No cohesive enemy combat force may penetrate the rear boundary. This is essentially a force-oriented defensive mission. Terrain is used to structure the battle

and position unit assets advantageously. If a piece of terrain is considered key or decisive, a subordinate troop or attached company team can be given a battle position mission. The squadron, or troop may defend in sector. This mission may be performed as follows:

a. During reconnaissance when a large enemy force is encountered.

b. During guard missions for both a stationary and a moving force.

c. During covering force operations or when operating as part of the covering force.

d. When defending as an economy of force.

0581. Unit commanders are given maximum freedom of action within the intent of the higher commander. Sectors are generally deeper than they are wide to permit the defending unit to fight the battle in depth and to provide sufficient space for combat support and combat service support assets. Coordination on the flanks is critical. Command and control must ensure this occurs.

Planning Considerations

0582. The Squadron Commander will normally assign troop sectors based on enemy squadron/battalion avenues of approach. Platoons are then oriented on company/troop-sized avenues of approach. The aviation squadron may be assigned its own sector, but it normally works in conjunction with the ground squadrons, maintaining surveillance of suspected enemy avenues of approach.

0583. The size of the squadron sector is a factor of the type squadron, reinforcement available, enemy threat, and terrain. The squadron commander must perform the following actions:

a. Allocates maneuver space to subordinate troops.

b. Controls direct fires by use of fire control measures.

c. Maintains flank coordination internally and externally by use of control measures, liaison officers, and other techniques.

d. Integrates obstacles, fire support, and air defense into the maneuver plan. If supporting artillery is operating in sector, it is placed forward to fire beyond the initial scout screen line. The regimental squadron commander must also ensure the fires of his Howitzer Battery are planned to provide support beyond the initial screen line. Subsequent positions are planned in depth to continue uninterrupted support. Coordination with main battle area units behind the squadron may be required for artillery firing positions to continue support as the squadron fights back through the sector. Priority of fire is initially designated to the troop astride the most dangerous avenue of approach.

e. Positions security forward and to the flanks and rear as necessary. This task is normally performed by air and ground scouts.

f. Integrates limited visibility positions or actions into the plan.

g. Clearly defines the intent of the higher commander and his own to subordinates so they can execute in the absence of effective communications.

h. Defines limits of subordinate action to include movement, engagement, disengagement, and counterattack.

i. Sets priorities for movement on routes during repositioning, disengagement, or counterattack.

0584. The squadron plans the defense in depth all the way to the rear of the sector. Preparations are normally conducted from front to rear. The defense may hinge on several succeeding key terrain features. They are used to structure the defense in depth or by phases and can be prioritized for preparation. Combat support assets are synchronized with the defense. The squadron must be ready to fight throughout the assigned depth of the sector.

0585. Combat service support is planned in depth as well. Initial and subsequent positions are defined and coordinated with troop commanders. Combat trains are well forward and field trains are well to the rear or out of sector, collocated with a brigade forward support battalion or in the regimental support area. Class III and Class V can be pre-positioned in depth at subsequent positions or at logistics release points for pick up by unit first sergeants.

0586. Combat service support prepares to support forward, but remains mobile to rapidly displace as the battle develops. Battle damage assessment and repair and evacuation of combat vehicles must be done efficiently and by priority to preclude leaving valuable assets in the hands of the enemy. Combat service support operators must monitor the progress of the battle to remain abreast of the developing situation.

Scheme of Maneuver

0587. Schemes of maneuver center on the use of battle positions, sectors, or a combination of battle positions and sectors for subordinate troops or platoons. Figure 6-3 lists considerations for each. At squadron and troop level, commanders have the flexibility of defending in troop sectors, from battle positions, or a combination of both. These basic schemes of maneuver can be used in designing a course of action.

0588. The squadron or troop can defend using sectors (see Figure 5-5). Sectors are used when the enemy situation is vague, avenues of approach are numerous, or troops require greater freedom of action. The commander delegates much of the responsibility for conducting the fight to the troop commanders or platoon leaders. He maintains control through effective control measures and a clearly understood intent.

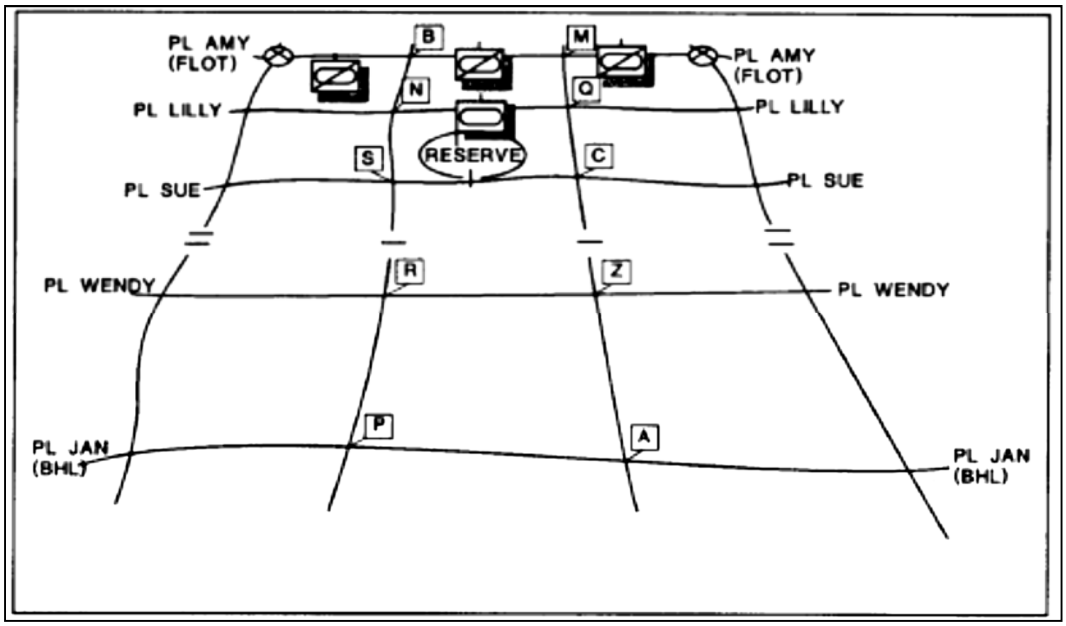


Figure 5.5 - Defend Using Sectors

0589. The squadron or troop can defend using battle positions (see Figure 5-6). This method is used when the enemy situation is clear, avenues of approach are few, or the commander must coordinate subordinate fires. In this scheme of maneuver the commander retains most of the authority for fighting the battle.

0590. The Squadron Commander and the S3 are positioned well forward, perhaps along two major avenues of approach, to control execution of the battle. Troop commanders must understand their authority to execute the concept in the absence of communications to prevent the squadron holding in place and risking destruction. Troop commanders will normally use this method for subordinate platoons when assigned a sector.

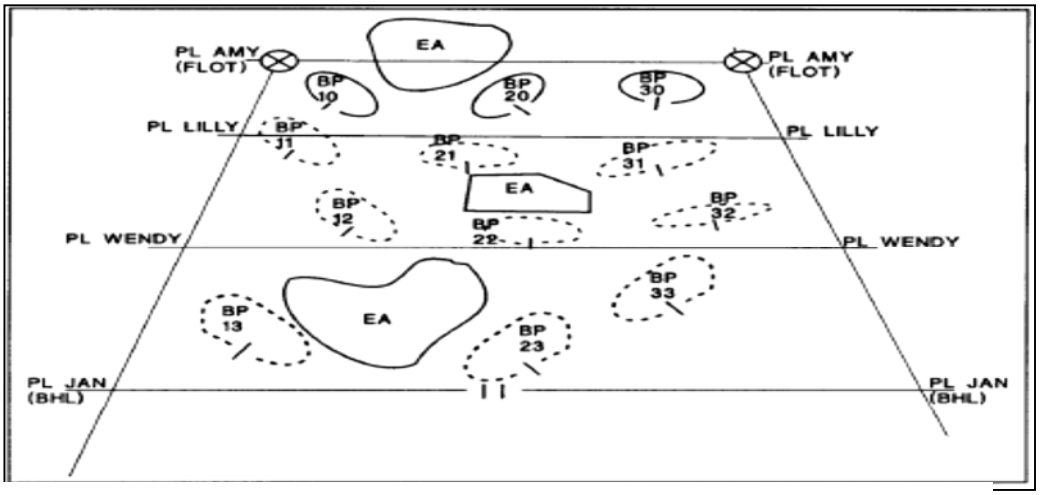


Figure 5.6 - Defend Using Battle Positions

0591. The squadron or troop can defend using a combination of sectors and battle positions (see Figure 5-7). This is considered the most common occurrence for the squadron. Ground troops can be assigned sectors, while air cavalry troops and the

reserve are assigned battle positions to mass their fires at critical points. Ground troops can also be assigned battle positions for occupation at critical points or as contingencies. This approach can be used when changes in terrain, weather, or enemy situation throughout the depth of the sector dictate. It may also be used if squadron command and control is degraded during the course of the battle, making more centralized control necessary. These shifts can be planned in advance or ordered during the fight. Control measures and techniques used are a combination of the other two methods.

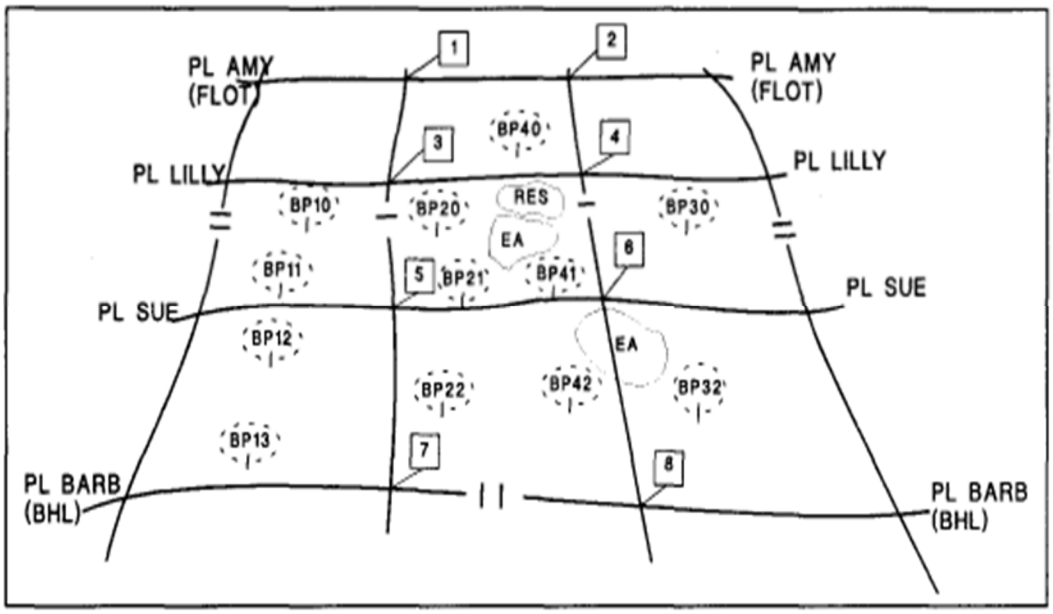


Figure 5-7. Defend Using a Combination of Sectors and Battle Positions

Defend a Battle Position

0592. This mission places a unit in a battle position to concentrate its fires, to limit its maneuver, or to place it in an advantageous position to counterattack. The battle position is a general location on the ground. The commander positions his forces on the best terrain within and in the vicinity of the position. Security forces may be positioned forward of and about the position. He can also locate combat support and combat service support elements outside the battle position. The commander or leader can maneuver his forces freely within the battle position and seize the initiative to maneuver outside the position to attack the enemy.

0593. Squadrons normally do not defend battle positions. They are seldom assigned sectors that allow for defense from a battle position. The air and ground troop mix in division cavalry does not lend itself to fighting from a squadron battle position. Situations may occur where a squadron is required to defend a battle position (such as a squadron being committed to block a penetration). Troops and companies often defend from battle positions. They do so under the following conditions:

a. During reconnaissance when stopped by a large enemy force.

b. As part of guard missions for a moving or stationary force.

c. During a squadron defense in sector mission.

d. As part of a squadron economy-of-force mission.

0594. The squadron normally specifies tasks for troops assigned a battle position. The troop is generally required to orient its weapon systems on an enemy avenue of approach using target reference points or engagement areas. Specific tasks can include the following actions:

a. Destroys a certain enemy force from the battle position.

b. Controls key terrain or block an avenue of approach by holding the battle position against a determined assault.

c. Reorients weapon systems on a secondary avenue of approach from supplementary positions.

d. Disengages and displaces to a subsequent battle position when certain criteria have been met.

Planning Considerations

0595. In selecting a battle position for subordinate troops, the squadron commander thinks two levels down in terms of platoons. He considers the type of platoons required to defend the terrain. This helps to determine task organization within the squadron and positioning of available troops or attached company teams. He must provide sufficient space in each battle position to allow dispersed primary and alternate firing positions. Room for limited visibility, supplementary, and hide positions, and locations for combat trains are also considered.

0596. The commander can vary the troop's degree of maneuver by the size of the battle position. A small battle position tends to mass the fires more and limits the use of alternate and supplemental positions. A larger battle position facilitates alternate and supplemental positions, use of over watch to support maneuver in depth, and execution of local counterattacks. Larger battle positions also reduce the necessity for coordination to move outside and increase dispersion in a nuclear and chemical environment. A battle position need not to be a standard oval shape that suggests a linear defense, but should conform to the terrain and requirements of the defensive tasks assigned.

0597. The ground troop commander normally assigns platoon battle positions within the troop battle position (see Figure 5-8). He considers the same factors discussed above. Alternate and supplementary platoon positions can be designated as separate battle positions to keep each position small and orientation clear. Scouts are normally positioned on the flanks to provide security and to harass the enemy with indirect fire and long-range missile fires. Scouts may also be used to augment the fires of the tank platoons in the execution of the troop engagement area.

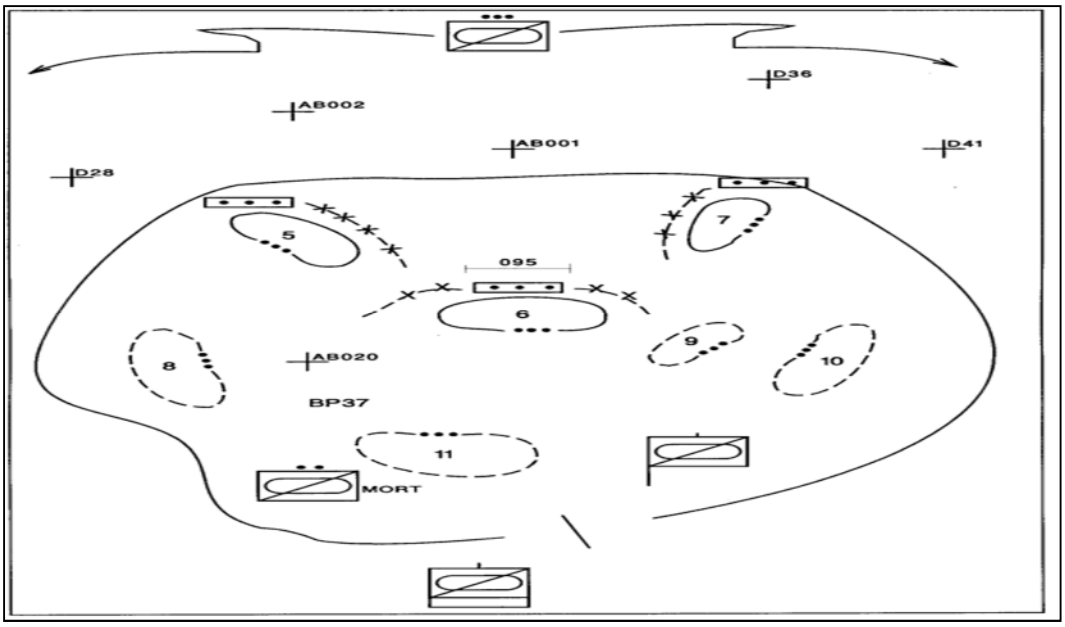


Figure 5.8 - Troop Battle Position

0598. Positioning outside the battle position is often necessary. Security forward rotate flanks may be required. This is normally a screen mission assigned to a scout platoon. Space within the battle position is allocated to the scout platoon if it is to displace inside during the fight. The commander plans withdrawal routes that preclude masking the fires of platoons in the battle positions.

0599. Scouts may also be required to maintain flank contact or to reconnoiter subsequent battle positions during a hasty defense. Coordination with flank units and the squadron is essential when moving forward of or to the flank of the battle position. Mortars, command posts, and combat trains often are stationed outside the battle position, normally behind it where they can provide responsive support. If the mission requires displacement to a subsequent battle position, the command post can initially occupy that position to provide continuity of command and control.

Glossary

Advance
The forward movement of a unit towards the enemy

Advance Guard
The security element operating to the front of a moving force.

Air Liaison Officer
The senior Air Force officer at each tactical air control party (TACP). He advises the Army Commander and staff on the capabilities, limitations, and employment of tactical air operations. He operates the Air Force request net, coordinates close air support (CAS) missions with the FSE, and assists in planning the simultaneous employment of air and surface fires. He supervises forward air controllers (FAC's) and assists the fire support team (FIST) in directing air strikes in the absence of a FAC.

Air Traffic Control
A service operated by appropriate authority to promote the safe, orderly and expeditious flow of air traffic. The control of air traffic to promote its safe, orderly, and expeditious movement.

Ambush
A surprise attack by fire from concealed positions on a moving or temporarily halted enemy.

Area Defense
A type of defense operation in which primary reliance is placed on the use of maneuver elements and fires forward in a sector to retain specific terrain. The commander's intent in this type of defense is to fight the decisive defensive battle forward of the battle area.

Area of Influence
A geographical area wherein a commander is directly capable of influencing operations by maneuver or fire support systems normally under his command or control.

Area of Interest
Area of concern to the commander, including the area of influence, areas adjacent thereto, and extending into enemy territory to the objectives of current or planned operations. This area also includes areas occupied by enemy forces that could jeopardize the accomplishment of the mission.

Area of Operations
That portion of an area of conflict necessary for military operations. Areas of operations are geographical areas assigned to commanders for which they have responsibility and in which they have authority to conduct military operations.

Area of Responsibility
A defined area of land in which responsibility is specifically assigned to the commander of the area for the development and maintenance of installations, control of movement, and the conduct of tactical operations involving troops under his control along with parallel authority to exercise these functions.

Area Reconnaissance
A form of reconnaissance operations that is a directed effort to obtain detailed information concerning the terrain or enemy activity within a prescribed area, such as a town, ridgeline, woods, or other features critical to operations. An area reconnaissance could be made of a single point, such as a bridge or installation.

Area Security
A form of security operations that includes area reconnaissance, rear operations, and security of designated personnel, unit convoys, facilities, and main supply route critical points.

Armored Cavalry Troop
Is the maneuver element of the squadron. It is composed of two Scout Platoons and two Light Tank Platoons that can be deployed depending on the type of enemy they are confronting. The composition was designed to be able to confront either enemy infantry units or tank units when doing their mission. The leaders at troop and company level perform functions similar to their squadron counterparts.

Armored Cavalry Troop (Separate)
Is organized as part of separate light and armored brigades. It is heavy or light depending on the organization of the brigade. It operates for the brigade commander in the operational environments for which the brigade is focused. The ACT(S) differs from an ACT since it can operate without the support of a squadron. It has its own maintenance section to sustain its operation. The troop commander and troop staffs of ACT (S) have the same responsibilities with that of ACT units.

Army Aviation
The aviation personnel, aircraft, and allied equipment organic of a unit.

Assailable Flank(s)
An exposed enemy flank(s) which is vulnerable to envelopment. For a flank to be assailable there must be sufficient maneuver space to accommodate the attacking force.

Assault
To make a short, violent, but well-ordered attack against a local objective.

Assault Force
Those forces charged with passing through a breach in an enemy fortified position or strong point and seizing an objective or completing destruction of the enemy.

Assault Position
That position between the Lines of Departure (LD) and the objective in an attack from which forces assault the objective. Ideally, it is the last covered and concealed position before reaching the objective (primarily used by dismounted infantry).

Assembly Area
An area in which a command is assembled for further action.

Assets
Any resource—person, group, relationship, instrument, installation, or supply at the disposition of an intelligence organization for use in an operational or support role. Often used with a qualifying term, such as agent asset or propaganda asset.

Assign
To place units or personnel in an organization where such placement is relatively permanent and/or where such organization controls, administers, and provides logistical support to units or personnel for the primary function, or greater portion of the functions, of the unit or personnel.

Attach
The temporary placement of units or personnel in an organization subject to limitations imposed by the attachment order, the commander of the formation, unit, or organization receiving the attachment will exercise the same degree of command and control there over as he does over units and persons organic to his command. However, the responsibility for transfer and promotion of personnel will normally be retained by the parent formation, unit, or organization.

Attack
An offensive action characterized by movement supported by fire against an established position intended to seize a particular terrain.

Attack Position
The last position occupied or passed through by the assault echelon before crossing the Line of Departure (LD).

Avenue of Approach
An air or ground route of an attacking force of a given size leading to its objective or to key terrain in its path.

Aviation
The branch of science or technology that deals with any part of the operation of machines that fly through the air.

Axis of Advance
A line of advance assigned for purposes of control; often a road or a group of roads, or a designated series of locations, extending in the direction of the enemy. – a general route of advance, assigned for purposes of control, which extends towards the enemy. An Axis of Advance symbol graphically portrays a commander’s intention, such as avoidance of built-up areas or envelopment of an enemy force.

Base of Fire
Fire placed on an enemy force or position to reduce or eliminate the enemy's capability to interfere by fire and or movement of friendly maneuver element(s). It may be provided by a single weapon or a grouping of weapons systems.

Battle Area
That part of the defense sector that is located to the rear of the security area and is bounded by a trace of the Forward Edge of the Battle Area (FEBA). Lateral boundaries and the rare boundary of command conducting the defense. The battle area is divided into a forward defense area and a reserve area.

Battle Damage Assessment
A service provided by intermediate rear maintenance, which evaluates combat damage to determine whether to repair, cannibalize, or evacuate.

Battle Position
A defensive location oriented on the most likely enemy avenue of approach from which a unit may defend or attack. Such units can be as large as battalion task forces and as small as platoons.

Booby Trap
An explosive charge which is exploded when an unsuspecting person disturbs an apparently harmless object or performs a presumably safe act.

Boundary
Tactical control measures used to delineate sectors of responsibility for subordinate units. Within these sectors, units may fire and maneuver without clearance from other units.

Breach
The employment of any means available to break through or secure a passage through an enemy defense, obstacle, minefield, or fortification.

Built-up Area (BUA)
A concentration of structures, facilities, and population.

Bypass
An act of maneuvering around an obstacle, position or troops to maintain the momentum of advantage.

Canalize
To restrict operations to a narrow zone with the use of existing or reinforcing obstacles or by direct or indirect fires.

Capability
The ability to execute a specified course of action. A capability may or may not be accompanied by an intention.

Casualties
Personnel and/or equipment lost in an operation.

Cavalry Squadron
The cavalry squadron is a highly mobile, armor-protected force organized as part of the mechanized infantry divisions. The squadron operates primarily during wars and conflicts.

Checkpoint
A predetermined point on the ground used as a means of coordinating friendly movement. Checkpoints are not used as reference points in reporting enemy locations.

Chemical, Biological and Radiological Nuclear Operations
A combined term used to refer to the three areas of chemical operations, biological operations, radiological operations, and nuclear operation in the collective sense.

Civil Considerations
Comprise the influence of manmade infrastructure, civilian institutions, and attitudes and activities of the civilian leaders, populations, and organizations within an area of operations on the conduct of military operations.

Civil Military Operations (CMO)
Military operations that enhance the relationship between military forces and civilian authorities and population, and which promote the development of favorable emotions, attitudes or behavior in neutral, friendly or hostile groups.

Close Air Support (CAS)
Air action against hostile targets that are in close proximity to friendly forces and which requires detailed integration of each air mission with the fire and movement and maneuver of those forces.

Combat Service Support
The assistance provided to sustain combat forces, primarily in the fields of administration and logistics. The focus of logistics at the tactical level of war; the synchronizations of the essential functions, activities, and task necessary to sustain soldiers and their weapon system in an area of operations; includes, but is not limited to, that support rendered by service support troops to arm, fuel, fix, move, man, and sustain soldiers and their equipment.

Combat Support
A unit that provides fire support and operational assistance provided to combat elements. It Includes artillery, air defense artillery, engineer, military police, signal, military intelligence, and chemical components.

Combat Trains
The portion of unit trains that provides the Combat Service Support (CSS) required for immediate response to the needs of forward tactical elements. At company level, medical, recovery, and maintenance elements normally constitute the combat trains. At battalion, the combat trains normally consist of ammunition and Petroleum, Oils, and Lubricants (POL) vehicles, maintenance/recovery vehicles and crews, and the battalion aid station.

Combatant
Any object which of any armed forces, except medical and religious personnel whether from the government (Armed Forces of the Philippines/Philippine National Police), Dissident Terrorist Organization (DT) or the Southern Philippines Secessionist Groups (SPSG), or other dissident groups, and who distinguished himself by the distinctive sign of his organization or at least by the carrying firearms openly.

Combined Arms
It is the synchronized or simultaneous application of several Army specific capabilities represented by military occupational specialties to achieve an effect on the enemy or on a situation that is greater than if each capability was used separately or in sequence.

Command
The authority that a commander in the military service lawfully executes over subordinates by virtue of rank or assignment. This include the authority and responsibility for effectively using available resources and for planning the employment of organizing, directing, coordinating and controlling military or other peace keeping forces for the accomplishment of assigned missions. It also includes responsibility for health, welfare, morale and discipline of assigned personnel.

Command and Control
The exercise of command that is the process through which the activities of military forces are directed, coordinated, and controlled to accomplish the mission. This process encompasses the personnel, equipment, communications, facilities, and procedures necessary to gather and analyze information, to plan for what is to be done, and to supervise the execution of operations.

Command Group
A small party that accompanies the commander when he departs the Command Post (CP) to be present at a critical action. The party is organized and equipped to suit the commander, and normally provides local security and other personal assistance for the commander as he requires.

Command Post (CP)
The principal facility employed by the commander to command and control combat operations. A CP consists of those coordinating and special staff activities and representatives from supporting elements and other services that may be necessary to carry out operations.

Commander's Intent
A clear, concise statement of what the force must do and the conditions the force must establish with respect to the enemy, terrain, and civil considerations that represent the desired end state.

Commanders
Refers to the following: major service commanders, area commanders, division commanders, brigade commanders, battalion commanders, company commanders, platoon leaders and detachment commanders and their equivalent in the Philippine

Navy, Philippine Airforce and Armed Forces of the Philippines-Wide Support and Separate Units

Commander's Estimate
The procedure whereby a commander decides how best to accomplish the assigned mission. It is a thorough consideration of the factors of mission, enemy, terrain and weather, troops available and time Mission, Enemy, Terrain, Troops, and Time Available (METT-T), and other relevant factors. The commander's estimate is based on personal knowledge of the situation and on staff estimates.

Communications Security
The protection resulting from all measures designed to deny unauthorized persons information of value that might be derived from the possession and study of telecommunications, or to mislead unauthorized persons in their interpretation of the results of such possession and study. Includes crypt security, transmission security, emission security, and physical security of materials and information.

Concentration
This is the application of combat power and its desired effects at decisive points and times during the attack to achieve decisive results. Leaders strive to concentrate the effects of their combat power while maintaining their dispersion in small units.

Concept
A notion or statement of an idea, expressing how something might be done or accomplished, that may lead to an accepted procedure.

Concept of Operations
A graphic, verbal, or written statement in broad outline that gives an overall picture of a commander's assumptions or intent in regard to an operation or series of operations; includes at a minimum the scheme of maneuver and fire support plan. The concept of operations is embodied in campaign plans and operations plans particularly when the plans cover a series of connected operations to be carried out simultaneously or in succession. It is described in sufficient detail for the staff and subordinate commanders to understand what they are to do and how to fight the battle without further instructions.

Contact Point
A designated, easily identifiable point on the terrain where two or more units are required to physically meet.

Contain
To restrict enemy movement by stopping, holding, or surrounding his forces or causing them to center their activity on a given front to prevent the movement of any part of his forces for use elsewhere. The limits of the containment may be expressed in terms of geography or time.

Control
A regulation of forces and warfighting functions to accomplish the mission in accordance with the commander's intent.

Control Measures
A means of regulating forces or warfighting functions established under a commander's authority used to assign responsibilities, require synchronization between forces, impose restrictions, or establish guidelines to regulate freedom of action. They can be permissive or restrictive.

Convoy
A group of vehicles crafts organized for the purpose of control and orderly movement with or without escort protection.

Coordinated Fire Line
A line beyond which conventional surface fire support means (mortars, field artillery, and naval gunfire ships) may fire at any time within the zone of the establishing headquarters without additional coordination. It is usually established by brigade or division but may be established by a maneuver battalion.

Counter-Attack
Attack by a part or all of a defending force against an enemy attacking force, for such specific purposes as regaining ground lost or cutting off or destroying enemy advance units, and with the general objective of regaining the initiative and denying to the enemy the attainment of his purpose in attacking. In sustained defensive operations, it is undertaken to restore the battle position (BP) and is directed at limited objectives.

Course of Action
Any sequence of activity that an individual member or a military unit may follow.

Covering Force
A combined arms force with a mission to cover. Operates apart from the main body to develop the situation early and deceives, disorganize and destroys enemy forces. A tactically self-contained force (That is, it is organized with sufficient combat support and combat service support assets to operate independently of the main body).

Critical Point
A key terrain feature or position important to the successful conduct of an operation.

Critical Task
A task which is essential for accomplishment of the unit missions, successful individual skill performance, and/or survival in battle. It requires training and evaluation.

Dead Space
The area within the maximum range of a weapon which cannot be covered by fire from a particular position because of obstacles or because of the nature of the ground.

Deception
Actions to mislead the enemy and induce him to do something counter to his interests. It includes manipulating, distorting, or falsifying information available to the enemy to ensure security to real plans, operations, or activities

Deception Operations
A military operation conducted to mislead the enemy. A unit conducting a deception operation may or may not make contact with the enemy. It includes demonstrations, displays, feints and ruses.

Decision
In the estimate of the situation, it is the clear and concise statement of the line of action intended to be followed by the commander as the most favorable to the successful accomplishment of his mission.

Decision Point
An event, an area, a line or a point on the battlefield where tactical decisions are required resulting from the war-gaming process before the operation order. Decision points do not dictate commander's decisions, they only dictates that a decision is required, and they indicate when and where the decision should be made to have the maximum effect on friendly or enemy course of action.

Decisive Engagement
An engagement in which a unit is considered fully committed and cannot maneuver or extricate itself. In the absence of outside assistance, the action must be fought to a conclusion and either won or lost with the forces at hand.

Decisive Point
A time or location where enemy weakness is positioned that allows overwhelming combat power to be generated against it. It could be an enemy weakness to be exploited or a time when the combat potential of the enemy force is degraded.

Deep Operations
Those operations directed against enemy forces and functions which are not in contact at the Forward Line of Troops (FLOT), line of departure, or friendly perimeter and are between the FLOT or perimeter and the forward boundary of the unit conducting the operation. These operations employ long-range fires, air and ground maneuver, and command and control warfare to defeat the enemy by denying him freedom of action; disrupting his preparation for battle and his support structure; and disrupting or destroying the coherence and tempo of his operations.

Defense
The employment of all means and methods available to prevent, resist or repel an enemy attack. Defense is often associated with the retention of enemy terrain.

Defense in Depth
The positioning of mutually supporting defense positions designed to absorb and progressively weaken an enemy attack, prevent initial observation of the whole position by the enemy and allow the commander to maneuver his reserve.

Defense in Sector
This type of defense allows the platoon to fight throughout a designated sector by locating and dividing itself into small units in dispersed locations.

Defensive Operations
These are combat operations to defeat an enemy attack, gain time, control key terrain, and economize forces.

Defilade
Protection from hostile observation and fire provided by an obstacle such as a hill, ridge or bank. To shield from enemy fire or observation by using natural or artificial obstacles.

Defile
A narrow passage that tends to constrict the movement of troops.

Delay
To trade space for time, inflict maximum damage on the enemy force, and preserve the forces within the limits established by the commander. In delay operations, the destruction of the enemy force is secondary to slowing his advance to gain time.

Depth
Is the extension of operations in time, space, and resources. Commanders use depth to obtain space for effective maneuver, time to conduct operations, and resources to achieve and exploit success.

Direct Fire
Fire directed at a target that is visible to the aimed or firing unit.

Direct Support
A mission requiring a force to support another specific force and authorizing it to answer directly the supported force's request for assistance. It is also the support provided by a unit or formation not attached to, nor under command of, the supported unit or formation, but required to give priority to the support required by that unit or formation.

Direction of Attack
A specific direction or route that the main attack or the main body of the force will follow. If used, it is normally at battalion and lower levels. Direction of attack is a more restrictive control measure than axis of advance, and units are not free to maneuver off the assigned route. It is usually associated with infantry units conducting night attacks, or units involved in limited visibility operations, and in counterattacks.

Disengagement
Breaking contact with the enemy and moving to a point where the enemy can neither observe nor engage the unit by direct fire.

Dispersion
A scattered pattern of hits by bombs or artillery rounds dropped and fired under identical conditions and same firing data.

Displace
To leave one position and take another. Forces may displace laterally to concentrate combat power in threatened areas.

Displacement
The movement of supporting weapons from one firing position to another.

Disrupt
To counter the enemy's initiative and synchronization; preventing him from concentrating overwhelming combat power against a friendly force.

Disruption
Precluding adversary from conducting countermoves through attacks against strategic and operational targets and centers of gravity.

Economy of Force
The economy of force principle calls for the rational use of force by selecting the best mix of combat power. The allocation of minimum-essential combat capability or strength to secondary efforts, so that forces may be concentrated in the area where a decision is sought.

Effective Range
That range at which a weapon or weapons system has a 50 percent probability of hitting or destroying the target.

Electronic Warfare
Active or passive efforts in conducting electronic activities to enhance friendly capabilities or undermine hostile communications, target acquisition, detection or homing capabilities.

Engagement Area
An area in which the commander intends to trap and destroy an enemy force with the massed fires of all available weapons. Engagement areas are routinely identified by a target reference point in the center of the trap area or by prominent terrain features around the area.

Envelopment
An offensive maneuver in which the main attacking force passes around or over the enemy's principal defensive positions to secure objectives to the enemy's rear.

Exploitation
An offensive operation that usually follows a successful attack to take advantage of weakened or collapsed enemy defenses. Its purpose is to prevent reconstitution of enemy defenses, to prevent enemy withdrawal, and to secure deep objectives.

Field Artillery
Equipment, supplies, ammunition and personnel involved in the use of cannon, rocket or surface-to-surface missile launchers and mobile enough to accompany and support infantry, mechanized, armored, airborne and airmobile units in the field.

Field Trains
The Combat Service Support (CSS) portion of a unit at company and battalion level that is not required to respond immediately. At company level, supply and mess teams normally will be located in the field trains.

Final Protective Fire
A predetermined line along which in order to stop enemy assaults, interlocking fire is placed from all available flat trajectory weapons, fixed as to direction and elevation and capable of delivery under any condition of visibility.

Fire Direction
Consisting of the selection of targets, concentration or distribution of fire and/or allocation of ammunition.

Fire Direction Center
That element of a Command Post by means of which a commander exercises fire direction or fire control. The nerve center of a firing unit.

Fire Support
Assistance to those elements of the ground forces which close with the enemy such as infantry and armor units, rendered by delivering artillery and mortar fire, naval gunfire, and close air support.

Fire Support Element
A functional portion of a force Tactical Operations Center (TOC) that provides centralized targeting, coordination, and integration of fires delivered on surface targets by fire support means under the control of or in support of the force. This element is staffed from the field artillery headquarters or field artillery staff section of the force and representatives of other fire support means.

Fire Support Plan
A plan on how fire support will be used to support an operation. It should include a portion for each means of fire support involved.

Fire Support Team
In fire support operations, it is a team required to plan, request, coordinate, and direct fire support efforts for company-sized units.

Fix
Actions taken to prevent the enemy from moving any part of his forces from a specific location and/or for a specific period of time by holding or surrounding them to prevent their withdrawal for use elsewhere.

Flank Guard
A security element operating to the flank of a moving or stationary force.

Forward Air Controller
A member of the tactical air control party who from a ground or airborne position controls aircraft engaged in close air support of ground forces.

Forward Defense
A strategic concept which calls for containing or repulsing military aggression to close to the original line of contact as possible so as to defend the entire territory of a nation or alliance.

Forward Edge of the Battle Area
The foremost limits of a series of areas on the ground where combat units are deployed, excluding the areas in which the covering or screening forces are operating, designated to coordinate fire support, the positioning of forces or the maneuver of units.

Forward Line of Own Troops
Line which indicates the most forward positions of friendly forces in any kind of military operation at a specific time. The FLOT normally identifies the forward location of covering and screening forces.

Forward Observer (FO)
An observer with forward troops trained to call for and adjust supporting fire and pass battlefield information.

Fragmentary Order
An abbreviated form of an Operation Order (OPORD) used to make changes in missions to units and to inform them of changes in the tactical situation.

Front
The line of contact of two (2) opposing forces.

Frontal Attack
A form of offensive maneuver in which the attacker strikes the enemy all along its front (direction) to overrun, destroy or capture a weaker enemy in position or to support another form of maneuver.

Gaps
Any break or breach in the continuity of tactical disposition greater in size than an area which could be covered effectively by small arms fire.

Guard
A task assigned to a unit/force that accomplished all of the tasks of a screening force.

Guard Force
Prevents enemy ground observation of a direct fire against the main body. Reconnoiters, attacks, defends and delays as necessary to accomplish its mission. Normally operates within the range of the main body indirect fire weapons.

Hasty attack
An offensive action characterized by movement supported by fire.

Hasty Defense
A defense normally organized while in contact with the enemy or when contact is imminent and time to organize is limited. It is characterized by improvement of the

natural defensive strength of the terrain by utilization of foxholes, emplacement, and obstacles.

Indirect Fire
Fire delivered on a target which cannot be seen by the firing unit.

Infiltration
The movement through or into an area or territory occupied by either friendly or enemy troops or organizations. The movement is made either by small groups or by individuals at extended or irregular intervals. When used in connection with the enemy, it infers that contact is avoided.

Information Requirements
Those items of information regarding the enemy and his environment which need to be collected and processed in order to meet the intelligence requirements of a commander.

Insurgent
An individual not recognized as a belligerent by international law, who espouses political ideology to overthrow the government or disintegrate part of the national territory by armed revolution.

Intelligence
The product resulting from the collection, evaluation, analysis, integration, and interpretation of all available information concerning an enemy force, foreign nations, or areas of operations and which is immediately or potentially significant to military planning and operations.

Intelligence Preparation of the Battlefield (IPB)
A systematic approach to analyzing the enemy, weather, and the terrain in a specific geographical area. It integrates enemy doctrine with the weather and terrain as they relate to the mission and the specific battlefield environment. This is done to determine and evaluate enemy capabilities, vulnerabilities and probable courses of action.

Interdiction
Air role designed to restrict enemy manpower and war fighting materiel from moving into, within, or out of the battle area. It can be conducted against land, sea and air targets.

Interdiction Fire
Fire placed on an area or point to prevent the enemy from using the area or point and route by enemy forces.

Jamming
The deliberate radiation, re-radiation, or reflection of electromagnetic energy to prevent or degrade the receipt of information by receiver. It includes communications jamming and non-communications jamming.

Joint Operations
Employment of two or more services in a single operation to achieve operational and strategic objectives.

Key Terrain
Any locality or area the seizure, retention, or control of which affords a marked advantage to either combatant. Any locality or area whose seizure or control affords a marked advantage to either combatants. Key terrain is any feature or area which, in the control of a combatant, will affect the conduct of an operation.

Landing Zone
A specified zone within an objective area used for landing aircraft.

Limit of Advance
An easily identifiable terrain feature beyond which attacking elements will not advance.

Limitation
Control measures, instruction or order that restrict freedom of action.

Line of Communication
All the route, land, water and air, which connect the operating military force with a base of operation and along which, its supplies and reinforcement move.

Line of Contact
A general trace delineating the location where two opposing forces are engaged.

Line of Departure
A line designated to coordinate the departure of attacking elements. Also known as the jump-off line.

Linkup
A meeting of friendly ground forces (such as when an advancing force reaches an objective area previously seized by an airborne or air assault force, when an encircled element breaks out to rejoin friendly forces, or when converging maneuver forces meet).

Main Attack
The principal attack or effort into which the commander throws the full weight of the offensive power at his disposal.

Main Battle Area
That portion of battlefield in which the decisive battle is fought to defeat the enemy. For any particular command, the main battle area extends rearward from the forward edge of the battle area to the rear boundary of the command's subordinate unit.

Main Effort
It is the unit, battle positions, sectors, zone, axis, avenue of approach, are of operations, theater operations, and so forth, the senior commander has determined as the most important task and purpose at that time, whose success will make the most

difference in the accomplishment of the higher commander's overall mission or objective.

Main Supply Route
The route designated within an area of operations where the bulk of supply flows in support of military operations.

Maintenance
Proper handling and operation of equipment to sustain or prolong serviceability. It may include application of preventive maintenance procedures.

Maneuver
The movement of forces supported by fire to achieve a position of advantage from which to destroy or threaten destruction of the enemy. A principle of war and an element of combat power.

Mass
A principle of war which means the concentration of combat power at the decisive time and place. To concentrate or bring together fires, so as to mass fires of multiple weapons or units.

Massed Fires
Fire from a number of weapons directed at a single point or small area.

Mechanized
Infantry units that use armored vehicles in tactical operations. Not to be confused with motorized units.

Meeting Engagement
A combat action that occurs when a moving force, incompletely deployed for battle, engages an enemy at an unexpected time and place.

Minefield
An area of ground containing mines laid with or without pattern.

Mission
The primary task assigned to an individual, unit, or force. It usually contains the elements of who, what, when, where, and the reason undertake, but seldom specifies how.

Mission Essential Task
A collection task in which an organization must be proficient to accomplish an appropriate portion of its wartime mission(s).

Mission Essential Task List (METL)
A compilation of collective mission essential tasks which must be successfully performed if an organization is to accomplish its wartime mission(s).

Mission, Enemy, Terrain, Troops, and Time Available (METT-TC)
The phrase or acronym used to describe the factors that must be considered during the planning or execution of a tactical operation.

Movement Technique
Manner of traversing terrain used by a unit (such as traveling, traveling over watch, and bounding over watch). The likelihood of enemy contact determines which of the following techniques are used.

Movement to Contact
An offensive operation designed to gain initial ground contact with the enemy or to regain lost contact.

Mutual Support
That support which units render to each other against an enemy because of their assigned task, their position relative to each other and the enemy, and their inherent capabilities.

Named Area of Interest (NAI)
A point or area along a particular avenue of approach, through which enemy activity is expected to occur. Activity or lack of activity within a NAI will help to confirm to deny a particular enemy course of action.

Objective
The physical object of the action taken (for example, a definite terrain feature, the seizure and/or holding of which is essential to the commander's plan, or, the destruction of an enemy force without regard to terrain features). The principle of war which states that every military operation should be directed towards clearly defined, decisive and attainable objectives.

Obscure
Breaching fundamental that integrates indirect and direct fire support to conceal advancing friendly troops forward to the objective.

Observation
A complete awareness by an individual of his surroundings, achieved through maximum employment of the senses. Expert observation enables one to recall any objects or situation accurately, fully and clearly.

Observation and Fields of Fire
Observation relates to the impact terrain has on the capability of Intelligence and Electronic Warfare (IEW) systems.

Observation Post (OP)
A position from which military observations (visual, audible, or other means) are made, or fire is directed and adjusted, and that possesses appropriate communications; it also may be airborne.

Offensive
A principle of war that emphasizes the distinct advantage of action rather than reaction. The time, place, purpose, scope, intensity and pace of operations should be dictated. The initiative must be seized, retained and fully exploited.

Offensive Operations
An operation conducted to defeat and destroy enemy forces and seize terrain, resources, and population centers.

Operation
A military action or the carrying out of a strategic, tactical, service, training, or administrative military mission; the process of carrying on combat, including movement, supply attack, defense, and maneuvers needed to gain the objectives of any battle or campaign.

Operation Order
A directive issued by a commander to subordinate commanders for affecting the coordinated execution of an operation; includes tactical movement orders.

Operational Control
The authority delegated to a commander to direct forces assigned so that the commander may accomplish specific missions or tasks that are usually limited by function, time or location; to deploy units concerned, and to retain or assign tact1cal control of those units. It does not of itself include administrative or logistic control.

Order
A communication-written, oral, or by signal that conveys instructions from a superior to a subordinate. In a broad sense, the terms order and command are synonymous. However, an order implies discretion as to the details of execution whereas a command does not.

Organic
Assigned to and forming an essential part of a military organization; an element normally shown in the unit's Table of Organization and Equipment (TOE).

Over Watch
A tactical technique in which one element is positioned to support the movement of another element with immediate direct fire.

Passage of Lines
Relief of front line troops by a rear unit which moves forward through an already established line. In this operation, the unit passes through may remain in place or move to the rear.

Passage Point
A place where units will pass through one another either in an advance or a withdrawal. It is where units physically execute a passage of lines.

Penetration
A form of offensive maneuver that seeks to break through the enemy's defensive position, widens the gap created, and destroys the continuity of his positions.

Phase
A specific part of an operation that is different from those that precede or follow. A change in phase usually involves a change of task.

Phase Line –
A line used for control and coordination of military operations. It is usually a recognizable terrain feature extending across the zone of action. Units normally report crossing PLs, but do not halt unless specifically directed. PLs often are used to prescribe the timing of delay operations

Physical Security
The physical measures of security operations designed to safeguard personnel; to prevent unauthorized access to equipment, facilities, materiel, and documents; and to safeguard them against espionage, sabotage, damage, and theft.

Planning Guidance
Is a broad description of when, where, and how the commander intends to employ Army power to accomplish the mission within the higher commander's intent.

Position
A location or area occupied by a military unit. The location of a weapon, unit, individual from which fire is delivered upon a target. Positions may be classified as primary positions, alternate positions, and supplementary positions.

Preparation Fire
Fire deliberated on the objective before the assault is launched.

Primary Position
A place for a weapon, unit, or individual to fight which provides the best means to accomplish the assigned mission.

Priority Intelligence Requirements
Those intelligence requirements for which a commander has an anticipated and stated priority in his task of planning and decision making.

Priority of Fires
Direction to a fire support planner to organize and employ fire support means according to the importance of the supported unit's missions.

Priority of Support
Priorities set by the commander in his concept of the operation and during execution to ensure that Combat Support (CS) and Combat Service Support (CSS) are provided to subordinate elements in accordance with their relative importance to accomplishing the mission.

Priority Target
A target from which the delivery of fires takes precedence over all the fires for the designated firing unit/element. The firing unit/element will prepare, to the extent possible, for the engagement of such targets. A firing unit/element may be assigned only one priority target.

Pursuit
An offensive operation against a retreating enemy force. It follows a successful attack or exploitation and is ordered when the enemy cannot conduct an organized defense and attempts to disengage. Its object is to maintain relentless pressure on the enemy and completely destroy him.

Quartering Party
A group of unit representatives dispatched to a probable new site of operations in advance of the main body to secure, reconnoiter, and organize an area prior to the main body's arrival and occupation.

Raid
An operation, usually small-scale, involving a swift penetration of hostile territory to secure information, to confuse the enemy, or to destroy his installations. It ends with a planned withdrawal upon completion of the assigned mission.

Rally Point
A place where members of a unit can reassemble and reorganize if dispersed during movement.

Rate of Fire
The number of rounds fired per weapon per minute. The distance between any given point and an object or target.

Rear Area
The area in the rear of the combat and forward areas. Combat echelons from the brigade through the field army normally designate a rear area. For any particular command, that area extending rearward from the rear boundary of their next subordinate formations or units deployed in the main battle or defense area to their own rear boundary. It is here that reserve forces of the echelon are normally located. In addition, Combat Support (CS) and Combat Service Support (CSS) units and activities are located in this area. Is provided primarily for the performance of support functions and where the majority of the echelon's sustaining operations occur. Operations in rear areas assure freedom of action and continuity of operations, sustainment, and command and control (C2).

Reconnaissance
A mission undertaken to obtain information by visual observation, or other detection methods, about the activities and resources of an enemy or potential enemy, or about the meteorology, hydrographic, or geographic characteristics of a particular area. An examination or observation of an area, territory, or airspace from the air either visually or with the aid of photography or electronic devices.

Reconnaissance by Fire
A method of reconnaissance in which fire is placed on a suspected enemy position to cause the enemy to disclose his presence by movement or return fire.

Reconnaissance in Force
A limited-objective operation conducted by, at least, a battalion task force to obtain information, and to locate and test enemy dispositions, strengths, and reactions. Even though a reconnaissance in force is executed primarily to gather information, the force conducting the operation must seize any opportunity to exploit tactical success.

Reconnaissance Patrol (Ground)
A small patrol used to gain information about the enemy, preferably without their knowledge.

Reinforce
To strengthen a unit by addition of additional personnel or military equipment.

Reinforcing Obstacles
Obstacles specifically constructed, emplaced, or detonated to tie together, strengthen, and extend existing obstacles. Standard obstacles are designed to simplify and expedite planning and logistics support; however, they will be employed in multiples as necessary to conform to a specific target site.

Relief in Place
An operation in which a unit is replaced in combat by another unit. Responsibilities for the combat mission and the assigned sector or zone of action of the replaced unit are assumed by the incoming unit.

Retrograde
An organized movement to the rear or away from the enemy. It may be forced by the enemy or may be made voluntarily. Such movements may be classified as withdrawal, retirement, or delaying operations.

Retrograde Operations
Are organized movements away from the enemy that relinquishes terrain to enemy control.

Reverse Slope
A position on the ground not exposed to direct fire or observation. It may be a slope that descends away from the enemy.

Route Reconnaissance
A form of reconnaissance focused along a specific line of communications, such as a road, railway, or waterway, to provide a new or updated information on route conditions and activities along the route.

Sabotage
An act or acts with intent to injure, interfere with, or obstruct the national defense of a country or disrupt the normal activities of a civilized society by willfully injuring or

destroying, or attempting to injure or destroy, any national defense or war material, premises, or utilities, to include human and natural resources.

Scheme of Maneuver
The tactical plan to be executed by a force in order to seize assigned objectives.

Screen
A task assigned to a unit/force that maintains surveillance, provides early warning to the main body, impedes and harasses the enemy with supporting indirect fires, and destroys enemy reconnaissance elements within its capability.

Sector
An area designated by boundaries within which a unit operates and for which it is responsible. Normally, sectors are used in defensive operations.

Secure
A tactical task to gain possession of a position or terrain feature, with or without force, and to deploy in a manner which prevents its destruction or loss to enemy action. The attacking force may or may not have physically occupy the area.

Security
Measures taken by a military unit, an activity, or an installation to protect itself against all acts designed to, or that may, impair its effectiveness. A condition that results from the establishment and maintenance of protective measures that ensures a state of inviolability from hostile acts or influences. With respect to classified matter, it is the condition that prevents unauthorized persons from having access to official information that is safeguarded in the interests of national security.

Security Operations
Those operations designed to obtain information about the enemy and provide reaction time, maneuver space, and protection to the main body. Security operations are characterized by aggressive reconnaissance to reduce terrain and enemy unknowns, gaining and maintaining contact with the enemy to ensure continuous information, and providing early and accurate reporting of information to the protected force. Security operations include screening operations, guard operations, covering force operations, and area security operations.

Seize
To clear a designated area and obtain control of it.

Smoke
An artificially produced aerosol of solid, liquid, or vapor in the atmosphere which weakens the passage of visible light or other forms of electromagnetic radiation.

Spoiling Attack
A limited-objective attack made to delay, disrupt, or destroy the enemy’s capability to launch an attack.

Strongpoint
A key point in a defensive position, usually strongly fortified and heavily armed with automatic weapons, around which other positions are grouped for its protection.

Successive Positions
Defensive fighting positions located one after another on the battlefield. A force can conduct a delaying action from successive delay positions.

Supporting Effort
It directly or indirectly creates a necessary condition for the main effort to succeed.

Suppress
Breaching fundamental that integrates indirect and direct fire support to soften the ground obstacles and enemy fortified defense position.

Suppression
Direct and indirect fires, or smoke brought to bear on enemy personnel, weapons, or equipment to prevent effective fire on friendly forces.

Surveillance
A systematic observation of airspace or surface areas by visual, seeking, electronic, photographic, or other means.

Sustainment
All engineer activities that allow the Philippine Military to conduct prolonged operations.

Synchronization
Is the arrangement of military actions in time, space, and purpose to produce maximum relative Army power at a decisive place and time.

Table of Organization and Equipment
Details the authorize levels of personnel and major equipment of major units and its sub-units and defines its order of battle.

Tactical Operations Center
Sub-element of the Command Post (CP) with staff elements (Brigade and Battalion) and is composed of a grouping of staff elements concerned with current and future tactical operations and support.

Tactics
The ordered arrangement and maneuver of units in relation to each other or the enemy in order to realized their full potentialities.

Target
A geographical area, complex, or installation planned for capture or destruction by military forces.

Target Acquisition
The detection, identification, and location of a target in sufficient detail to permit the effective employment of weapons.

Target Area of Interest
An area or point along a mobility corridor, the successful interdiction of which will cause the enemy to either abandon a particular course of action or require him to use specialized engineer support to continue.

Target Reference Point
An easily recognizable point on the ground (either natural or manmade) used for identifying enemy targets or controlling fires.

Task
A clearly defined, measurable activity accomplished by individuals and organizations. Tasks are specific activities that contribute to the accomplishment of encompassing missions or other requirements. A task should be definable, measurable and decisive.

Task Organization
A temporary grouping of forces designed to accomplish a particular mission. Task organization involves the distribution of available assets in Direct Support (DS) or under the operational control of the subordinate.

Time Available
The time available to plan, prepare, and execute operations is considered for both enemy and friendly forces.

Traveling
A movement technique used when speed is necessary and contact with enemy forces is not likely. All elements of the unit move simultaneously with the unit leader located where he can best control.

Traveling Over Watch
A movement technique used when contact with enemy forces is possible. The lead element and trailing element are separated by a short distance which varies with the terrain. The trailing element moves at variable speeds and may pause for short periods to over watch the lead element

Turning Movement
A variation of an envelopment in which tile attacking force passes around or over the enemy's principal defensive positions to secure objectives that are deep in the enemy's rear. In doing so, it forces the enemy to abandon his positions, to divert major forces to meet the threat, and to fight in two directions simultaneously.

Turret-Down
A vehicle is in turret-down position when the entire vehicle is behind cover, but the commander can still observe to the front from the turret hatch or cupola.

Unity of Effort
Coordinated and cooperation among all forces, not necessarily part of the same command structure, toward a commonly recognized objective.

Warfighting Functions
It is a group of tasks and related systems (people, organizations, information, and processes) united by a common purpose that commanders use to accomplish missions and training objectives.

Warning Order
A preliminary notice of an action or order that is to follow. Usually issued as a brief oral or written message. It is designed to give subordinates time to make necessary plans and preparations.

Withdrawal
A retrograde operation in which a force in contact with the enemy frees itself for a new mission.

Zone Reconnaissance
A directed effort to obtain detailed information concerning all routes, obstacles (to include chemical or radiological contamination), terrain, and enemy forces within a zone defined by boundaries. A zone reconnaissance normally is assigned when the enemy situation is vague or when information concerning cross-country trafficability is desired.

Acronyms and Abbreviation

A2C2	army airspace command and control
AD	air defense
ADA	air defense artillery
ALO	air liaison officer
APERS	anti-personnel
BP	battlefield position
C2	command and control
C3I	command, control, communication and intelligence
CAS	close air support
COA	course of action
COMSEC	communication security
CP	command post
CS	combat support
CSM	command sergeant major
CSS	combat service support
CTCP	combat trains command post
DS	direct support
EX-O	executive officer
FARP	forward area rearm/refuel point
FASCAM	family of scatterable mines
FDC	fire direction center
FEBA	forward edge of the battle area
FIST	fire support team
FLOT	forward line of own troops
FM	field manual; frequency modulation
FRAGO	fragmentary order
FS	fire support
FSE	fire support element
FSO	fire support officer
FSS	fire support section
HF	high frequency
HHT	headquarters and headquarters troop
IEW	intelligence and electronic warfare
IFV	infantry fighting vehicle
IPB	intelligence preparation of the battlefield
JAAT	joint air attack team
J-SEAD	joint suppression of enemy air defenses
KIA	killed in action
LD	line of departure
LOGPAC	logistics package
MBA	main battle area
METL	mission essential task list
METT-T	mission, enemy, terrain, troops, and time available
MTOE	modification Table of Organization and Equipment
NAI	named areas of interest
NCO	non-commissioned officer
OP	observation post
OPCON	operational control

OPLAN	operation plan
OPORD	operation order
PA	physician’s assistant
PAC	personnel and administrative center
PIR	priority intelligence requirements
PL	phase line
SEAD	suppression of enemy air defenses
SMO	squadron maintenance officer
SOI	signal operation instructions
SOP	standing operating procedures
TAC CP	tactical command post
TACP	tactical air control party
TAI	target area(s) of interest
TOC	tactical operations center
TOE	table of organization and equipment
TRP	target reference point
UHF	ultra high frequency
UMCP	unit maintenance collecting point
VHF	very high frequency